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August 29, 2025

Commission Secretary
British Columbia Utilities Commission
Suite 410, 900 Howe Street
Vancouver, BC V6Z 2N3

Dear Commission Secretary:

**RE: British Columbia Utilities Commission (BCUC or Commission)
British Columbia Hydro and Power Authority (BC Hydro)
Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates (2023) (Application)
Compliance with BCUC Order No. G-67-24
Year One Evaluation Report**

BC Hydro writes in compliance with BCUC Order No. G-67-24 to provide the Year One (i.e., May 1, 2024 to April 30, 2025) Evaluation Report on its Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates.

The primary purpose of the evaluation report is to track the cost recovery progress of the Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates and to address whether the rates are competitive and maintain a level playing field for exempted public utilities providing public EV charging services in B.C. The evaluation report may include rate amendments depending on how cost recovery is tracking relative to the assumptions in the Application.

In this Year One Evaluation Report, BC Hydro is seeking approval of a 5% increase to the fast-charging rates set out in RS 4100, effective April 1, 2026 (i.e., fiscal 2027). BC Hydro is not proposing any changes to the Level 2 charging rate, Idle Fee or any other terms and conditions of RS 4100.

BC Hydro submits that this increase is reasonable because it restores the forecast 10-year revenue to cost ratio of the Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates to approximately 100% and results in a fast-charging rate that is comparable to other providers, helping to maintain a level playing field for exempted public utilities providing public EV charging services in B.C.

This Year One Evaluation Report must also propose the timing of the next evaluation report. BC Hydro proposes that the next Evaluation Report be filed by no later than August 31, 2027 (i.e., two years from now). If circumstances dictate (e.g., BC Hydro receives indications that forecast cost recovery is worsening), BC Hydro would accelerate the filing of the next Evaluation Report to inform whether any adjustments should be made to fiscal 2028 rates.

Pursuant to section 42 of the Administrative Tribunals Act and Part IV of the BCUC's Rules of Practice and Procedure, BC Hydro is providing the BCUC portions of this Evaluation Report and the Live Excel Working Model (Appendix A) confidentially because they contain commercially sensitive detailed station utilization, deployment plan and vendor cost information. Disclosure of such information could harm BC Hydro's market competitiveness and future negotiating position in upcoming procurements. BC Hydro requests that the information be held confidential on an ongoing basis, until otherwise determined by the BCUC. A public version of the Evaluation Report with a static Excel Model is filed under a separate cover with commercially sensitive information redacted.

For further information, please contact Shiau-Ching Chou at bchydroregulatorygroup@bchydro.com.

Yours sincerely,



Chris Sandve
Chief Regulatory Officer

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Enclosure

BC Hydro Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates

Evaluation Report for Year One

May 2024 to April 2025

PUBLIC

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1 Introduction

On March 13, 2024, the BC Utilities Commission (**BCUC** or **Commission**), issued Order No. G-67-24,¹ approving BC Hydro's Public Electric Vehicle (**EV**) Charging Service Rates as applied for in the Public Electric Vehicle (**EV**) Charging Service Rates Application (**Application**).² Those rates, set out in Rate Schedule (**RS**) 4100, became effective on May 1, 2024. The rates are designed to fully recover the forecast costs of providing BC Hydro's Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service on a 10-year levelized basis (i.e., costs are expected to exceed revenue from rates in earlier years and revenue is expected to exceed costs in later years so that, over 10 years, the forecast costs are fully recovered).³

This is BC Hydro's year one (i.e., May 1, 2024 to April 30, 2025 or **Year One**) evaluation report on the Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service rates (**Evaluation Report**).⁴ The primary purpose of the Evaluation Report is to track the cost recovery progress of the Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates and to address whether the rates are competitive and maintain a level playing field for exempted public utilities providing public EV charging services in BC. The Evaluation Report may include rate amendments depending on how cost recovery is tracking relative to the assumptions in the Application.⁵

In this Year One Evaluation Report, BC Hydro is seeking approval of a 5% increase to the fast-charging rates set out in RS 4100, effective April 1, 2026 (i.e., fiscal 2027). When combined with the approved fiscal 2027 general rate

¹ https://docs.bcuc.com/documents/other/2024/doc_76344_g-67-24-bch-public-ev-charging-rates-decision.pdf.

² <https://www.bcuc.com/OurWork/ViewProceeding?applicationid=1139>.

³ Refer to Order No. G-67-24, page 2.

⁴ Year One is the period from May 1, 2024 to April 30, 2025. However, the Original Rate Model was based on fiscal years (i.e., April 1 to March 31). For easy comparison, all revenues, costs and cost recovery results in the remainder of this Evaluation Report provide comparisons between the original fiscal 2025 (i.e., April 1, 2024 to March 31, 2025) forecast and actual fiscal 2025 results, which includes one month of time-based interim rates and 11 months of energy-based permanent rates. Where available, Year One results are also included to show the full year performance under the permanent RS 4100 rates.

⁵ Refer to Order No. G-67-24, pages 27 to 28.

changes effective on that same date,⁶ the combined rate increase would be 8.9% or an average increase of \$0.76⁷ per charging session. BC Hydro is not proposing any changes to the Level 2 charging rate, Idle Fee or any other terms and conditions of RS 4100.

As discussed further in the sections below, the Year One Evaluation Report shows:⁸

- The revenue to cost ratio (**R/C Ratio**) for fiscal 2025 (i.e., April 1, 2024 to March 31, 2025) was 45%. The forecast R/C Ratio for fiscal 2025 in the Application was 84%. Due to the relatively smaller scale of the Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service in earlier years, this discrepancy equates to approximately \$7.4 million in additional cost under-recovery in fiscal 2025. The discrepancy is primarily due to higher than forecast financing costs and operating and maintenance costs and lower recognized revenue from provincial Low Carbon Fuel Credits (**LCFC**) and federal Clean Fuel Regulations Credits (**CFRC**). The change in how CFRC revenues are recognized is particularly impactful, deferring approximately \$88 million in revenue outside of the 10-year levelized recovery period.⁹
- The updated forecast 10-year R/C Ratio is 98.7%. The forecast 10-year R/C ratio in the Application was 99.5%. This cumulative discrepancy equates to approximately \$2.4 million. Over the 10-year period, higher operating and maintenance costs and lower LCFC and CFRC revenue are forecast to

⁶ https://docs.b cuc.com/documents/orders/2025/doc_80826_g-76-25-bch-f2026-f2027-rra-final.pdf.

⁷ Based on a fiscal 2026 estimated average customer bill of \$8.45 before sales tax.

⁸ BC Hydro incorporated all updates into the 10-year rate model submitted with the BCUC on December 15, 2024 (**Original Rate Model**) and developed a new cost recovery forecast (**2025 Rate Model**). The 2025 Rate Model is provided as [Appendix A](#). The Original Rate Model is provided as Attachment 1 to Exhibit B-11 (https://docs.b cuc.com/documents/proceedings/2023/doc_75413_b-11-bch-srp-undertakings-responses-public.pdf).

⁹ Federal Clean Fuel Regulations Credits were referred to as federal LCFC in the Application. As discussed further in section [3.2.2](#) below, the value of LCFCs has decreased. While the value of CFRCs has increased, the revenue from CFRCs must be allocated to offset capital costs and amortized over the asset life to align with the requirements from Canada's *Clean Fuel Regulations*. Due to an oversight, BC Hydro did not recognize CFRC revenue this way in the Application and instead recognized it in the year it was earned. This correction decreases recognized revenue from CFRCs in fiscal 2025 and over the 10-year levelized period.

continue but are offset by lower forecast costs for a reduced deployment plan and by lower financing costs due to applying BC Hydro's weighted average cost of debt (**WACD**) instead of the higher Weighted Average Cost of Capital (**WACC**).¹⁰

- Revenues from Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service are now expected to exceed costs starting in fiscal 2030 which is two years earlier than forecast in the Application (fiscal 2032). However, the cumulative cost under-recovery between fiscal 2025 and fiscal 2029 is now forecast to be approximately \$66 million compared to the Application forecast of \$26 million. In other words, the cost under-recovery in the earlier years is steeper but shorter. This is because the factors driving increased cost under-recovery are recognized immediately while the impacts of the reduced deployment plan that offset this under recovery are recognized over time.
- BC Hydro's RS 4100 fast charging rate is at the lower end when compared to other public EV charging service providers' fast charging rates. BC Hydro's Level 2 charging rate is slightly higher than the mid-point rate of most other Level 2 charging service providers. BC Hydro's Idle Fee is similar to other public EV charging service providers.

A 5% increase to the fast-charging rates set out in RS 4100, effective April 1, 2026 (i.e., fiscal 2027), is forecast to raise an additional \$17.4 million in revenue from fiscal 2027 to fiscal 2033, improving the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio from 98.7% to 101.7%. When this increase is combined with the approved fiscal 2027 general rate changes, BC Hydro's fast charging rate would be 39.32 cents per kWh which is higher than the low-point rate of key providers such as FLO, Tesla, SWTCH and

¹⁰ As discussed further in section [3.2.3](#), the Application's approach of applying the WACC to the financing costs associated with BC Hydro's Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service was incorrect. The WACD should have been applied since BC Hydro does not earn a return on equity from its investments in Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service.

ChargePoint but remains below the overall mid-point.¹¹ BC Hydro submits that this proposed increase is reasonable because it restores the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio to approximately 100% and results in a fast-charging rate that is comparable to other providers, helping to maintain a level playing field for exempted public utilities providing public EV charging services in B.C. A higher rate increase than what is proposed would be unreasonable because a higher increase is not required to maintain a forecast R/C ratio of 100% and because, when combined with the approved fiscal 2027 general rate changes, it could exceed the level generally considered by the Commission to be rate shock.¹²

This Year One Evaluation Report also proposes the timing of the next evaluation report in accordance with Order No. G-67-24¹³ that the next Evaluation Report be filed by no later than August 31, 2027 (i.e., two years from now). BC Hydro submits that an earlier (i.e., one year from now) deadline would not be appropriate because it would provide insufficient time for any meaningful developments to occur while a later deadline (i.e., beyond two years) could increase the risk of cost under-recovery or over-recovery given the extent to which various factors have fluctuated during Year One and could continue to do so. However, if circumstances dictate (e.g., BC Hydro receives indications that forecast cost recovery is worsening), BC Hydro would accelerate the filing of the next Evaluation Report so that it could inform whether any adjustments should be made to fiscal 2028 rates.

¹¹ Refer to [Appendix D](#), page 8, Figure 2.

In several decisions, the BCUC has confirmed that a greater than 10% change in rates per annum is generally considered to be rate shock. For example, refer to page 19 of Order No. G-213-21 (https://docs.bcuc.com/documents/other/2021/doc_63416_decision-g-213-21-kpl-rra.pdf), page 7 of Order No. G-222-21 (<https://www.ordersdecisions.bcuc.com/bcuc/decisions/en/500701/1/document.do>), and page 21 of Order No. G-334-23 (https://docs.bcuc.com/documents/other/2023/doc_75239_g-334-23-fei-2024-annualreview-deliveryrates-decision.pdf).

¹³ Refer to Order No. G-67-24, page 28.

1.1 Concordance with Order No. G-67-24

Order No. G-67-24 directed BC Hydro to include several items in this Year One Evaluation Report. [Table 1](#) below provides a concordance table that shows where each of these items are addressed.¹⁴

Table 1 Concordance with Order No. G-67-24

Evaluation Item	Decision Reference	Evaluation Result	Report Reference
The performance of the rates for public EV charging service, including the extent of cost recovery, charging session revenue, and extended stay charge revenue	Page 25	The R/C Ratio for fiscal 2025 was 45%. The forecast R/C Ratio for fiscal 2025 in the Application was 84%. The updated forecast 10-year R/C Ratio is 98.7%. The forecast 10-year R/C ratio in the Application was 99.5%.	Section 4 for Fiscal 2025 Section 5 for the 10-year period
Public EV charging service statistics, such as station utilization rates, estimated low carbon fuel credit revenue, and customer satisfaction metrics	Page 25	Key modelling input updates such as station utilization rates and estimated LCFC and CFRC revenue have been included in the updated 2025 Rate Model. Customer satisfaction increased by 2%, reaching 80%.	Section 3.2.2 Section 4.2.3 Section 5.4.1 Section 3.1.5 Appendix C
Progress and updates on BC Hydro's deployment plan and on converting time-based rates to energy-based rate	Page 25	BC Hydro successfully transitioned from time-based rates to energy-based rates on May 1, 2024. BC Hydro has reduced its 10 year EV charging station deployment plan. The reduction is primarily driven by planned reduction in the number of Level 2 charging station deployments. In fiscal 2025, BC Hydro tripled the size of its public EV charging network, increasing the total number of ports from 173 to 591. This was lower than the original fiscal 2025 plan of 828 ports.	Section 3.1.2 Section 3.2.1
Could include a request to the BCUC for approval of adjustment(s) to the public EV charging rates depending on how cost recovery is tracking relative to the assumptions in the Application	Page 25	BC Hydro proposes a 5% increase to the fast charging rate effective April 1, 2026. There is no proposed change to the Level 2 charging rate, Idle Fee or any other RS 4100 terms and conditions.	Section 7.1

¹⁴ Refer to Order No. G-67-24, page 28.

Evaluation Item	Decision Reference	Evaluation Result	Report Reference
A recommendation as to when the next evaluation report should be filed	Page 25	BC Hydro proposes to submit an evaluation report on its Public EV Charging Service by no later than August 31, 2027.	Section 7.2
Details for cost of NACS connectors that BC Hydro is planning to adopt on new equipment orders as well as for retro-fitting existing charging stations	Page 28	BC Hydro has been deploying NACS connectors at new charging sites. The retrofitting cost is similar to the estimate presented in the Application proceeding. There is an incremental cost to purchase new charging stations with NACS connectors.	Section 3.1.3
Network platform upgrade costs	Page 28	BC Hydro completed its network platform upgrade in January 2024 at an estimated cost of \$1.08 million.	Section 3.1.1
Update regarding the value of low carbon fuel credits	Page 28	The value of Provincial LCFCs has decreased. The value of Federal CFRCs has increased. CFRC revenue is now being allocated to offset capital costs instead of being recognized as revenue in the year it is earned to align with the requirements from Canada's <i>Clean Fuel Regulations</i> .	Section 3.2.2
Update on energy-based cost (in ¢/kWh) of the greater-than-200 kW stations and Information on congestion experienced at higher power level stations	Page 28	BC Hydro has not deployed a dedicated charging port with greater than 200 kW output. The average cost information is not available yet.	Section 3.2.1
Information on whether the extended stay charge should apply to public Level 2 chargers to alleviate congestion	Page 28	BC Hydro has not observed congestion at Level 2 charging stations and submits that Idle Fee continues to not be warranted for Level 2 charging stations.	Section 3.2.6
An updated survey of Level 2 and fast charging rates offered by other EV service providers in BC Hydro's service area. ¹⁵	Page 28	BC Hydro's fast charging rate is higher than the low-point of some key providers but lower than the overall mid-point of all service providers. BC Hydro's Level 2 charging rate is slightly higher than the average mid-point of other service providers.	Section 6 Appendix D

¹⁵ On page 28 of Decision and Order No. G-67-24, the BCUC stated: "To address whether the Proposed Rates are competitive, a comparison of BC Hydro fast charging service rates with other operators will assist the BCUC in evaluating and understanding the potential impact on exempted public utility providers in the EV charging service market."

Evaluation Item	Decision Reference	Evaluation Result	Report Reference
Update on cost recovery showing the R/C ratios and any impacts on other ratepayer groups	Page 28	The updated forecast 10-year R/C ratio decreased from 99.5% to 98.7%. BC Hydro's proposed 5% increase to fast charging rate will restore the forecast 10-year R/C ratio to approximately 100%.	Section 5 Section 7.1

1.2 Structure of Report

This Year One Evaluation Report is organized as follows:

- Section [2](#) provides background information on BC Hydro's Public EV Charging Service;
- Section [3](#) describes updates to BC Hydro's Public EV Charging Service;
- Section [4](#) provides actual costs and revenues for fiscal 2025;
- Section [5](#) provides updated forecast costs and revenues for the 10-year levelized period;
- Section [6](#) provides a jurisdictional review of rates of other EV charging service providers in B.C. and other comparable jurisdictions;
- Section [7](#) explains BC Hydro's proposed increase to RS 4100 fast charging rates and our proposal for the timing of the next Evaluation Report;
- [Appendix A](#) provides the updated Working Excel Rate Model that shows the updated cost recovery forecast based on various input updates;
- [Appendix B](#) includes sample customer communications from when BC Hydro transitioned from time-based rates to energy-based rates;
- [Appendix C](#) provides BC Hydro's survey on Public EV Charging Service conducted in November 2024;
- [Appendix D](#) provides the updated public EV charging service jurisdictional review conducted by Ernst & Young; and

- [Appendix E](#) provides a public report announcing completion of the B.C. Electric Highway and the tripling of the size of BC Hydro's public EV charging network.

2 Background

On July 28, 2023, pursuant to the BCUC Order Nos. G-18-22¹⁶ and G-391-22¹⁷ on BC Hydro's Public Electric Vehicle Fast Charging Rate Application submitted in March 2021,¹⁸ BC Hydro filed the Application and proposed a new energy-based rates RS 4100 to replace time-based RS 1360, 1560 and 1561. On March 13, 2024, the BCUC issued Order No. G-67-24 approving the permanent energy-based rates RS 4100, which were forecast to recover the full cost of BC Hydro's Public EV Charging Service on a 10-year levelized basis. The BCUC also approved a new Idle Fee to encourage customers to move their vehicles after a charging session is completed to mitigate potential congestion at stations. BC Hydro was directed to complete the transition to permanent energy-based rates by June 1, 2024. The permanent energy-based rates became effective May 1, 2024.

Order No. G-67-24 directed BC Hydro to submit an Evaluation Report by August 31, 2025.

3 Updates to BC Hydro's Public EV Charging Service

This section describes updates to BC Hydro's Public EV Charging Service including activities since the Application and updates to key inputs and assumptions based on decisions and observations in fiscal 2025.

3.1 Activities Since the Application

This section describes activities since the Application; specifically, a network platform upgrade (section [3.1.1](#)), the successful transition to energy-based rates

¹⁶ https://docs.bcuc.com/documents/other/2022/doc_65431_g-18-22-bch-ev-fast-charging-rates-decision.pdf.

¹⁷ https://docs.bcuc.com/documents/other/2022/doc_69392_g-391-22-extension-request.pdf.

¹⁸ https://docs.bcuc.com/documents/proceedings/2021/doc_61620_b-1-bch-ev-fc-rate-application.pdf.

(section [3.1.2](#)), the roll out of the North American Charging Standard (**NACS**) Connector (section [3.1.3](#)), BC Hydro's first Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service rate pilot (section [3.1.4](#)) and a November 2025 customer satisfaction survey (section [3.1.5](#)).

3.1.1 Network Platform Upgrade

BC Hydro completed its network platform¹⁹ upgrade between October 2023 and January 2024²⁰ to support an expanded network and to introduce key service enhancements that could not be supported by the original network platform, including billing based on energy-based rates.²¹

The total cost of the network platform upgrade was approximately \$1.08 million, compared to the original forecast of \$0.4 million in the Original Rate Model. The cost variance was primarily due to under-estimated new network platform setup costs prior to completing the procurement process, as well as unplanned implementation costs related to charging station migration, software updates required for all FLO charging stations (BC Hydro's older charging station models),²² data migration, enhanced risk and control assessments and cybersecurity evaluation.

While the one-time network platform upgrade cost was higher than the original estimate, the new contract included a lower than estimated network transaction cost (i.e., approximately █% instead of █% assumed in the Original Rate Model). The updated network platform upgrade cost and network transaction fee are included in the updated operating and maintenance costs in the 2025 Rate Model.

¹⁹ The network platform is a core IT system that manages BC Hydro's EV charging network. It communicates with and manages EV chargers remotely, tracks all charging sessions and relevant data, stores customer profiles and validates customers, provides information to the BC Hydro EV mobile app and bills customers.

²⁰ The network platform upgrade took place in fiscal 2024. It was completed after the evidentiary record was closed for the Application proceeding.

²¹ Exhibit B-1, section 5.4, page 5-40.

²² FLO supplied fast charging stations required a software update to ensure full compliance with latest Open Charge Point Protocol (**OCPP**) before integration with the new network platform.

The network platform upgrade investment included the following components:

- Server and platform setup, configuration and customization;
- Migration of charging stations and customers from the previous platform;
- Off-boarding of the previous vendor and data cleanup;
- Development of branding, visual design and customer email communication templates;
- Implementation of a new support/ticket management tool;
- Call centre training;
- Customer communications; and
- Project management.

The new network platform supports energy-based billing and the Idle Fee implementation and improves customer communications and system administration capabilities. The new platform is hardware-agnostic, allowing compatibility with a wide range of charger makes and models. It also includes an updated BC Hydro EV mobile app for customers.

3.1.2 Successful Transition to Energy-Based Rates

On May 1, 2024, BC Hydro successfully transitioned from interim time-based rates (as set out in RS 1360, 1560, 1561, 4100) to permanent energy-based rates (as set out in RS 4100) for its Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service.

To facilitate this transition, BC Hydro executed a comprehensive implementation plan to ensure customer awareness, system readiness, and operational continuity. Key activities included:

- **Measurement Canada dispensation:** Secured authorization for all applicable charging stations to bill by kilowatt-hour (kWh);

-
- **Customer communications:** Distributed updated materials and informed customers of the change to energy-based billing. Refer to [Appendix B](#) for examples of customer communications;
 - **Network platform configuration and enablement:** Enabled billing for energy-based rates and the Idle Fee in the EV network platform administration system and mobile app;
 - **Contact centre readiness:** Trained customer service representatives and other support staff to assist customers with inquiries related to the new rates;
 - **Third-party listing updates:** Refreshed rate information on external platforms such as PlugShare and ChargeHub; and
 - **Physical signage:** Replaced physical pricing labels at charging station sites to reflect the updated energy-based rates.

3.1.3 North American Charging Standard (NACS) Connector Roll-Out

In fiscal 2025, BC Hydro began integrating North American Charging Standard (NACS) connectors, historically known as the Tesla connector and now formally designated as SAE²³ J3400, into its public EV charging network.

Among BC Hydro's current installed and procured public EV charging stations, only the ABB T184 (dual port 180 kW) model deployed in the field and the ABB A400 (dual port 400 kW) model scheduled for installation in fiscal 2026 are capable of being configured with NACS cables and connectors. The configuration currently is carried out either by retrofitting with NACS cables in BC Hydro's warehouse prior to installation, or by procuring new charging stations directly from the manufacturer with NACS cables pre-installed.

²³ Society of Automobile Engineers (SAE).

Retrofitting an existing ABB T184 charger not deployed in the field with a NACS cable and connector costs approximately [REDACTED], including parts and standard technician labour. For chargers in the field, there are potential additional expenses for travel, logistics and lodging depending on site location. These costs are close to BC Hydro's previous estimate of \$7,500 presented during the review of the Application.²⁴

Purchasing a new ABB T184 equipment configured with NACS + CCS²⁵ connectors currently costs approximately [REDACTED] more than the CCS + CCS variant,²⁶ compared to BC Hydro's previous assumption of no incremental cost. This incremental cost is included in the updated average per port capital cost of new charging stations in the 2025 Rate Model.

BC Hydro's NACS deployment strategy focuses on newly installed stations. Where feasible, all new BC Hydro hub sites started to include at least one NACS charging port from the third quarter of fiscal 2025. By the end of fiscal 2025, a total of 11 sites and 19 charging stations (representing 21 ports) were available with NACS connectors.

To date, the number of new non-Tesla EVs manufactured with NACS connectors has been limited and the roll out of this new connector standard has been behind industry expectations. Accordingly, BC Hydro has not undertaken retrofits of chargers already deployed in the field. For fiscal 2026, BC Hydro will continue to deploy at least one NACS connector at every hub site and will closely monitor usage and vehicle manufacturer trends to assess if the demand for NACS connectors increases. If usage patterns increase and/or market conditions change, we will update our NACS deployment and retrofit plan accordingly to meet customer needs.

²⁴ Exhibit B-9, Slide 7.

²⁵ NACS + CCS means both a NACS connector and a CCS "Combined Charging System" socket and connector which incorporates both AC and DC current pins. Up until 2025, CCS was the standard used by most vehicle manufacturers prior to moving to NACS connectors going forward.

²⁶ CCS + CCS means two CCS connectors.

3.1.4 First Rate Pilot

On June 13, 2025, BC Hydro submitted its first rate pilot project application under the expedited review framework established by Order No. G-275-24.²⁷ The pilot application proposed a one-month, 50% discount at selected public EV charging sites to evaluate the effectiveness of temporary price reductions in enhancing customer awareness, influencing charging behaviour, and increasing site usage. On July 3, 2025, the BCUC issued Order No. G-166-25,²⁸ approving the pilot. The pilot is funded through the \$6.5 million marketing budget approved as part of the Public EV Charging Service Rates.

BC Hydro implemented the pilot starting August 1, 2025 and will submit an evaluation form to the BCUC by February 27, 2026. BC Hydro expects to submit additional pilot applications to the BCUC in due course.

3.1.5 Customer Experience and Satisfaction

In November 2024, BC Hydro conducted its fifth annual Public EV Charging Customer Survey, receiving responses from 1,813 participants. Survey responses were from BC Hydro EV network members (whom BC Hydro has contact information for) but did not include roaming²⁹ customers who are anonymous to BC Hydro.

[Appendix C](#) provides the full survey results. Key findings from the survey include:

- **Overall satisfaction:** Overall satisfaction with BC Hydro's Public EV Charging Service increased by 2%, reaching 80%;

²⁷ https://docs.bcuc.com/documents/other/2024/doc_79004_g-275-24-bch-public-ev-charging-review-framework-final.pdf.

²⁸ https://docs.bcuc.com/documents/other/2025/doc_82619_g-166-25-bch-public-ev-charging-service-rates-pilot-final.pdf.

²⁹ Examples of roaming customers on the BC Hydro EV network include users via other networks such as FLO, Hypercharge and SWTCH who use their third-party app to activate BC Hydro charging stations.

- **Preference for fast charging:** Fast charging remains the top reason customers use BC Hydro stations. Notably, 68% of customers who participated in the survey prefer faster chargers, even at a higher cost;
- **Minimal impact from transition to energy-based rates:** The shift to energy-based pricing has had limited influence on user behavior, with 80% of respondents reporting no change, while 9% indicated a decrease in their use of BC Hydro chargers. However, customers still express that energy-based pricing is important to them with 67% of respondents rating it as an important pricing method; and
- **Idle Fee:** Among those aware of the Idle Fee, about 29% reported an improvement of charging experience, primarily due to reduced congestion and quicker access to charging stations. 69% of the respondents said their experience using BC Hydro's Public EV Charging Service had not noticeably changed since the implementation of the Idle Fee.

3.2 Updates to Key Inputs and Assumptions

This section describes updates to key inputs and assumptions based on decisions and observations in fiscal 2025; specifically, updates to BC Hydro's deployment plan (section [3.2.1](#)), updated LCFC and CFRC revenue forecasts (section [3.2.2](#)), updated financing costs (section [3.2.3](#)), observed station utilization (section [3.2.4](#)), observed dispensed energy and session duration at stations (section [3.2.5](#)) and observed congestion at stations (section [3.2.6](#)).

3.2.1 Updated Deployment Plan

BC Hydro has updated its 10-year EV charging station deployment plan. Key updates include:

- **Reduced Deployment:** The overall planned number of stations has been reduced by approximately 40% from approximately 3,300 ports by fiscal 2033 to approximately 1,900 ports by fiscal 2033. This reduction is primarily driven by a

reduction in the deployment of Level 2 charging stations from approximately 1,250 by fiscal 2033 to approximately 225 by fiscal 2033.

BC Hydro has decided to significantly reduce its Level 2 charging station deployment plan because of higher than expected Level 2 station installation costs and relatively low revenue per charging port. Although Level 2 charging stations have lower equipment costs than fast charging stations, the total costs per Level 2 port including design, construction and service connection costs are higher than expected. In addition, Level 2 charging is now more widely available through other public EV charging service providers, which reduces the need for BC Hydro investment in this area.

- **Near-term Focus on Completion of BC Electric Highway:** The Original Rate Model assumed a static split of 78% urban ports and 22% non-urban ports in each year during the 10-year period. The updated 2025 Rate Model reflects the currently planned ramp up of urban ports, which is expected to reach 78% by fiscal 2031. This adjustment accounts for the initial build-up of non-urban ports driven by the completion of the B.C. Electric Highway, discussed further below. As a result, the proportion of urban ports, which are expected to generate higher revenue, is lower in the earlier years but increases in later years.
- **Focus on Dual-Port Charging Stations:** BC Hydro has established dual port charging stations, particularly dual port 180 kW charging stations, as our standard charging station model moving forward. BC Hydro had not deployed dual port charging stations at the time of the Application. After installing over 150 dual port charging stations since February 2024, we have determined that dual port stations are significantly more cost-effective than single port charging stations on a per port basis. When used by a single vehicle capable of receiving high power, the station can deliver up to the full kW charging station capacity. In addition, the shift to a standardized dual port charging station

provides economies of scale for both procurement and maintenance, improving operational efficiency.

- **Greater than 200 kW Ports:** BC Hydro has not deployed charging stations with dedicated ports rated above 200 kW to date.³⁰ BC Hydro does not plan to install greater than 200 kW charging ports in the near future except for limited use cases such as at major highway corridors, where dual port 400 kW charging stations may be deployed to match anticipated dwell times. Therefore, there is no available information on average per kWh costs for these stations to report yet. Charging stations with dedicated greater than 200 kW ports require much higher deployment costs as we have learned from recent installations, and do not appear to be cost effective at this time. BC Hydro will continue to monitor the development of charging station technology, battery technology and market conditions and will update its deployment plan with regard to greater than 200 kW charging ports, as appropriate.

[Table 2](#) below provides a summary of the actual fiscal 2024, planned fiscal 2025 and actual fiscal 2025 number of charging ports by region and by power level.³¹ As shown, to-date, the number of fast charging stations deployed has exceeded the planned numbers; however, significantly less Level 2 charging stations have been deployed due to the reasons discussed above. Specifically, in fiscal 2025, BC Hydro tripled the size of its public EV charging network, increasing the total number of ports from 173 to 591 (499 fast-charging ports and 92 Level 2 charging ports) which was lower than the original fiscal 2025 plan of 828 ports (403 fast-charging ports and 425 Level 2 charging ports).

³⁰ BC Hydro has deployed a small number of dual port 350 kW and 400 kW charging stations. For planning purposes, they are deemed as two 175 kW ports and two 200 kW ports, respectively.

³¹ BC Hydro notes that no additional ports were installed during April 2025. There were the same number of ports by the end of Year One as fiscal 2025.

**Table 2 BC Hydro Public EV Charging Network
Fiscal 2025 Year End Port Counts by
Power Level**

Region	Power per Port (kW)	F2024 Actual (A)	F2025 Plan (B)	F2025 and Year One Actual (C)	Variance (C – B)
Urban	7 (Level 2) ³²	-	380	53	(327)
Urban	Up to 25 kW Fast Charging	-	-	-	0
Urban	Greater than 25 kW and less than or equal to 50 kW Fast Charging	50	52	50	(2)
Urban	Greater than 50 kW and less than or equal to 100 kW Fast Charging	14	154	162	8
Urban	Greater than 100 kW and less than or equal to 200 kW Fast Charging	-	12	4	(8)
Urban	Greater than 200 kW	-	2	-	(2)
Total Fast Charging Port in Urban		64	220	216	(4)
Total Fast Charging + Level 2 Ports in Urban		64	600	269	(331)
Non-Urban	7 (Level 2)	3	45	39	(6)
Non-Urban	Up to 25 kW Fast Charging	9	9	9	0
Non-Urban	Greater than 25 kW and less than or equal to 50 kW Fast Charging	75	70	82	12
Non-Urban	Greater than 50 kW and less than or equal to 100 kW Fast Charging	22	90	190	100
Non-Urban	Greater than 100 kW and less than or equal to 200 kW Fast Charging	-	12	2	(10)

³² BC Hydro's Level 2 charging stations are listed as 7 kW in the Original and 2025 Rate Models, but the power level may range between 7 kW to 19 kW depending on specific configuration of the site.

Region	Power per Port (kW)	F2024 Actual (A)	F2025 Plan (B)	F2025 and Year One Actual (C)	Variance (C – B)
Non-Urban	Greater than 200 kW	-	2	-	(2)
Total Fast Charging Ports in Non-Urban		106	183	283	100
Total Fast Charging + Level 2 Ports in Non-Urban		109	228	322	94
Total Fast Charging Ports		170	403	499	94
Total Fast Charging + Level 2 Ports		173	828	591	(237)

[Table 3](#) below provides the original deployment plan and the updated deployment plan by fiscal 2031 and by fiscal 2033.³³

In the original deployment plan, BC Hydro planned for moderate network growth after fiscal 2031. However, at this current time, BC Hydro is assuming that it will not expand its public EV charging network for light-duty vehicles after fiscal 2031. The updated deployment plan includes only sustainment replacements for end-of-life stations beyond fiscal 2031. This reflects our current expectation that market conditions will not require further expansion of the BC Hydro’s network after fiscal 2031 and aligns with the ending of prescribed undertakings for public EV charging by utilities in the Greenhouse Gas Reduction (Clean Energy) Regulation on December 31, 2030. BC Hydro will continue to review its deployment plan annually and update it as appropriate.

³³ The full updated deployment plan is available in the “Deployment Plan” tab of the 2025 Rate Model in [Appendix A](#).

Table 3 **Number of Planned Ports in Fiscal 2031 and 2033**

Region	Power (kW)	Fiscal 2031			Fiscal 2033		
		Original	Update	Difference	Original	Update	Difference
Urban	7						
Urban	25 ³⁴						
Urban	50						
Urban	75 ³⁵						
Urban	90 ³⁶						
Urban	100						
Urban	175 ³⁷						
Urban	180						
Urban	200 ³⁸						
Urban	350						
Non-urban	7						
Non-urban	25						
Non-urban	50						
Non-urban	75						
Non-urban	90						
Non-urban	100						
Non-urban	175						
Non-urban	180						
Non-urban	200						
Non-urban	350						
Total		3,175	1,900	(1,275)	3,305	1,900	(1,405)

³⁴ 25 kW are single-port chargers deployed in limited circumstances and expected to be phased out over time.

³⁵ 75 kW are one of two ports of dual-port 120 kW, 150 kW battery-assist or 200 kW battery-assist chargers which are deployed in limited circumstances.

³⁶ 90 kW are one of two ports of dual-port 180 kW chargers.

³⁷ 175 kW are one of two ports of dual-port 350 kW chargers.

³⁸ 200 kW are one of two ports of dual-port 400 kW chargers.

[Table 4](#) below provides the updated planned number and proportion of urban and non-urban ports during the 10-year period.

In fiscal 2025, BC Hydro prioritized its charging station deployment to complete the B.C Electric Highway, which is the Government of B.C.’s strategic initiative to improve EV accessibility across the province through a comprehensive network of EV fast charging stations along all major highways and travel corridors’ located approximately 150 kilometres apart.³⁹

By the end of fiscal 2025, BC Hydro had deployed 114 B.C. Electric Highway charging sites with 331 ports across the province. Based on the Statistics Canada Index of Remoteness, 43 of BC Hydro’s 114 B.C. Electric Highway sites can be classified as remote or very remote.⁴⁰ The completion of the B.C. Electric Highway contributed to a higher proportion of non-urban ports to-date.

³⁹ <https://news.gov.bc.ca/releases/2024EMLI0062-001447>.

⁴⁰ Definition of Remote or Very Remote based on Statistics Canada Index of Remoteness:
<https://www150.statcan.gc.ca/n1/en/catalogue/17260001>.

**Table 4 BC Hydro Public EV Charging Network
Year End Port Counts by Area**

Fiscal Year End	Urban		Non-Urban	
	Number of Ports	Proportion of Ports (%)	Number of Ports	Proportion of Ports (%)
2024	64	37	109	63
2025	269	46	322	54
2026	████	████	████	████
2027	████	████	████	████
2028	████	████	████	████
2029	████	████	████	████
2030	████	████	████	████
2031	████	████	████	████
2032	████	████	████	████
2033	1,480	78	420	22

3.2.2 Updates to Provincial LCFC and Federal CFRC Revenues

In the updated 2025 Rate Model, most of the revenue from federal CFRCs is allocated to offset capital costs and amortized over the asset life. This aligns with the requirements from Canada's *Clean Fuel Regulations*.⁴¹ Due to an oversight, BC Hydro did not recognize CFRC revenue this way in the Application and instead recognized it in the year it was earned. This correction decreases recognized revenue from CFRCs in fiscal 2025 and over the 10-year levelized period.

In accordance with section 103(1) of *Clean Fuel Regulations*, BC Hydro determined that proceeds from CFR credits must be recognized as a contribution to capital costs. The Regulations require all public EV charging service providers, including BC Hydro, to reinvest all proceeds from CFR credits into EV infrastructure. As a result, only 20% of CFRC revenue can be recognized during the year it is earned. The remaining 80% of forecast CFRC revenue is allocated to offset capital costs,

⁴¹ <https://laws-lois.justice.gc.ca/eng/regulations/SOR-2022-140/index.html>.

amortized over the asset life of seven years. Under this approach, approximately \$88 million of the CFRC revenue earned during the 10-year period is recognized beyond fiscal 2033, which is outside of the 10-year levelized cost recovery period.

The estimated values of LCFCs and CFRCs also changed in fiscal 2025. [Table 5](#) below summarizes the updated values compared to the Original Rate Model.

Table 5 **Change in LCFC Assumptions from Application**

	Original Rate Model	2025 Rate Model
Estimated Value of Provincial LCFC (\$/Credit)	████	████
Estimated Value of Federal CFR Credit (\$/Credit)	████	████

3.2.3 Updates to Financing Costs

In the 2025 Rate Model, BC Hydro updated the financing cost interest rate applied to capital expenditures from its current WACC of 6% to its average WACD of 3.6% to align with the actual financing cost for Public EV Charging Service. In the Original Rate Model, BC Hydro applied the WACC as the financing rate applied to capital expenditures, which incorporates both return on debt and return on equity. The use of WACD aligns with actual interest cost recognized in BC Hydro’s financial statements and is applied in accordance with Special Direction 8,⁴² whereby BC Hydro currently does not collect a return on equity on capital expenditures.

In the 2025 Rate Model, BC Hydro also included additional financing costs on pre-purchase of EV charging equipment and a fiscal 2024 opening work-in-progress balance that were inadvertently not included in the Original Rate Model. Specifically:

- **Pre-Purchase of EV Charging Equipment:** The Original Rate Model assumed that all capital expenditures during a given fiscal year were in-service by the end of the year and fully depreciating by the following fiscal year. However, to support the scaling up of our public EV charging network, BC Hydro

⁴² https://www.bclaws.gov.bc.ca/civix/document/id/complete/statreg/24_2019.

pre-ordered much larger volumes of equipment to mitigate supply chain constraints and achieve price certainty. The pre-purchase of equipment and the passage of time before government funding was received resulted in a delayed start to depreciation. This resulted in higher working capital balances, leading to higher than expected financing costs.

- **Fiscal 2024 Work in Progress Balance:** There was also an opening work-in-progress balance of \$19.7 million at the beginning of fiscal 2024, which attracted financing costs but was inadvertently not included in the Original Rate Model.

3.2.4 Fiscal 2025 Station Utilization

Among the major fast charging power levels BC Hydro has deployed to date (i.e., 50 kW, 90 kW and 100 kW) and had a significant percentage of total dispensed kWh, actual fiscal 2025 average utilization rates were either higher or the same as BC Hydro's original forecasts for both urban and non-urban areas. However, Level 2 charging ports showed considerably lower utilization rates compared to BC Hydro's original forecasts.

[Table 6](#) below presents the forecasted and actual average utilization rates and includes the number of charging ports and the share of total dispensed energy across all power levels and areas.

Table 6 **Fiscal 2025 Forecast vs Actual Average Utilization per Port**

Power per Port (kW)	Actual Number of Ports Deployed	Forecast Utilization (%) (A)	Actual Utilization (%) (B)	Variance (%) (B – A)	Percentage of Total Dispensed kWh by Urban/Non-Urban (%)
Urban Area					
7 (Level 2)	53	■	■	■	■
25	-	■	■	■	■
50	50	■	■	■	■
75	8	■	■	■	■
90	138	■	■	■	■
100	16	■	■	■	■
175	4	■	■	■	■
180	-	■	■	■	■
200	-	■	■	■	■
350	-	■	■	■	■
Non-Urban Area					
7 (Level 2)	39	■	■	■	■
25	9	■	■	■	■
50	82	■	■	■	■
75	22	■	■	■	■
90	144	■ ⁴³	■	■	■
100	24	■	■	■	■
175	2	■ ⁴⁴	■	■	■
180	-	■	■	■	■
200	-	■	■	■	■
350	-	■	■	■	■

⁴³ BC Hydro previously planned to install dual port 180 kW stations (2 X 90 kW ports) in the non-urban area in fiscal 2024, therefore the assumed utilization rate in fiscal 2025 would be escalated to ■%. Dual port 180 kW stations were first installed in non-urban areas in fiscal 2025. The assumed first year utilization rate should be 2%.

⁴⁴ BC Hydro previously planned to install dual port 350 kW stations (2 X 175 kW ports) in the non-urban area in fiscal 2024, therefore the assumed utilization rate in fiscal 2025 would be escalated to ■%. Dual port 350 kW stations were first installed in non-urban areas in fiscal 2025. The assumed first year utilization rate should be 2%.

Based on the data presented in the table above, BC Hydro observes that:⁴⁵

- In fiscal 2025, the actual maximum utilization rates at BC Hydro’s urban 50 kW and 100 kW stations were ■%, due to having fewer ports than forecast per charging site, exceeding the 30% assumption of the maximum utilization rate in Original Rate Model.⁴⁶ The 30% assumption for the maximum utilization rate remains appropriate for the 90 kW ports, which are now the new primary power level under the updated deployment plan;
- BC Hydro’s assumed first year utilization rates (i.e., 12% for urban areas and 2% for non-urban areas)⁴⁷ were similar to the actual average utilization rates for 90 kW ports, the primary power level starting from fiscal 2025, which were ■% in urban areas and ■% in non-urban areas. In contrast, 75 kW and 175 kW ports, installed in smaller number later in fiscal 2025, showed lower utilization rates than BC Hydro’s original forecasts, due to their locations and shorter in-service duration; and
- Level 2 charging ports in both urban and non-urban areas had much lower utilization rates than the original forecasts. The original forecasts of 13% for urban and 8% for non-urban were based on a limited number of deployment locations. The current utilization rates of ■% urban and ■% non-urban are based on actual data for a larger number of ports and locations. BC Hydro has

⁴⁵ As discussed in section [3.2.1](#) above, BC Hydro plans to mainly deploy dual port 180 kW stations going forward. 50 kW, 90 kW and 100 kW charging ports will continue to be the dominant power levels BC Hydro offers. In addition, BC Hydro is building larger charging sites with more charging ports available at these sites. The higher maximum utilization rates observed at 50 kW and 100 kW power levels (mostly installed at smaller sites) in the urban areas may not be achieved at larger sites. Therefore, we did not update the utilization rate assumptions (i.e., first year, maximum and growth rate) in the updated 2025 Rate Model. We will continue to closely monitor utilization rates and may update these assumptions if the actual utilization rates observed vary from forecasts going forward.

⁴⁶ Refer to section 5.3.2 of the Application, pages 5-17 to 5-18.

⁴⁷ *Ibid*, page 5-17.

observed that Level 2 utilization is highly influenced by the customers' reasons for the use of the stations and location. Specifically:

- ▶ For urban Level 2 stations, utilization is assumed to be largely driven by customers' length of stay at the adjacent amenities to the charging site; and
- ▶ For non-urban Level 2 stations, the low utilization is mainly due to Level 2 stations being positioned as backups for fast charging stations.

3.2.5 Energy Dispensed and Session Duration

BC Hydro also validated the average dispensed energy per minute and average charging session duration by power level to assess the original assumptions that underpin charging port utilization rates and charging revenue forecasts.⁴⁸

[Table 7](#) below compares the average dispensed energy per minute and charging duration for each power level between the Original Rate Model and the 2025 Rate Model.⁴⁹ As shown, both average dispensed energy per minute and average charging durations are slightly higher than BC Hydro's original forecasts for all main power levels in both urban and non-urban areas, with the exception of urban Level 2 charging ports (i.e., 7 kW ports) which has a significantly higher average charging duration. This is likely driven by the deployment locations and the improvement of EV technology; specifically, newer EV models can receive higher power level charging and have bigger size batteries.

⁴⁸ In section 5.4 of the Application, BC Hydro outlined its methodology for estimating the transition from time-based to energy-based charging, based on the limited charging data available at that time. With a full year of operational data now available and a diverse deployment of EV charging stations across various power levels, BC Hydro has enhanced its understanding of average energy dispensed and session durations across different station types and power levels.

⁴⁹ For power levels that have not yet been deployed, the load assumptions remain consistent with those in the Original Rate Model

Table 7 **Change in Load Assumptions from 2023 Application**

		Dispensed Energy per Minute		Average Session Duration (Minutes)	
Region	Power	Original	Update	Original	Update
Urban	7	0.08	0.08 (no change)	████	████
Urban	25	0.29	0.29 (no change)	████	████
Urban	50	0.57	0.60	████	████
Urban	75	0.67	0.82	████	████
Urban	90	0.71	0.87	████	████
Urban	100	0.76	0.83	████	████
Urban	175	1.33	1.12	████	████
Urban	180	1.33	1.33 (no change)	████	████
Urban	200	1.33	1.33 (no change)	████	████
Urban	350	1.35	1.35 (no change)	████	████
Non-urban	7	0.08	0.09	████	████
Non-urban	25	0.29	0.31	████	████
Non-urban	50	0.57	0.60	████	████
Non-urban	75	0.67	0.95	████	████
Non-urban	90	0.71	0.89	████	████
Non-urban	100	0.76	0.82	████	████
Non-urban	175	1.33	1.35	████	████
Non-urban	180	1.33	1.33 (no change)	████	████
Non-urban	200	1.33	1.33 (no change)	████	████
Non-urban	350	1.35	1.35 (no change)	████	████

3.2.6 Congestion

BC Hydro does not currently have a technical solution to directly track congestion at public EV charging sites. To assess congestion at BC Hydro’s public EV charging stations, we used the following approach to estimate the likelihood of waiting by analyzing the time lapse between consecutive charging sessions at each station: If the time between the end of energy flow of one session and the start of the energy flow of the next session is three minutes or less, we assume for the purpose of this analysis that the next customer was already waiting in line before the charging port became available. We then calculated the probability of waiting by dividing the number of charging sessions with a three minute or less gap between charging sessions by the total number of charging sessions.

Based on this approach, on average, the likelihood for customers to wait at BC Hydro’s urban charging sites to charge (i.e., congestion) is █% and at non-urban sites, it is █%.

[Table 8](#) below shows the average monthly congestion for urban and non-urban charging stations and by charging site size in Year One. The table shows that as the number of sites and ports increases, congestion decreases. Accordingly, BC Hydro is addressing fast charging congestion through the development of additional sites with higher number of ports per site and transitioning away from two-port charging site configurations.

Table 8 Congestion by Ports per Site (Based on Three Minutes Waiting Probability)

Region	Month	1-2 Port Site Congestion (%)	3-4 Port Site Congestion (%)	5-7 Port Site Congestion (%)	HUB (8+ Ports) Congestion (%)	Total Congestion (%)	Number of Hub Sites	Number of Ports
Urban	2024-May	■	■	■ ⁵⁰	■	■	1	72
Urban	2024-Jun	■	■	■	■	■	3	96
Urban	2024-Jul	■	■	■	■	■	4	108
Urban	2024-Aug	■	■	■	■	■	4	108
Urban	2024-Sep	■	■	■	■	■	4	108
Urban	2024-Oct	■	■	■	■	■	6	134
Urban	2024-Nov	■	■	■	■	■	6	134
Urban	2024-Dec	■	■	■	■	■	7	144
Urban	2025-Jan	■	■	■	■	■	10	184
Urban	2025-Feb	■	■	■	■	■	14	233
Urban	2025-Mar	■	■	■	■	■	16	261
Urban	2025-Apr	■	■	■	■	■	16	261
Urban Total		■	■	■	■	■		
Non-Urban	2024-May	■	■	■	■	■	0	111
Non-Urban	2024-Jun	■	■	■	■	■	0	115
Non-Urban	2024-Jul	■	■	■	■	■	0	129
Non-Urban	2024-Aug	■	■	■	■	■	0	162
Non-Urban	2024-Sep	■	■	■	■	■	0	219
Non-Urban	2024-Oct	■	■	■	■	■	0	234
Non-Urban	2024-Nov	■	■	■	■	■	1	259
Non-Urban	2024-Dec	■	■	■	■	■	1	262

⁵⁰ N/A refers to no sites existing with the given number of ports, or lack of data available due to new deployments.

Region	Month	1-2 Port Site Congestion (%)	3-4 Port Site Congestion (%)	5-7 Port Site Congestion (%)	HUB (8+ Ports) Congestion (%)	Total Congestion (%)	Number of Hub Sites	Number of Ports
Non-Urban	2025-Jan	■	■	■	■	■	2	270
Non-Urban	2025-Feb	■	■	■	■	■	3	281
Non-Urban	2025-Mar	■	■	■	■	■	6	330
Non-Urban	2025-Apr	■	■	■	■	■	6	330
Non-Urban Total		■	■	■	■	■		
Grand Total		■	■	■	■	■		

BC Hydro has not observed congestion at Level 2 charging stations. As of August 2025, BC Hydro has two dedicated Level 2 charging sites in operation totaling 31 ports. The average congestion of these two Level 2 sites is approximately █%. Most of BC Hydro's Level 2 charging stations are co-located at fast charging sites and have relatively low utilization rates. In addition, BC Hydro has not received feedback from customers asking for Idle Fees for Level 2 and, as discussed in section [6](#) below, most other Level 2 charging service providers do not have idle fees. Accordingly, in BC Hydro's view, an Idle Fee on Level 2 charging stations continues to not be warranted.

[Table 9](#) below shows the percentage of charging sessions that incurred Idle Fees by month and area. The Idle Fee for fast charging ports was launched in May 2024 and applied to 2.8% of urban sessions and 3.1% of non-urban sessions in the first month. It then stabilized to 1.8% of sessions on average at the end of Year One. In BC Hydro's view, the reduction indicates that the Idle Fee is achieving the intended customer behaviour, motivating customers to move their vehicle as soon as possible after charging to mitigate congestion and to provide opportunities for other customers to charge.

The percentage of sessions incurring Idle Fees was lower than BC Hydro's original 5% assumption. The average Idle Fee duration was 16 minutes (excluding the 5-minute grace period), which was higher than the 5-minute duration assumed in the Application. As discussed in section [5.3.4](#) below, the 2025 Rate Model was updated to reflect these differences.

Table 9 Congestion by Ports per Site (Based on Three Minutes Waiting Probability)

Region	Month	% of Session Idle Fee Applies
Urban	2024-May	2.8
Urban	2024-Jun	2.2
Urban	2024-Jul	2.0
Urban	2024-Aug	1.8
Urban	2024-Sep	1.7
Urban	2024-Oct	1.4
Urban	2024-Nov	1.5
Urban	2024-Dec	1.6
Urban	2025-Jan	1.5
Urban	2025-Feb	1.6
Urban	2025-Mar	1.7
Urban	2025-Apr	1.9
Urban Total		1.7
Non-Urban	2024-May	3.1
Non-Urban	2024-Jun	2.3
Non-Urban	2024-Jul	2.1
Non-Urban	2024-Aug	2.1
Non-Urban	2024-Sep	2.3
Non-Urban	2024-Oct	2.2
Non-Urban	2024-Nov	1.9
Non-Urban	2024-Dec	1.7
Non-Urban	2025-Jan	1.6
Non-Urban	2025-Feb	1.8
Non-Urban	2025-Mar	2.0
Non-Urban	2025-Apr	2.2
Non-Urban Total		2.1
Grand Total		1.8

As discussed in section [3.2.6](#) below, among those customers aware of the Idle Fee, approximately 30% reported an improvement in their charging experience, primarily due to reduced congestion and quicker access to chargers.⁵¹ The

⁵¹ Refer to page 21 of [Appendix C](#).

remaining 69% indicated it had no impact on their experience using BC Hydro's Public EV Charging Service.

4 Fiscal 2025 Cost Recovery Results

This section sets out actual costs and revenues for BC Hydro's Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service for fiscal 2025.

4.1 Overview of Fiscal 2025 Results

The R/C Ratio for fiscal 2025 (i.e., April 1, 2024 to March 31, 2025) was 45%. The forecast R/C Ratio for fiscal 2025 in the Application was 84%. Due to the relatively smaller scale of the Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service in earlier years, this discrepancy equates to approximately \$7.4 million in additional cost under-recovery in fiscal 2025. The discrepancy is primarily due to higher than forecast financing costs and operating and maintenance costs and lower recognized revenue from provincial LCFCs and federal CFRCs.

[Table 10](#) below compares the forecast fiscal 2025 revenue and cost items against the actual fiscal 2025 and actual Year One results.

Table 10 **Fiscal 2025 and Year One Cost Recovery Assessment**

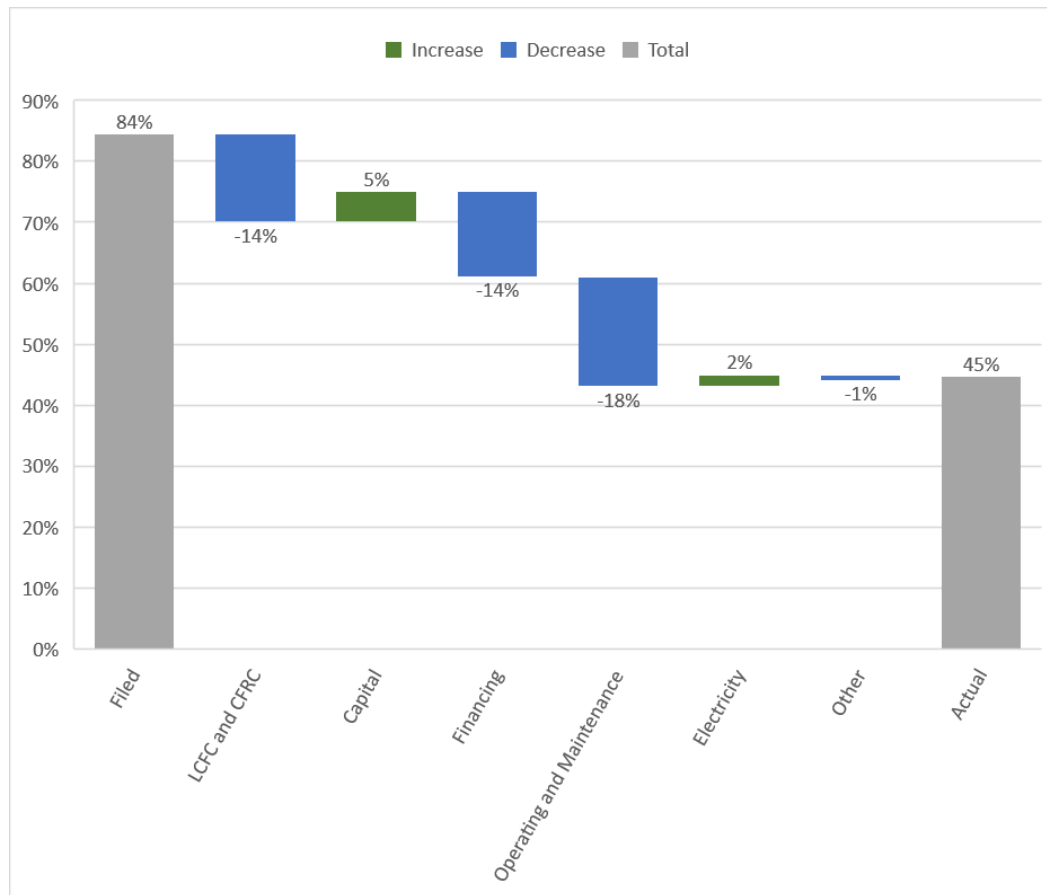
	Original Rate Model F2025 Forecast (A)	Actual F2025 Results (B)	Actual Year One Results (C)	Variance (B - A)
Revenue (\$ million)				
• Electric Vehicle Charging	6.1	4.9	5.2	(1.2)
• Idle Fee	0.1	0.04	0.05	(0.06)
• LCFC – Provincial	4.8	2.5 ⁵²	2.6 ⁵²	(2.3)
• CFRC – Federal	1.1	0.5 ⁵³	0.6 ⁵³	(0.6)
Total Revenue	12.1	8.0	8.3	(4.1)
Cost (\$ million)				
• Capital (Depreciation)	2.7	1.3	1.6	(1.4)
• Finance	1.0	3.1	3.3	2.1
• Operating and Maintenance	6.3	10.4	10.8	4.1
• Electricity	4.0	2.6	2.8	(1.4)
• Previous Years' • Under-Recovery	0.1	0.1	0.1	-
• Marketing	0.1			(0.1)
Total Costs	14.3	17.5	18.6	3.2
Surplus/(Deficiency)	(2.2)	(9.6)	(10.3)	(7.4)
R/C (%)	84%	45%	45%	(39%)

[Figure 1](#) illustrates the key variances between the original fiscal 2025 forecasts and the actual Year One results.

⁵² Estimated value of provincial LCFC earned during the reporting period. Actual value may vary based on prevailing market prices once credits are issued after the end of each calendar year.

⁵³ Estimated value of federal CFR credits earned during the reporting period.

Figure 1 Variance Explanation of Revenue to Cost Ratio by Major Factors



4.2 Fiscal 2025 Revenues

This section sets out actual revenues for BC Hydro's Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service for fiscal 2025.

4.2.1 EV Charging Revenue

In the Original Rate Model, BC Hydro forecasted \$6.1 million in charging revenue in fiscal 2025. The actual fiscal 2025 charging revenue was \$4.9 million. As discussed in section [3.2.1](#) above, in fiscal 2025, BC Hydro installed a lower number of Level 2 charging ports and a higher portion of non-urban ports, which had lower usage, compared to the original deployment plan. This resulted in less energy dispensed and lower revenue.

4.2.2 Idle Fee Revenue

In the Original Rate Model, BC Hydro forecasted \$0.11 million in Extended Stay Charge (i.e., Idle Fee)⁵⁴ revenue in fiscal 2025. The actual fiscal 2025 Idle Fee revenue was \$0.04 million. As the Idle Fee only accounts for a very small portion of the forecast revenue, this revenue shortfall had no material impact on the R/C Ratios.

As discussed in section [3.2.6](#) above, BC Hydro assumed that approximately 5% of charging sessions would incur an average of five minutes of the 40 cents per minute Idle Fee in the Original Rate Model. In fiscal 2025, 1.8% of charging sessions triggered Idle Fee for an average of 16 minutes.

4.2.3 Provincial LCFC and Federal CFRC Revenues

In the Original Rate Model, BC Hydro forecasted \$4.8 million in provincial LCFC revenue and \$1.1 million in federal CFRC revenue in fiscal 2025. The estimated fiscal 2025 LCFC revenue was \$2.5 million and the estimated CFRC revenue was \$0.5 million. The lower LCFC and CFRC revenues contributed to approximately 14% of the reduction to the fiscal 2025 R/C Ratio.

As discussed in section [3.2.2](#) above, in addition to lower dispensed energy due to the reduced deployment plan, these lower LCFC and CFRC revenues were partially driven by the change to only recognize 20% the CFRC revenue during the year they were earned and the lower LCFC value.

4.3 Fiscal 2025 Costs

This section sets out actual costs for BC Hydro's Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service for fiscal 2025.

⁵⁴ BC Hydro renamed "Extended Stay Charge" to "Idle Fee" to be consistent with industry terminology in its compliance filing submitted updated approved RS 4100 tariff sheets to the BCUC on March 28, 2024.

4.3.1 Capital Costs

In the Original Rate Model, BC Hydro forecasted \$2.7 million in capital cost depreciation in fiscal 2025. The actual fiscal 2025 capital cost depreciation was \$1.3 million. The lower capital cost depreciation had an approximately 5% positive impact on the fiscal 2025 R/C Ratio.

In the Original Rate Model, BC Hydro assumed depreciation for 270 ports in service at the end of fiscal 2024 and 558 new ports added, with half-year depreciation applied to new installations. At the end of fiscal 2024, there were 173 ports in service and 418 new ports were installed during fiscal 2025, resulted in lower than forecast capital cost depreciation.⁵⁵

4.3.2 Financing Costs

In the Original Rate Model, BC Hydro forecasted \$1 million in financing costs in fiscal 2025. The actual fiscal 2025 financing cost was \$3.1 million. The higher financing cost contributed to approximately 14% of the reduction to the fiscal 2025 R/C Ratio.

As discussed in section [3.2.3](#) above, BC Hydro incurred higher financing costs due to the pre-purchase of equipment and delayed depreciation starts as well as the inclusion of and an opening work-in-progress balance of \$19.7 million at the beginning of fiscal 2024 which was inadvertently excluded from the Original Rate Model.

4.3.3 Operating and Maintenance Cost

In the Original Rate Model, BC Hydro forecasted \$6.3 million in operating and maintenance costs in fiscal 2025. The actual fiscal 2025 operating and maintenance

⁵⁵ For reporting purposes, we can only track CFRCs allocated for capital cost offsets based on actual CFRC revenue received. In the updated 2025 Rate Model, 80% the federal CFRC revenue has been allocated to offset capital costs on a forecasting basis based on the time the credits are earned. However, the actual fiscal 2025 capital cost depreciation does not include the offset from CFRCs. Actual proceeds from CFRCs earned from energy dispensed in calendar 2022, 2023 and 2024 have been received and recorded in fiscal 2026, after the evaluation period, and will be reported in the next evaluation report.

costs were \$10.4 million. The higher operating and maintenance costs contributed to approximately 18% of the reduction to the fiscal 2025 R/C Ratio.

Operating and maintenance costs were higher than expected during fiscal 2025 for the following primary reasons:

- Labour and contractor costs were \$2.1 million higher than expected due to a significant ramp-up of activities during fiscal 2025. BC Hydro's previous labour forecast under-estimated the resources required to deliver the deployment plan and manage a growing network;
- One of BC Hydro's suppliers of EV charging infrastructure declared bankruptcy, leading to a write-off of \$0.8 million of prepaid warranty costs;
- The cost for BC Hydro's new network platform service⁵⁶ was \$0.6 million higher than originally assumed, with \$0.4 million incurred in fiscal 2025; and
- The warehouse space originally assumed to be available to store public EV charging equipment was not sufficient for the large volume of equipment BC Hydro pre-purchased, which resulted in an unplanned warehouse leasing costs of \$0.9 million.

4.3.4 Electricity Cost

In the Original Rate Model, BC Hydro forecasted \$4 million or 18.93 GWh of energy, averaging 23.9 cents per dispensed kWh, in electricity costs in fiscal 2025. The actual fiscal 2025 electricity cost was \$2.6 million for 15.0 GWh of energy, averaging 19.3 cents per dispensed kWh. The lower electricity costs had an approximately 2% positive impact on the fiscal 2025 R/C Ratio.

The lower cost per dispensed kWh was primarily driven by:

⁵⁶ Refer to section [3.1.1](#).

- Less than forecast curbside Level 2 charging site installations (typically billed under Small General Service rate) and greater than forecast dual-port 180 kW and/or larger hub site⁵⁷ installations (typically billed under the Large General Service rate), which resulted in fewer basic charges due to port consolidation at a site and lower average per kWh energy charges (considering both the energy and demand charges of the respective general service rates); and
- Fast charging site ancillary load (e.g., for lighting and cooling fans in charging stations) was lower than estimated. BC Hydro estimated 12% ancillary load in the Original Rate Model. Actual fast charging site ancillary load was approximately 10%. By installing larger hub sites and higher charging capacity sites, the ancillary loads can be shared amongst more dispensed kWh, which lowered the average energy cost of charging sites.

4.3.5 Marketing Budget (Rate Pilots)

In the Original Rate Model, BC Hydro included a marketing budget of \$6.5 million for rate pilots over the 10-year period. There was no rate pilot implemented in fiscal 2025 or Year One and therefore no pilot costs were incurred. As discussed in section [3.1.4](#) above, BC Hydro submitted its first EV Charging Pilot Project Application to the BCUC on June 13, 2025, which was approved by Order No. G-166-25 on July 3, 2025. The cost of this pilot project will be included in the fiscal 2026 marketing budget cost.

⁵⁷ BC Hydro's definition of a "hub site" is public charging site with eight charging ports or more, meaning eight vehicles can charge simultaneously.

5 Updated Forecast 10-Year Cost Recovery Results

This section provides updated forecast costs and revenues for BC Hydro's Public EV Charging Service for the 10-year levelized period.

5.1 Overview of the Updated 10-Year Rate Model

The updated forecast 10-year R/C Ratio is 98.7%. The forecast 10-year R/C ratio in the Application was 99.5%. This discrepancy equates to approximately \$2.4 million. Over the 10-year period, higher operating and maintenance costs and lower LCFC and CFRC revenues are forecast to continue but are offset by lower forecast costs for a reduced deployment plan and by lower financing costs due to applying BC Hydro's WACD instead of the higher WACC.

Revenues from Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service are now expected to exceed costs starting in fiscal 2030 which is two years earlier than forecast in the Application (fiscal 2032). However, the cumulative cost under-recovery between fiscal 2025 and fiscal 2029 is now forecast to be approximately \$66 million compared to the Application forecast of \$26 million. In other words, the cost under-recovery in the earlier years is steeper but shorter. This is because the factors driving increased cost under-recovery are recognized immediately while the impacts of the reduced deployment plan that offsets this under recovery are recognized over time.

5.2 Updates to Rate Model Assumptions

[Table 11](#) below provides an updated version of Table 5-3 from the Application, with a new column that outlines the updated Reference Case assumptions and updated cost and revenue forecasts. The following is a summary of changes to the Reference Case assumptions:

- **Proportion of Urban Stations:** Updated. Now reflects the planned ramp up of urban ports, which is expected to reach 78% by fiscal 2031;

-
- **Charging Port First Year⁵⁸ and Maximum Utilization Rate:** No change. As discussed in section [3.2.4](#) above, actual fiscal 2025 utilization rates were similar to BC Hydro's forecast utilization rates in the Original Rate Model;
 - **Electric Vehicle Stock in B.C. in Fiscal 2033:** Updated. BC Hydro revised its EV stock forecast in May 2025. As discussed in section [5.3.1](#) below, the updated forecast anticipates higher EV adoption compared to the forecast used in the Original Rate Model;
 - **Number of Charging Ports in Fiscal 2033:** Updated. For the reasons discussed in section [3.2.1](#) above, the overall planned number of stations has been reduced by approximately 40% from 3,305 ports by fiscal 2033 to 1,900 ports by fiscal 2033. This reduction is primarily driven by a reduction in the deployment of Level 2 charging stations from 1,250 by fiscal 2033 to 225 by fiscal 2033; and
 - **Availability of Government Funding:** Updated. As discussed in section [5.4.4](#) below, BC Hydro has updated its assumption regarding the availability of government funding.

⁵⁸ The first year when a new charging port power level is introduced.

Table 11 **Summary of Scenarios, Inputs and Assumptions**

Inputs	Updated Reference Case Assumptions (Fiscal 2033)	Original Reference Case Assumptions (Fiscal 2033)	Original Low-End Sensitivity Assumptions (Fiscal 2033)	Original High-End Sensitivity Assumptions (Fiscal 2033)
Assumptions				
Proportion of Urban Stations	78%	78%	50%	90%
Charging Port First Year and Maximum Utilization Rate	First year urban: 12% First year non-urban: 2% Maximum: 30%	First year urban: 12% First year non-urban: 2% Maximum: 30%	First year urban: 6% First year non-urban: 2% Maximum: 30%	First year urban: 15% First year non-urban: 2% Maximum: 30%
Electric Vehicle Stock in BC in Fiscal 2033	826,000 (May 2025 update)	591,000 BC Hydro's Reference Electric Vehicle Stock Forecast (Average of Low and High Electric Vehicle Stock Forecast)	384,000 BC Hydro's Low Electric Vehicle Stock Forecast (Zero-Emission Vehicles Act)	797,000 BC Hydro's High Electric Vehicle Stock Forecast (CleanBC Roadmap to 2030)
Number of Charging Ports in Fiscal 2033	Fast Charging: 1,676 Level 2: 224 Total: 1,900	Fast Charging: 2,050 Level 2: 1,255 Total: 3,305	~50% less than the Reference Case Fast Charging: 1,190 Level 2: 600 Total: 1,790	~50% more than the Reference Case Fast Charging: 2,910 Level 2: 1,890 Total: 4,800
Availability of Government Funding	Ends by current Published Deadlines (Federal: Fiscal 2027 Provincial: Fiscal 2030)	Ends in Fiscal 2030	Ends by current Published Deadlines (Federal: Fiscal 2027 Provincial: Fiscal 2030)	Ends in Fiscal 2033
Dynamic Costs (\$ million)				
Capital	63	116	62	180
Finance	26	54	28	85
Operating and Maintenance	121	123	74	175
Electricity	170	252	128	382
Static Costs (\$ million)				
Previous Years' Under-Recoveries	5	5	5	5
Marketing Budget	6	6	2	12
Previous Under-Collection of GST	0.023	0.023	0.023	0.023

Inputs	Updated Reference Case Assumptions (Fiscal 2033)	Original Reference Case Assumptions (Fiscal 2033)	Original Low-End Sensitivity Assumptions (Fiscal 2033)	Original High-End Sensitivity Assumptions (Fiscal 2033)
Delayed Application of the F2023 General Rate Increase	0.007	0.007	0.007	0.007
Total Cost	392	557	299	840
Dynamic Revenues (\$ million)				
Electric Vehicle Charging Revenue	265	323	100	580
Extended Stay Charge Revenue	2	4	1	7
Low Carbon Fuel Credit Revenue ⁵⁹	120	227	72	406
Total Revenue	387	555	173	994
10-Year Levelized R/C Ratio (Rounded)	99%	100%	58%	118%

[Table 12](#) below shows the impact of each cost and revenue change on the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

Table 12 Combined Impact of all Assumption Changes

	Impact (\$ thousands)	Impact (%)
Revenue	(167,101)	-30
• Electric Vehicle Charging Revenue	(57,981)	-18
• Extended Stay Charge (Idle Fee) Revenue	(1,696)	-41
• LCFC and CFRC Revenue	(107,425)	-47
Cost	(164,709)	+30
• Capital Costs	(52,905)	+46
• Financing Costs	(28,772)	+53
• Operating and Maintenance Costs	(976)	+1
• Electricity Costs	(82,056)	+33
• Previous Years Under Recovery	0	0
• Marketing Budget	0	0
Revenue - Cost	(2,392)	-1

⁵⁹ Includes both LCFC and CFRC.

[Table 13](#) below shows the impact to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio from each of the key updates that are causing the changes shown in the tables above, assuming all other variables remain the same as the Original Rate Model.⁶⁰ The sub-sections below provide further discussion on each of these changes.

Table 13 Impact of Each Key Update

Positive Impact on R/C Ratio	
Assumption/Input	Impact on R/C
Higher EV Stock Forecast	8%
Reduced Deployment Plan	4%
Updated Financing Costs	3%
Updated Station Energy Assumptions	3%
Negative Impact on R/C Ratio	
Assumption/Input	Impact on R/C
Changes to LCFC and CFRC	-7%
Increased Capital Cost per Port	-6%
Increased Operating and Maintenance Costs	-4%
Updated Government Funding Availability Assumption	-3%
Updated General Rate Increase Forecast	-3%

5.3 Updates with Positive Impacts

This section discusses each of the key updates with positive impacts to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

5.3.1 Higher EV Stock Forecast

As discussed in section [5.2](#) above, BC Hydro updated its EV stock forecast in May 2025. [Table 14](#) below provides the updated forecast. The updated forecast anticipates higher EV adoption compared to the original forecast in the Application. All else being equal, this change results in an 8% increase to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

⁶⁰ The impacts are not additive when combined due to interdependencies among various inputs.

Table 14 Update of Electric Vehicle Forecasts

Fiscal Year	Updated Reference Case	Reference Case	Low-End Sensitivity	High-End Sensitivity	Difference Between Reference Cases
	(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E=A-B)
F2024	141,278	141,278	141,030	141,526	0
F2025	179,235	199,923	198,487	201,358	-20,688
F2026	212,204	202,018	198,592	205,444	10,186
F2027	239,907	214,815	205,940	223,690	25,092
F2028	280,410	243,904	218,247	269,561	36,506
F2029	342,312	286,621	234,222	339,019	55,691
F2030	427,726	334,613	248,036	421,191	93,113
F2031	538,499	386,501	261,964	511,038	151,998
F2032	673,263	486,330	318,447	654,213	186,933
F2033	826,331	590,517	384,250	796,784	235,814

In the April 2023 EV forecast in the Application,⁶¹ BC Hydro assumed a 10-year lifespan for EV batteries. In the most recent update, this assumption was revised to 15 years based on an updated analysis using ICBC data. The longer life expectancy positively impacts the projected number of EVs.

As shown in [Table 15](#) below, all else being equal, the increase in the EV stock forecast results in a 10% increase in forecast revenue, primarily driven by higher charging volumes due to higher EV adoption.⁶² It also leads to a 2% increase in forecast costs, which is mainly attributable to higher electricity costs and increased operating and maintenance costs due to higher network transaction fees (based on volume).

⁶¹ Refer to section 5.3.3 of the Application for BC Hydro's April 2023 EV stock forecast scenarios.

⁶² As discussed in section 5.3.2 of the Application, BC Hydro based its charging port utilization rate growth assumption on the EV stock growth, discounted by a 1.4 factor each year to account for greater number of charging ports available in the market.

Table 15 **Impact of Electric Vehicle Stock
Forecast Update**

	Impact (\$ thousands)	Impact (%)
Revenue	56,520	10
• EV Charging Revenue	33,276	10
• Idle Fee Revenue	392	9
• LCFC Revenue	22,851	10
Cost	9,577	-2
• Capital Costs	0	0
• Financing Costs	0	0
• OMA Costs	2,748	-2
• Electricity Costs	6,830	-3
• Previous Years Under Recovery	0	0
• Marketing Budget	0	0
Revenue-Cost	46,943	8

5.3.2 Reduced Deployment Plan

As discussed in section [3.2.1](#) above, BC Hydro has revised its public EV charging service deployment plan with a lower deployment and different power level composition. All else being equal, this change results in a 4% increase to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

As shown in [Table 16](#) below, all else being equal, the revised deployment plan results in a 39% decrease in forecast revenue, primarily due to fewer ports, a higher proportion of non-urban ports and reduced energy dispensed. Forecast costs decrease by 42%, mainly due to (a) lower capital, financing and operations and maintenance costs for fewer installations, (b) reduced electricity costs because of less charging activity and (c) lower costs assuming that BC Hydro's public EV charging network will not expand after fiscal 2031, as discussed in section [3.2.1](#) above.

Table 16 Impact of Deployment Plan Update

	Impact (\$)	Impact (%)
Revenue	(217,482)	-39
• EV Charging Revenue	(126,697)	-39
• Idle Fee Revenue	(1,893)	-46
• LCFC Revenue	(88,893)	-39
Cost	(231,661)	42
• Capital Costs	(63,138)	54
• Financing Costs	(28,151)	52
• OMA Costs	(32,572)	27
• Electricity Costs	(107,800)	43
• Previous Years Under Recovery	0	0
• Marketing Budget	0	0
Revenue-Cost	14,179	2

5.3.3 Updated Financing Costs

As discussed in section [3.2.3](#) above, BC Hydro updated its interest rate to calculate financing costs from its WACC of 6% to its average WACD of 3.6%. All else being equal, this change results in a 3% increase to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

In addition, as discussed in sections [3.2.3](#) and [4.3.2](#) above, BC Hydro incurred higher financing costs due to the pre-purchase of equipment and delayed depreciation starts and the inclusion of an opening work-in-progress balance of \$19.7 million at the beginning of fiscal 2024 that was inadvertently not included in the Original Rate Model.

All else being equal, these changes result in a \$13.7 million reduction in financing costs.

5.3.4 Updated Station Energy Assumptions

As discussed in section [3.2.5](#) above, based on actual fiscal 2025 charging session data, the average dispensed energy per minute and the average duration of charging sessions are both slightly higher than BC Hydro's original assumptions in the Original Rate Model.

In addition, as discussed in sections [3.2.6](#) and [4.2.2](#) above, actual charging sessions that incurred Idle Fees were less than assumed in the Application but the duration of Idle Fees were longer. Lastly, as discussed in section [4.3.4](#) above, the ancillary load for fast charging sites was 10%, which was lower than the original estimate of 12%.

All else being equal, these updates result in a 3% increase to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio. As shown in [Table 17](#) below, there is a \$22.2 million net increase in revenue and a \$345,000 net decrease in costs.

Table 17 **Impact of Updated Station Energy Assumptions**

	Impact (\$)	Impact (%)
Revenue	22,193	4
• EV Charging Revenue	12,973	4
• Idle Fee Revenue	(504)	-12
• LCFC Revenue	9,724	4
Cost	3,450	-1
• Capital Costs	0	0
• Financing Costs	0	0
• OMA Costs	1,090	-1
• Electricity Costs	2,360	-1
• Previous Years Under Recovery	0	0
• Marketing Budget	0	0
Revenue-Cost	18,743	3

5.4 Updates with Negative Impacts

This section discusses each of the key updates with negative impacts to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

5.4.1 Changes to LCFC and CFRC Policy and Pricing

As discussed in section [3.2.2](#) above, BC Hydro updated the allocation of federal CFRC revenue and the values of the provincial LCFCs and federal CFRCs. All else being equal, these updates result in a 7% decrease to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

As shown in section [3.2.2](#), the value of provincial LCFCs is lower than original forecast and the value of federal CFRCs is higher than original forecast. These changes alone would have increased the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio by 6%. However, the change in how CFRC revenues are recognized is particularly impactful, deferring approximately \$88 million in revenue outside of the 10-year levelized recovery period, results in a reduction to the 10-year R/C Ratio of 12%.

As shown in [Table 18](#) below, all else being equal, incorporating these changes results in a reduction in forecast revenue of approximately \$81 million and a reduction of \$43 million in the forecast costs.

Table 18 Impact of LCFC and CFRC Changes

	Impact (\$)	Impact (%)
Revenue	(80,504)	-15
• EV Charging Revenue	0	0
• Idle Fee Revenue	0	0
• LCFC Revenue	(80,504)	-35
Cost	(42,517)	8
• Capital Costs	(28,140)	24
• Financing Costs	(14,377)	26
• OMA Costs	0	0
• Electricity Costs	0	0
• Previous Years Under Recovery	0	0

	Impact (\$)	Impact (%)
• Marketing Budget	0	0
Revenue-Cost	(37,986)	-7

5.4.2 Increased Capital Cost per Port

As discussed in section [4.3.1](#) above, BC Hydro underestimated the average per port capital cost in the Original Rate Model. The updated average per port capital cost is included in the 2025 Rate Model. All else being equal, this update results in a 6% decrease to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

[Table 19](#) below compares the assumed per port cost by power level in the Original Rate Model and the 2025 Rate Model.

Table 19 Change in per port Capital cost
Assumptions from 2023 Application

Power Level (kW)	Original Rate Model (\$ F2024)	2025 Rate Model (\$ F2024)	Change (%)	Planned Ports by F2033
7				
25				
50				
75				
90				
100				
175				
180				
200				
350				

As shown in [Table 20](#) below, all else being equal, the revised capital cost per port estimates result in an estimated \$22.9 million increase in capital costs, along with an additional \$10.9 million in financing costs.

Table 20 **Impact of Increase per Port Capital Costs**

	Impact (\$)	Impact (%)
Revenue	0	0
• EV Charging Revenue	0	0
• Idle Fee Revenue	0	0
• LCFC Revenue	0	0
Cost	33,756	-6
• Capital Costs	22,863	-20
• Financing Costs	10,893	-20
• OMA Costs	0	0
• Electricity Costs	0	0
• Previous Years Under Recovery	0	0
• Marketing Budget	0	0
Revenue-Cost	(33,756)	-6

5.4.3 Operating and Maintenance Costs

As discussed in section [4.3.3](#) above, BC Hydro underestimated the operating and maintenance costs in the Original Rate Model. All else being equal, this update results in a 4% decrease to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

As discussed in section [4.3.3](#) above, BC Hydro's original forecast under-estimated the resources required to deliver the deployment plan and manage a growing network.

In addition, BC Hydro is forecasting increases to non-labour costs due to revised vendor agreements and operational requirements to maintain service levels.

[Table 21](#) below summarizes these non-labour cost increases.

Table 21 Summary of Non-Labour Cost Increases

Category	Details
Network Transaction Fees	Reduced from ■% to ■% (based on updated vendor contracts).
Network Costs per Station	Fast Charging: \$■ to \$■; Level 2: \$■ to \$■ (based on updated vendor contracts).
IT Enhancements	Additional \$■ million for billing integration and feature upgrades over the remaining years of the 10-year period.
Warehousing	Additional \$■ million for EV charger and equipment storage over the remaining years of the 10-year period.
Site-Related Costs	Additional \$xx■ million (net of government contributions for off-grid sites) for EV charging site maintenance (e.g., snow removal).

All else being equal, these updates increase forecast operating and maintenance costs by approximately \$21 million.

5.4.4 Availability of Government Funding

BC Hydro has updated its assumption with regard to the availability of government funding. All else being equal, this update results in a 3% decrease to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

As shown in [Table 22](#) below, all else being equal, this change is expected to result in an increase in capital costs of approximately \$11.3 million and an associated increase in financing costs of approximately \$5.4 million over the 10-year period.

Table 22 Impact of Government Funding Availability Assumption

	Impact (\$)	Impact (%)
Revenue	0	0
• EV Charging Revenue	0	0
• Idle Fee Revenue	0	0
• LCFC Revenue	0	0
Cost	16,702	-3
• Capital Costs	11,270	-10
• Financing Costs	5,432	-10

	Impact (\$)	Impact (%)
• Operating and Maintenance Costs	0	0
• Electricity Costs	0	0
• Previous Years Under Recovery	0	0
• Marketing Budget	0	0
Revenue-Cost	(16,702)	-3

5.4.5 General Rate Increase Forecast

In the updated 2025 Rate Model, BC Hydro has applied its most recent general rate increase forecast. All else being equal, this results in a 3% decrease to the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio.

The updated forecast assumes an annual net bill increase of 3.75% beginning in fiscal 2026, which aligns with BC Hydro's approved general rate changes for fiscal 2026 and fiscal 2027. This assumption includes changes to rate riders. Changes to rate riders apply to forecast electricity costs but do not apply to forecast EV charging revenue.⁶³ All else being equal, this results in higher forecast electricity costs of \$18.8 million over the 10-year period and higher EV charging revenue of \$870,000 over the 10-year period.

6 2025 Jurisdictional Review

BC Hydro engaged Ernst & Young (EY) to provide an updated jurisdictional review of public EV charging rates of other EV charging service providers in B.C. and other comparable jurisdictions. [Appendix D](#) provides the full report.

As of July 2025, there are an estimated 2,066 public fast charging ports and 5,112 public Level 2 charging ports across B.C. BC Hydro's public EV

⁶³ As stated in BC Hydro's response to BCUC IR 1.1.1: "To be consistent with the current billing practice of all rate schedules and rate designs, including RS 1360, RS 1560, and RS 1561, BC Hydro updated the Proposed Rates to exclude forecast DARR and TIRR revenue from the cost-of-service assessment."

charging ports represent approximately 24% of fast charging ports and 2% of Level 2 charging ports in B.C.

Exempt public EV charging service providers change their rates from time to time and some charge time-varying rates. Many service providers continue to bill customers based on time-based rates, particularly for Level 2 charging. EY has developed a conversion methodology for translating time-based rates into equivalent energy-based rates equivalents; however, direct correlation remains challenging due to variability in charging speeds and usage patterns.

[Figure 2](#) and Figure 3 below compare BC Hydro’s fast charging and Level 2 charging rates, respectively, to the average rates of other public EV charging service providers in B.C.

Figure 2 **Fast Charging Rates: BC Hydro Compared to Average of Other Charging Operators in B.C.⁶⁴**



⁶⁴ Refer to [Appendix D](#), page 8.

Figure 3 **Level 2 Charging Rates: BC Hydro Compared to Average of Other Charging Operators in B.C.⁶⁵**



As shown, BC Hydro’s fast charging rate is below the mid-point of other providers in B.C. whereas BC Hydro’s Level 2 charging rate is above the mid-point of other providers.

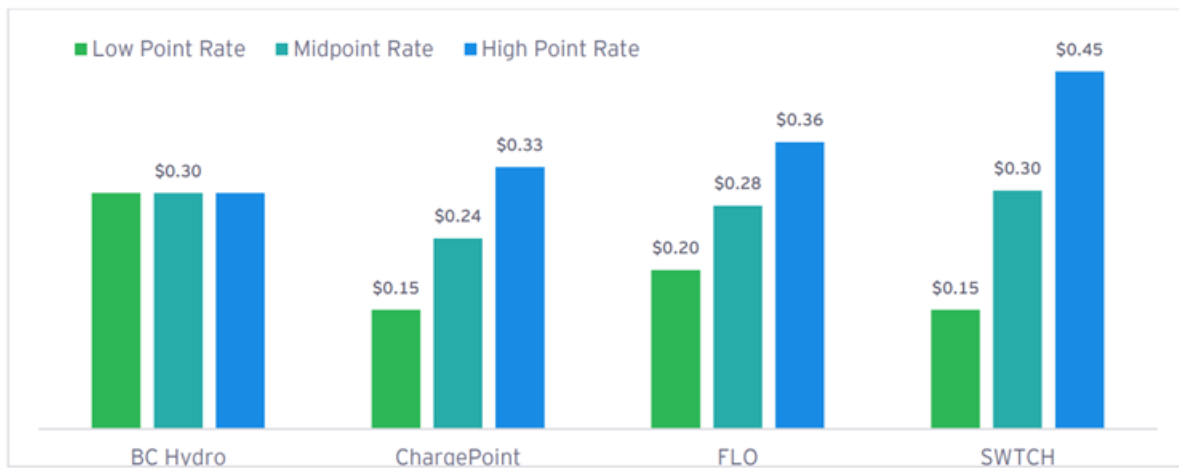
The EY report also includes a more granular view of rates for individual providers in B.C., as shown in [Figure 4](#) and Figure 5 below.

⁶⁵ Refer to [Appendix D](#), page 9.

Figure 4 Fast Charging Rates: BC Hydro Compared to Other Charging Operators in B.C.⁶⁶



Figure 5 Level 2 Charging Rates: BC Hydro compared to other charging operators in B.C.⁶⁷



⁶⁶ Refer to [Appendix D](#), page 8.

⁶⁷ Refer to [Appendix D](#), page 9.

In its jurisdictional review, EY notes that pricing decisions among other service providers and station owners may be influenced by their diverse business models that reflect regional differences, infrastructure costs, and their customer needs.⁶⁸

With regard to idle fees, BC Hydro’s fast charging Idle Fee (40 cents per minute) and its structure (i.e., five-minute grace period after charging ends) is generally consistent with market practices. EY identified only one Level 2 service provider (i.e., Shell Recharge) that currently applies an idle fee for Level 2 charging.⁶⁹ [Table 23](#) below provides a summary of idle fees in B.C.

Table 23 **Sample Idle Fees Charged by BC Hydro and Providers Across B.C.**

Charging Network	Idle Fee	Grace Period	Notes
BC Hydro	\$0.40 per minute ¹⁶	5 minutes after charging ends	Applies only to DC fast chargers; no idle fee for L2 chargers
Shell	\$0.15/min	After 5 mins grace period	Usually varies by site
Electrify Canada	\$0.40 per minute ¹⁷	10 minutes after charging ends	Applies after a 10-minute grace period for DC fast chargers; shown in app before session starts
ChargePoint	\$3.00 to \$10.00/hr	15 mins	Idle fees are optional and vary widely
Tesla Supercharger	\$0.50/min and \$1.00/min if station is 100% occupied ¹⁸	5 mins	Applies only to DC fast chargers
Petro Canada	No idle fee ¹⁹	Not applicable	

7 BC Hydro’s Proposals

In this Year One Evaluation Report, BC Hydro is proposing a 5% increase to the fast-charging rates set out in RS 4100, effective April 1, 2026. BC Hydro also proposes that the next Evaluation Report be filed by no later than August 31, 2027 (i.e., two years from now).

7.1 Proposed Increase to Fast Charging Rates

BC Hydro is proposing a 5% increase to the fast-charging rates set out in RS 4100, effective April 1, 2026. When combined with the approved fiscal 2027 general rate

⁶⁸ Refer to [Appendix D](#), page 4.

⁶⁹ Refer to [Appendix D](#), page 13.

changes effective on that same date,⁷⁰ the combined rate increase would be 8.9% or an average increase of \$0.76 per charging session. BC Hydro is not proposing any changes to the Level 2 charging rate, Idle Fee or any other terms and conditions of RS 4100.

A 5% increase to the fast-charging rates set out in RS 4100, effective April 1, 2026, is forecast to raise an additional \$17.4 million in revenue from fiscal 2027 to fiscal 2033, improving the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio from 98.7% to 101.7%. When this increase is combined with the approved fiscal 2027 general rate changes, BC Hydro's fast charging rate would be 39.32 cents per kWh which is higher than the low-point of some key providers but remains below the overall mid-point.

BC Hydro submits that this proposed increase is reasonable because it restores the forecast 10-year R/C Ratio to approximately 100% and results in a fast-charging rate that is comparable to other providers, helping to maintain a level playing field for exempted public utilities providing public EV charging services in BC. BC Hydro submits that a higher rate increase would be unreasonable because a higher increase is not required to maintain a forecast R/C ratio of 100% and because, when combined with the approved fiscal 2027 general rate changes, it could exceed the level generally considered by the Commission to be rate shock.⁷¹

7.2 Future Evaluation Reports

This Year One Evaluation Report must propose the timing of the next evaluation report.⁷² BC Hydro proposes that the next Evaluation Report be filed by no later than August 31, 2027 (i.e., two years from now). BC Hydro submits that an earlier (i.e., one year from now) deadline would create regulatory inefficiency because it would provide insufficient time for any meaningful developments to occur while a later

⁷⁰ https://docs.bcuc.com/documents/orders/2025/doc_80826_g-76-25-bch-f2026-f2027-rra-final.pdf.

⁷¹ In several decisions, the BCUC has confirmed that a greater than 10% change in rates per annum is generally considered to be rate shock. For example, refer to page 19 of Order No. G-213-21, page 7 of Order No. G-222-21, and page 21 of Order No. G-334-23.

⁷² Refer to Order No. G-67-24, page 28.

deadline could increase the risk of cost under-recovery or over-recovery given the extent to which various factors have fluctuated during Year One and could continue to do so. However, if circumstances dictate (e.g., BC Hydro receives indications that forecast cost recovery is worsening), BC Hydro would accelerate the filing of the next Evaluation Report so that it could inform whether any adjustments should be made to fiscal 2028 rates.

BC Hydro Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates

Evaluation Report for Year One

Appendix A

Updated Working Excel Rate Model

PUBLIC



REFER TO LIVE SPREADSHEET MODEL

Provided in electronic format only

(Accessible by opening the Attachments Tab in Adobe)

BC Hydro Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates

Evaluation Report for Year One

Appendix B

Energy-based Rate Transition – Customer Communications

Rate Transition Customer Communications

Effective May 1, 2024 BC Hydro transitioned from time-based rates to approved energy-based rates as well as the Idle Fee for fast charging. BC Hydro conducted various customer communication activities before and during the transition to ensure customers were aware of this change. Below are samples of the communications activities.

Media Release and Stories

- Media release: [Statement: B.C. Utilities Commission approves energy-based rates for public charging services](#)
- BC Hydro Connected newsletter stories & features mentioning the new rates:
 - ▶ [Four EV road trips showcase fast charging options in B.C.](#)
 - ▶ [EV charging etiquette is mostly just common sense](#)

Website FAQ Sample

Paying

Can I auto-reload funds in my BC Hydro EV network account? ✓

How can I get an RFID card? ✓

How do I get a refund or withdraw funds from my account? ✓

How do I find information on pricing? ✓

How do I load funds into my BC Hydro EV account? ✓

How do I pay for the charge? ✓

How do idle fees work? ✓

How much does it cost to use an EV charger? ✓

What is energy-based billing? ^

In 2024, we switched to energy-based billing (\$ per kWh) instead of time-based billing (\$ per minute).

We made the change in response to customer feedback and industry best practice. Under time-based billing, the cost to charge at a public charger could vary due to vehicle and battery size, the beginning and ending state of charge (i.e. battery percentages), and the temperature. Switching to energy-based billing (\$ per kWh) removes these variables.

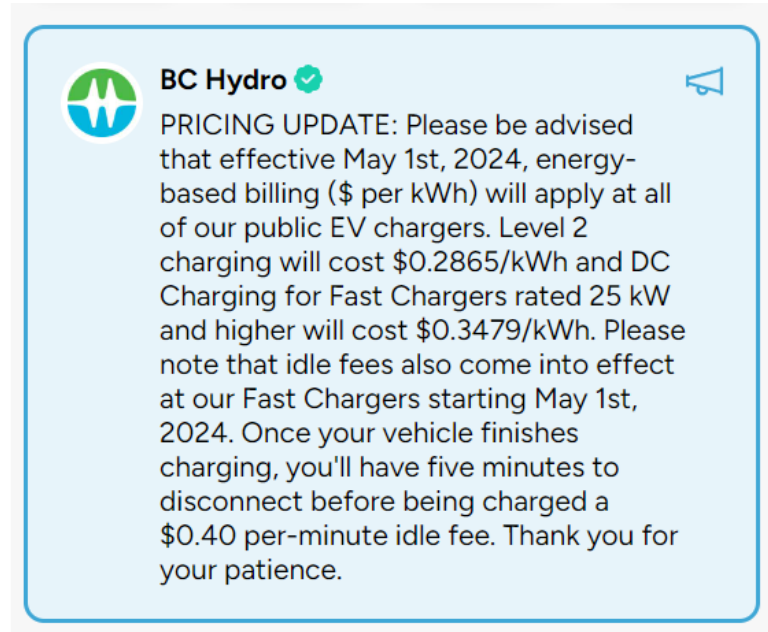
Authorization from Measurement Canada

Our public chargers are temporarily authorized to be used for the purpose of obtaining the basis of a charge for electricity under terms and conditions established by Measurement Canada.

What's a rate rider? ✓

Where can I view receipts for my BC Hydro EV network transactions? ✓

PlugShare/ChargeHub Updates Sample



On-site Signage

Charging rates

Effective May 1, 2024

Level 2 charger	\$0.2865/kWh
25 kW and higher	\$0.3479/kWh

Once your vehicle stops charging, you will have 5 minutes to disconnect before you will be charged a \$0.40 per minute idle fee.

For more information on EV charging rates, roaming, third-party fees and taxes, scan this QR code

Rates are set by the British Columbia Utilities Commission.

Social Media Samples



Email Samples



Public charging updates start May 1

[Read this email online](#)

ENERGY-BASED BILLING STARTS MAY 1

New rates are coming



Hi Jaime,

Energy-based billing is coming soon to our public charging network.

Starting May 1, [energy-based billing](#) (\$ per kWh) will apply at all of our public EV chargers. With costs based on the amount of electricity delivered to your vehicle, you'll pay for what you use.

[Idle fees](#) also come into effect at our fast chargers starting May 1. Once your vehicle finishes charging, you'll have five minutes to disconnect before being charged a \$0.40 per-minute idle fee.

Recently completed stations

- [Manning Park Resort](#) – expansion
- [Tumbler Ridge](#) – new site
- [Cranbrook Public Parking](#) – expansion

Next up

- [Ulkatcho First Nation \(Anahim Lake\)](#) – new site
- [Salmon Arm](#) – new site



EV power management rebate

Don't have the electrical capacity to support an EV charger at home? We're offering a \$200 rebate on devices that can help you avoid a service upgrade. [Check out our rebate](#)

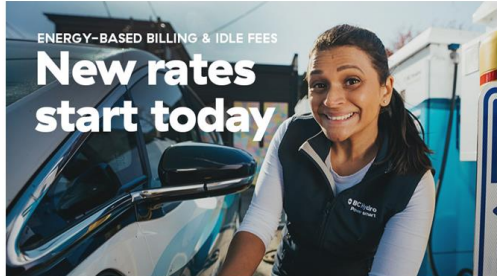


Learn about new public charging rates

[Read this email online](#)

ENERGY-BASED BILLING & IDLE FEES

New rates start today



Hi Jaime,

[Energy-based billing](#) (\$ per kWh) starts today at all of our public charging sites. [Idle fees](#) are also now in effect at our fast chargers.

What does this mean for you?

Effective May 1, 2024, the costs to charge at our chargers are:

Type of charge	Price (before tax)
Level 2 charging	\$0.2865 per kWh
Fast charging (labelled 25 kW or higher)	\$0.3479 per kWh
Idle fee*	\$0.40 per minute

*Once your vehicle stops charging, you'll have five minutes to disconnect before you're charged an idle fee. Idle fees apply at all of our fast chargers with the exception of Level 2 chargers.

[Learn more about the new rates](#)

EV charging etiquette

Public charging is all about community. With more EV drivers hitting the road every day, positive EV charging etiquette can help everyone get along. [Check out our EV charging etiquette tips.](#)

Need help charging?

Our [fast charging help centre](#) guides you through charging, paying, and other common questions. If you require additional assistance, you can call our customer service team 24 hours a day at [1 866 338 3369](#).

BC Hydro Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates

Evaluation Report for Year One

Appendix C

Survey on the Public EV Charging Service – November 2024



Public EV Charger Survey

Prepared for BC Hydro – EV Service Delivery

May 14, 2025



Adam DiPaula | adipaula@sentisresearch.com

Alex Sharp | asharp@sentisresearch.com

thesentisgroup.com

Content Overview



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BACKGROUND & OBJECTIVES



The purpose of this project is to conduct the fifth wave of the BC Hydro Public EV Charger Survey.

The specific objectives of the survey are as follows:

- Determine how and where BC Hydro EV network members charge their vehicles
- Determine how and why BC Hydro EV network members use Public Chargers
- Identify what features BC Hydro EV network members want BC Hydro to prioritize for future charging sites
- Measure the impact of changes in BC Hydro public charging rates implemented in May 2024
- Determine what's most important to BC Hydro EV network members when it comes to determining the price they pay for charging
- Assess awareness of the idle fee and its impact on the user experience



APPROACH



SURVEY SAMPLE

In total, 1,813 surveys were conducted among BC Hydro EV network members across British Columbia.



SURVEY METHOD & LENGTH

The survey questionnaire was designed by BC Hydro with input from Sentis. Sentis provided BC Hydro with a link to the online survey which BC Hydro then sent to their database of EV drivers.



DATA COLLECTION DATES

November 13 – 21st with a reminder sent on November 19th.



MARGIN OF ERROR

Results on the total sample are accurate to $\pm 2.3\%$ (19 times out of 20).



PARTICIPATION CRITERIA

- Own or lease an EV (plug-in hybrid or electric)
- Household must have at least one EV

Region (2024)	# of Surveys	% of Surveys
Lower Mainland / Fraser Valley / Sunshine Coast	1,090	60%
Vancouver Island	491	27%
Okanagan / Kootenays	143	8%
Northern BC	60	3%
<i>Prefer not to answer</i>	29	2%
Total	1,813	100%

Survey Responses by year

Year	Completed Surveys	Response Rate	Margin of Error (19 times out of 20)
2024	1,813	21%	$\pm 2.3\%$
2023	1,877	-	$\pm 2.3\%$
2022	1,277	-	$\pm 2.7\%$

STATISTICAL DIFFERENCES

Statistical testing has been conducted across survey waves. A shift of 3 points (on a full base) between waves is typically required to be considered statistically different (19 times out of 20).



HIGHLIGHTS

Key Takeaways

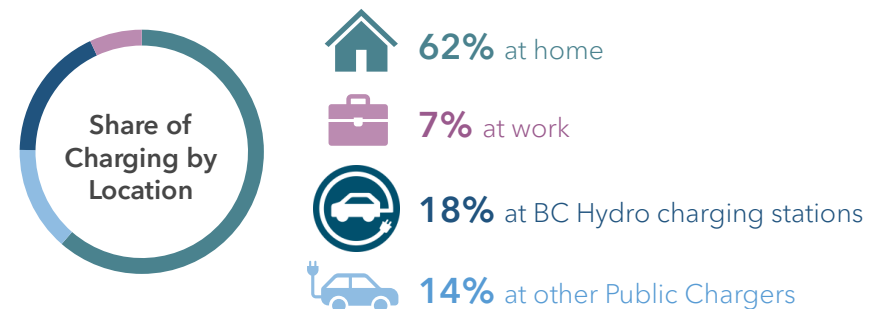


KEY TAKEAWAYS CHARGING HABITS

BC Hydro chargers are garnering a greater share of charging.

This year's survey showed a shift in where BC Hydro network members are charging their EVs. Compared to 2023, they're doing a larger share of their charging at BC Hydro chargers - up from 13% to 18% - and a smaller share of their charging at home - down from 67% to 62%.

This shift can be attributed to both shifts in network member demographics and public charger preferences. The percentage of network members living in condos/apartments (who do most of their charging at public stations) increased from 18% in 2023 to 25% in 2024, while the percentage of network members living in single-detached homes decreased from 64% in 2023 to 57% in 2024.



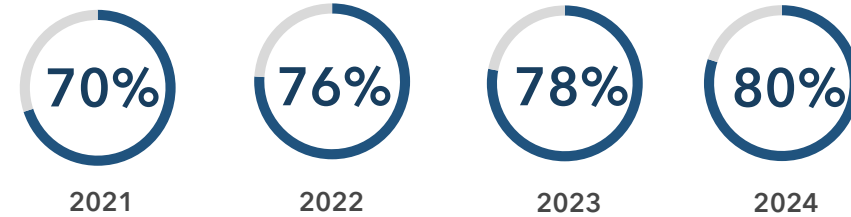


KEY TAKEAWAYS CHOOSING A PUBLIC CHARGER

Satisfaction with BC Hydro chargers continues to rise.

Overall satisfaction with BC Hydro chargers has continued to rise steadily and now stands at 80%, second only to Tesla.

% Satisfied Overall with
BC Hydro Chargers



BC Hydro is now the leader when it comes to value for money – satisfaction has increased by 25 percentage points since 2021 and now stands at 73%.

Consistent with BC Hydro's higher score on value for money, a higher percentage of BC Hydro EV network members cite fair pricing as a reason why they use BC Hydro chargers (44%, up from 38% in 2023).

Virtually all (95%) of survey respondents have used BC Hydro chargers in the past six months – and one-third (33%) are frequent users.

BC Hydro Charger
Usage



FLO and ChargePoint continue to be the most commonly used alternatives at 73% and 67%, respectively.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

CHARGING INFLUENCES & RATES



Fast charging and shorter wait times continue to be the main influences on which public chargers EV drivers choose to use.

Several findings from the survey reinforce this:

- Fast charging continues to be the most common reason BC Hydro network members use BC Hydro chargers.
- The percentage of BC Hydro network members who are only willing to wait five minutes or less for a BC Hydro charger in an urban area increased from 41% in 2023 to 46% in 2024.
- Over two-thirds (68%) of network members will choose a faster charger even if the fee is higher.

The energy-based charging rate has had little impact on the use of BC Hydro chargers.

Eight-in-ten BC Hydro network members say the new charging rate hasn't impacted their charging – and only 9% say that the new rate has led them to decrease how much they charge at BC Hydro chargers.

Among the 20% of users who report a change in their behaviour due to the rate adjustment, long-distance travel is most likely to be impacted with 43% claiming the rate change has increased their usage.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

THE IDLE FEE & MOBILE APP

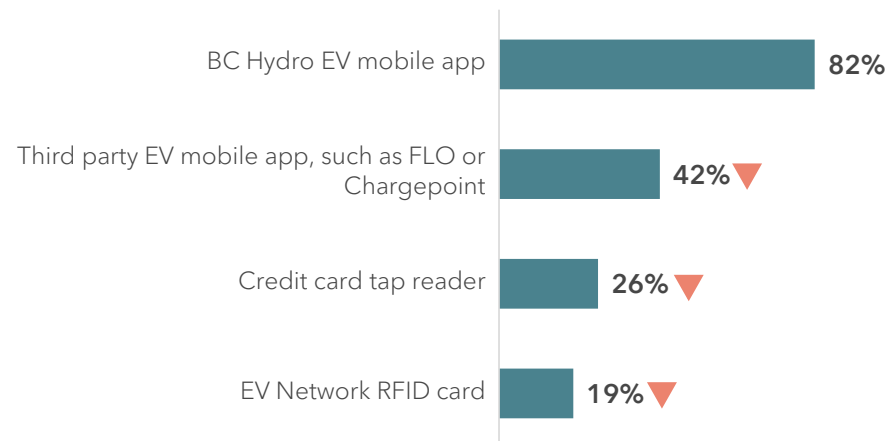
The idle fee has been well received.

The idle fee hasn't impacted most users of BC Hydro chargers. Among those aware of the idle fee, 7-in-10 say that their experience hasn't changed – and 3-in-10 say their experience has improved, largely because there's less congestion and faster turnaround times at stations.

The BC Hydro EV mobile app is now by far the most frequently used method to pay for charging.

The BC Hydro mobile app continues to be the most common way that BC Hydro network members pay for their charging session – 82% use it – while the use of all other payment methods has declined significantly.

Top Payment Methods For Public Charging





SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

Public Charger Use

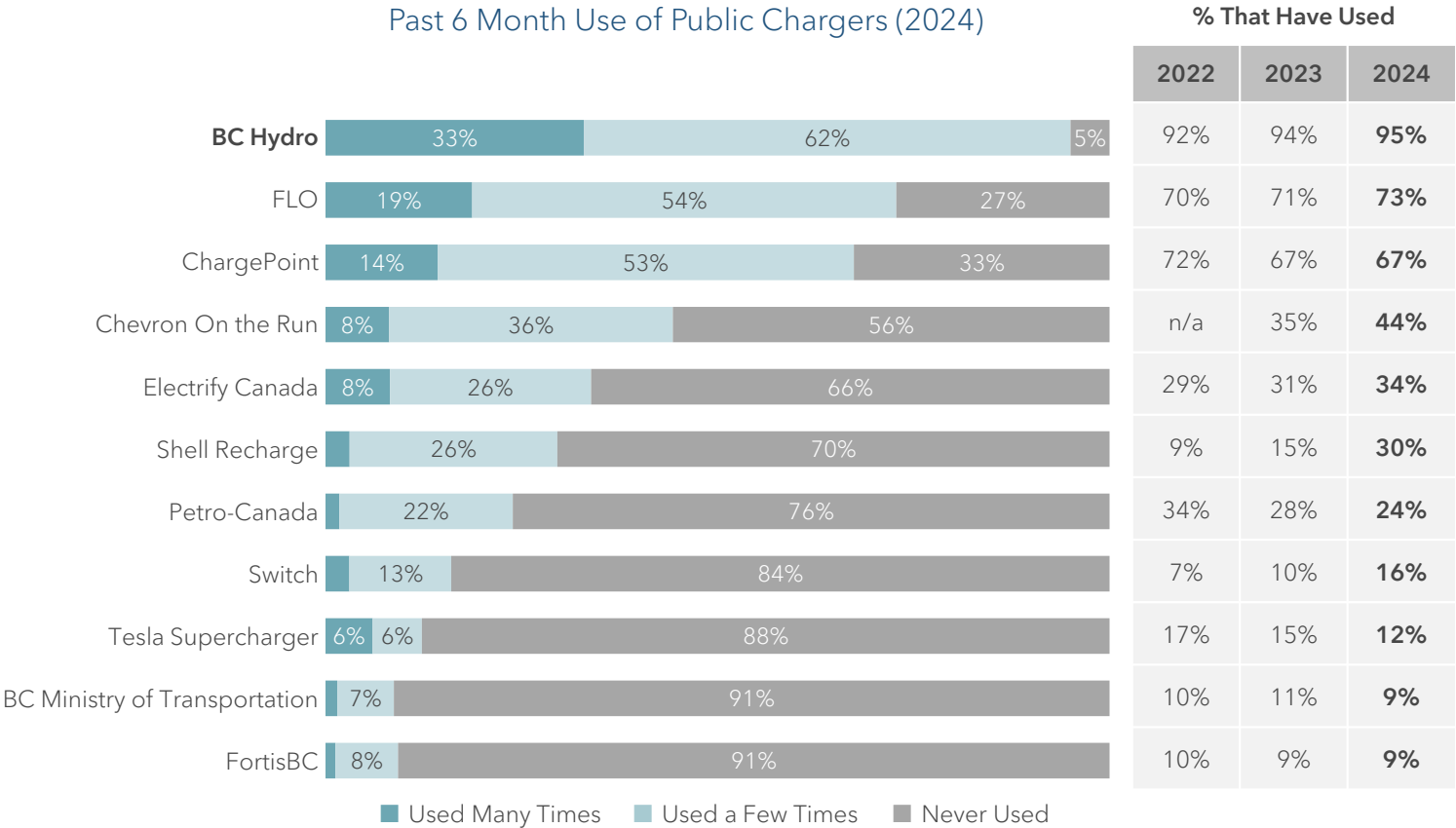


USE OF DIFFERENT PUBLIC CHARGERS

The use of BC Hydro chargers is in line with the last several years, with 95% of survey respondents having used a BC Hydro charger in the past six months. However, frequent use of BC Hydro chargers has increased slightly, from 29% in 2023 to 33% in 2024.

FLO and ChargePoint remain the top alternative charging service providers. However, compared to last year, BC Hydro network members are more likely to have used chargers at Chevron On the Run (up from 35% in 2023 to 44% in 2024 and Shell Recharge (up from 15% in 2023 to 30% in 2024) in the past six months.

There are a few regional differences: Northern BC network members are the most likely to use BC Hydro chargers frequently (40%), while those on Vancouver Island are the least likely to do so (28%).



Sample: Total 2024 (1,813), 2023 (1,877), 2022 (1,277)
Q22. Which of the following EV Services/EV Networks with DC fast charging stations have you used in the last 6 months?



SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

Charging Habits



SHARE OF CHARGING BY LOCATION

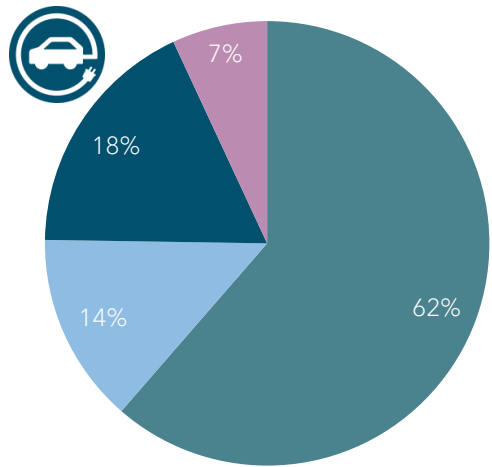
BC Hydro network members provided the percentage of their charging that they do at each of four locations – home, work, BC Hydro chargers, and other public chargers.

In 2024 BC Hydro network members report doing a greater share of their charging at BC Hydro chargers (18%) compared to 2023 (13%). This is due to a shift from home charging – which declined from 67% in 2023 to 62% in 2024.

The share of charging that BC Hydro network members report doing at other public charging stations hasn't change from 2023 and stands at 14%.

- Home
- Other Public Chargers
- BC Hydro Chargers
- Work

Share of Charging by Location (2024)



	Share by Location	
	2022	2023
	(1,277)	(1,877)
Home	68%	67%
Other public Chargers	13%	14%
BCH Chargers	12%	13%
Work	7%	7%

Sample: Total 2024 (1,813)
Q4. Using your best estimate, how often do you charge your EV at the following locations? Please provide a percentage breakdown that totals to 100%.



SHARE OF CHARGING BY LOCATION BY DWELLING TYPE

BC Hydro network members in **detached homes or duplexes** continue to prioritize home charging over other methods, maintaining the same habits as in 2023.

BC Hydro network members in **townhouses or row homes** have shifted more of their charging to BC Hydro chargers - from 10% in 2023 to 16% in 2024.

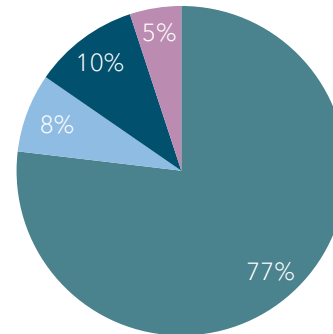
This is also the case among those living in **apartments and condos** who in 2024 reported doing 34% of their charging at BC Hydro stations - up from 30% in 2023.

Both townhouse and apartment/condo dwellers show downward shifts in their use of other public chargers from 2023 to 2024 - down from 14% to 11% among townhouse dwellers and down from 32% to 29% among apartment/condo dwellers.

Share of Charging by Location (2024)

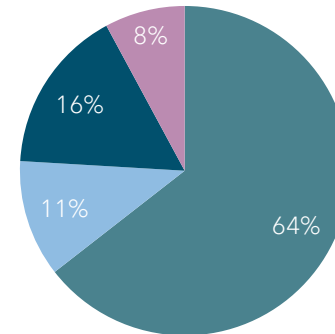
Among those Living in
Detached Home / Duplex

(n=1,033)



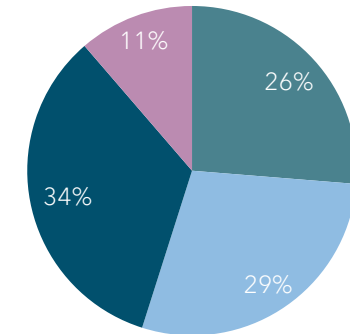
Among those Living in
Townhouse / Row Home

(n=264)



Among those Living in
Apartment / Condo

(n=461)

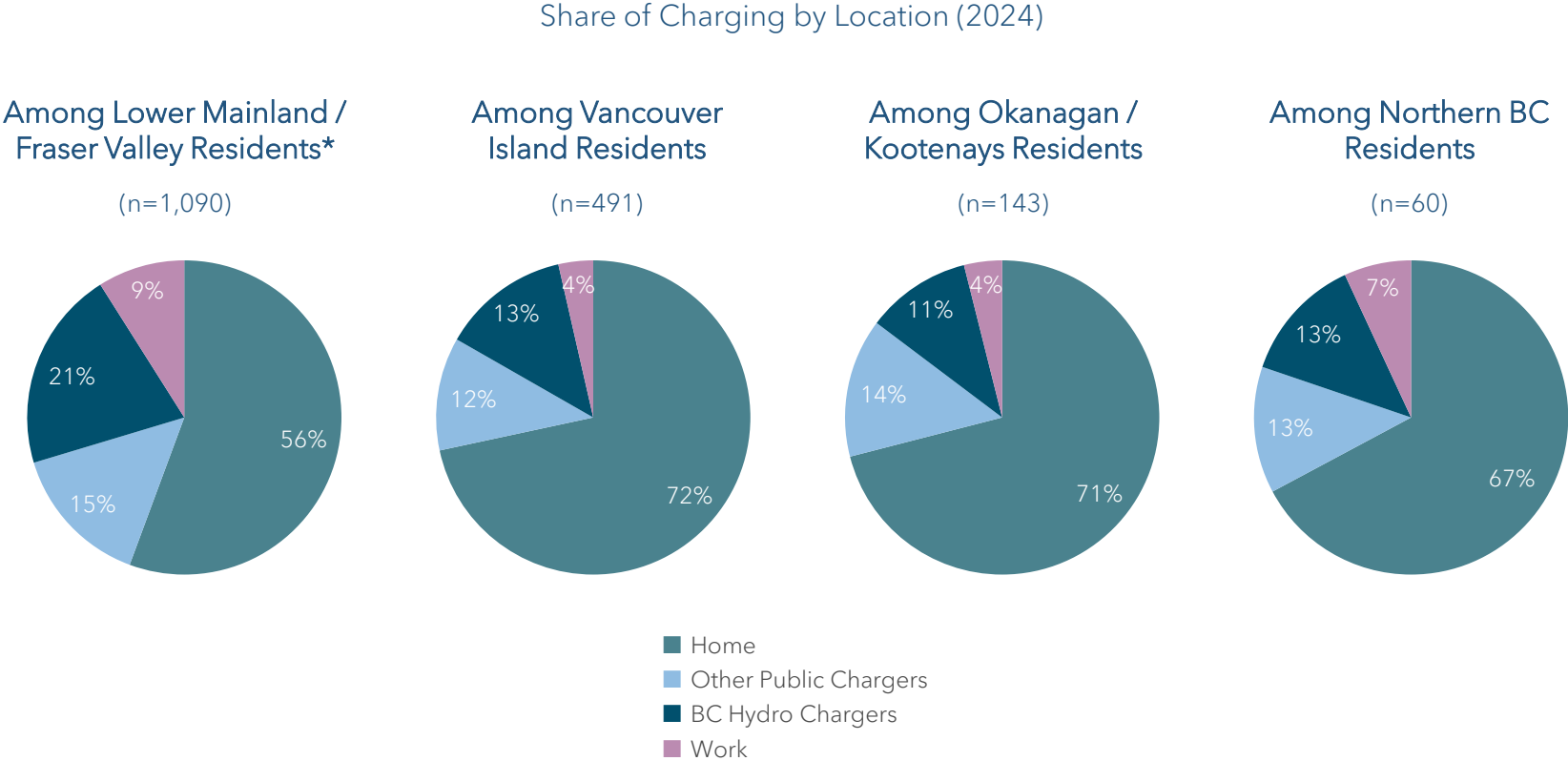


■ Home
■ Other Public Chargers
■ BC Hydro Chargers
■ Work



SHARE OF CHARGING BY LOCATION BY REGION

BC Hydro network members in the **Lower Mainland** have shifted more of their charging from home to BC Hydro public chargers. Home charging dropped from 61% in 2023 to 56% in 2024, while charging at BC Hydro public chargers increased from 16% in 2023 to 21% in 2024.



*Also includes those living on the Sunshine Coast and Sea-to-Sky region.
Q4. Using your best estimate, how often do you charge your EV at the following locations? Please provide a percentage breakdown that totals to 100%.

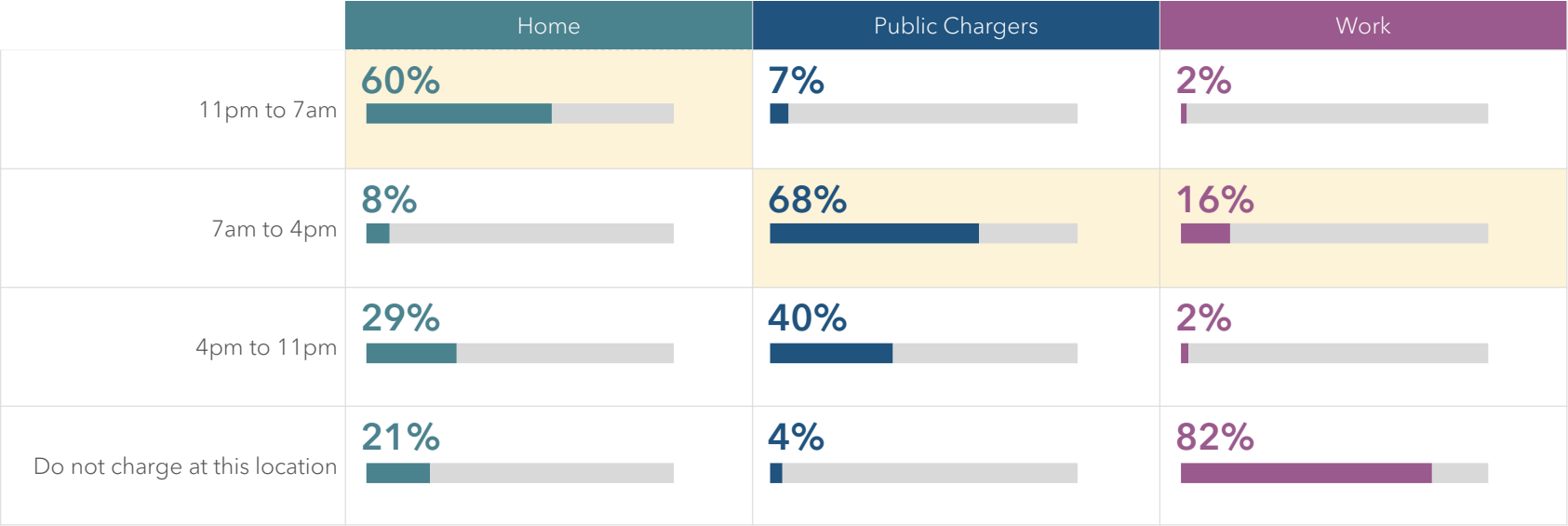


TIMES OF DAY FOR CHARGING

Home Charging: Overnight charging remains the most common, though evening charging dropped significantly, from 40% in 2023 to 29% in 2024.

Public Charging: The use of public chargers continues to be most common between 7 AM and 4 PM – with over two-thirds of BC Hydro network members (68%) accessing public chargers during this time frame.

Work Charging: EV charging while at work continues to be relatively uncommon, with only two-in-ten BC Hydro network members indicating that they charge at work.



Most common time frame(s) at location

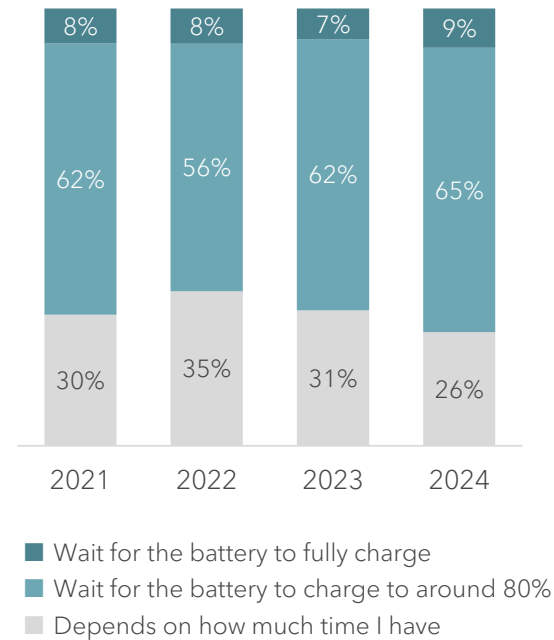
Note: This is a multiple response questions, so percentages within columns will not add up to 100%
Sample: Total 2024 (1,813)
Q6. Between what times of the day do you generally charge your EV at the following location(s)? You may select more than one time frame for a location if your charging is evenly split across time frames.



CHARGING PATTERNS AT PUBLIC CHARGERS

The percentage of drivers charging until their battery reaches about 80% has slightly increased, rising to 65% in 2024 compared to 62% in 2023.

How EV Drivers Charge at Public Chargers



Sample: Use a public charger – 2024 (1,747), 2023 (1,814), 2022 (1,217), 2021 (868)

Q8. Thinking of your usual public charging experience, which of the following is most applicable to you?



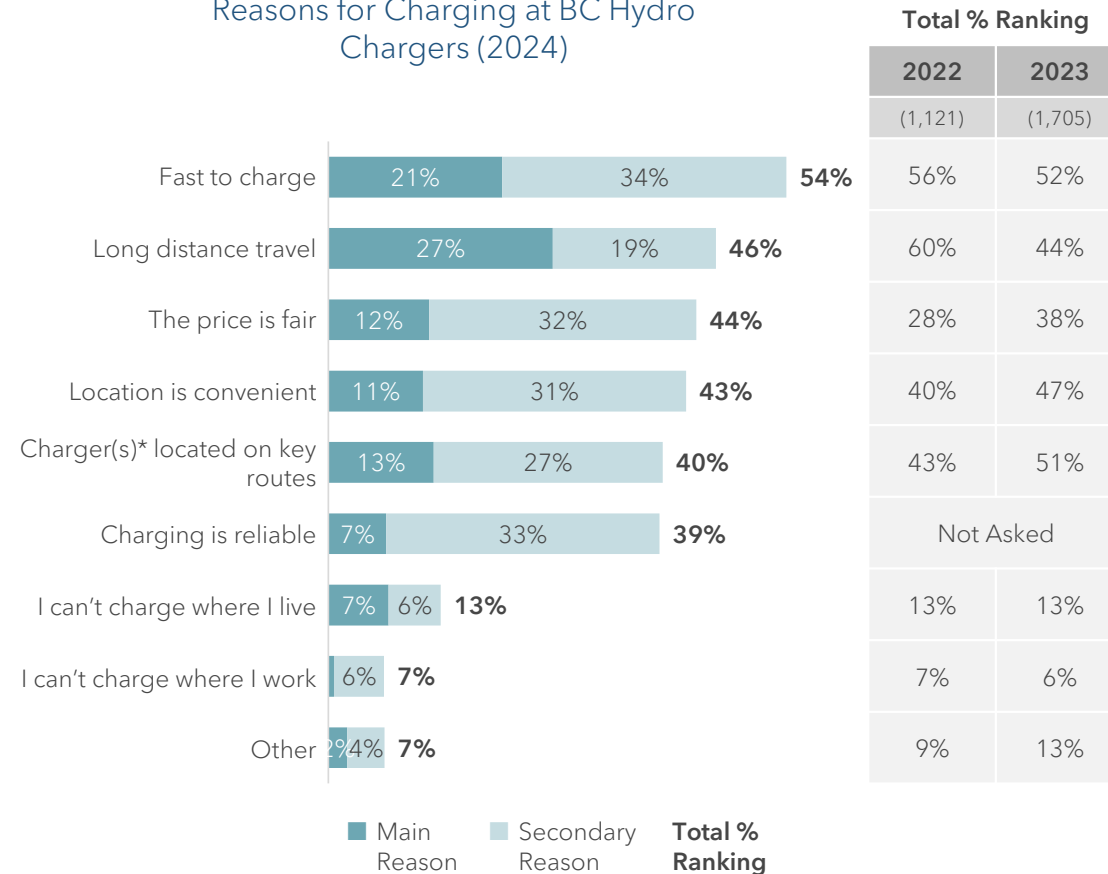
REASONS FOR CHARGING AT BC HYDRO CHARGERS

Fast charging continues to be the most common reason BC Hydro network members choose BC Hydro chargers.

Long-distance travel, fair pricing, convenient locations, chargers being located on key routes, and reliable charging are also relatively common reasons why BC Hydro network members use BC Hydro chargers.

BC Hydro network members were more likely to cite fair pricing as a reason for charging at BC Hydro chargers (44% in 2024 compared to 38% in 2023) and less likely to cite chargers being located on key routes as a reason for charging at BC Hydro chargers (40% in 2024 compared to 51% in 2023).

Reasons for Charging at BC Hydro Chargers (2024)



*Question wording updated from "Stations" to "Charger(s)" in 2024

Sample: Use BC Hydro Charging Stations - 2024 (1,646)

Q10a. Earlier you mentioned that you use BC Hydro's public chargers. What's the main reason you use BC Hydro's public chargers? Select one only.

Q10b. Are there any other reasons you use BC Hydro's public chargers? Select all that apply.



SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

Idle Fee



IDLE FEE AWARENESS AND PRECEPTIONS

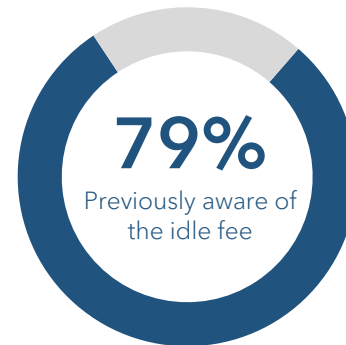
Eight-in-ten BC Hydro network members who use BC Hydro chargers are aware of the idle fee.

Most (69%) of those who were previously aware of the idle fee say that their overall experience at BC Hydro chargers hasn't changed since the implementation of the fee.

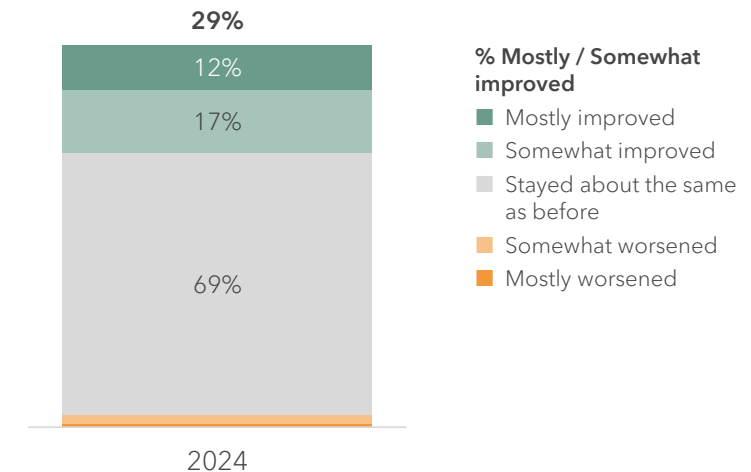
However, over one-quarter (29%) say that their experience has improved while only 2% say it's worsened.

Those in the Lower Mainland/FV and Vancouver Island are more likely to have experienced improvements, 32% and 26%, respectively, compared to those in the Okanagan/Kootenays (13%) and in Northern BC (17%).

Idle fee awareness
(among those who use BC Hydro Chargers)



Change in experience since idle fee
(among those aware of idle fee)



Sample: Use BC Hydro Chargers- 2024 (1,646)

Sample: Those aware of idle fee - 2024 (1,305)

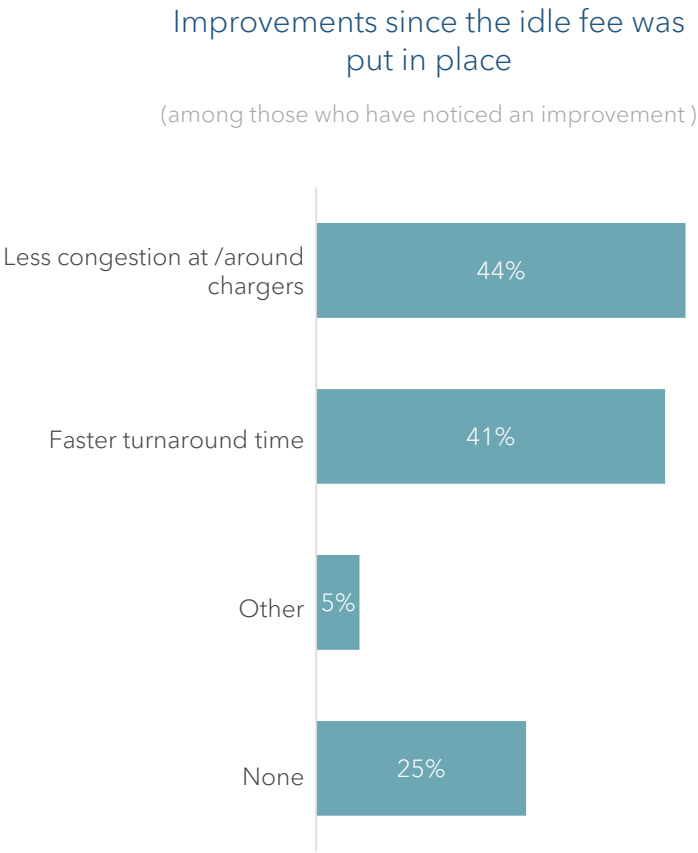
IDLE_FEE_0. Were you previously aware of the idle fee?

IFLE_FEE_1. Since the implementation of the idle fee, has your overall experience at BC Hydro public chargers improved, worsened, or stayed around the same as before?



IMPROVEMENTS - IDLE FEE

The most common benefits experienced as a result of the introduction of the idle fee are less congestion and faster turnaround times.



Sample: Seen improvement since Idle Fee was put in place- 2024 (369)
Sample: Use BC Hydro Chargers- 2024 (1,646)
IDLE_FEE_2. Thinking of your recent visits to BC Hydro public chargers, have you noticed any of the following improvements? Select all that apply.
IDLE_FEE_5. To what extent do you support or oppose the implementation of an idle fee charge at BC Hydro Level 2 chargers to encourage drivers to move on when they're finished charging?



Notable Feedback about the Idle Fee



Idle fee has not impacted experience

"Increase in EV cars has meant more people wanting to charge which counters the idle fee..."

"I still find some vehicles at stations even if they are fully charged. Owners are not nearby. They just left the vehicle plugged-in. You have to increase the idle fee and decrease the regular charging cost."

"I have not seen any reduction in waiting times since the idle fee came in. Generally, people leave as soon as they are finished. I have rarely seen an unattended car at a Hydro charger."

"I generally find that users of the BC Hydro chargers do not leave the station unattended, I believe the app provides good feedback to charging status."

"The big issue for me is the availability of BC Hydro chargers in the city of Vancouver. I haven't personally seen any improvements in availability as a result of the idle fee."

"It's still cheap to park in cities even with an idle fee. People leave their cars plugged in. Turnover is an issue. I would recommend charging stops at 90% charge and idle fee is \$1/minute."

Idle fee has worsened experience

"Rushed to get back to avoid idle fee"

"5 minutes is too short."

"Idle fees can create a stressful experience as users feel rushed to move their car immediately after charging. This is especially challenging in situations where it might not be convenient to return to the car on time."

"BC Hydro stations start charging the idle fee at 80%, even if I need to charge more and have not been there 45 minutes."

"Can't go out for lunch and charge because I have to move vehicle"

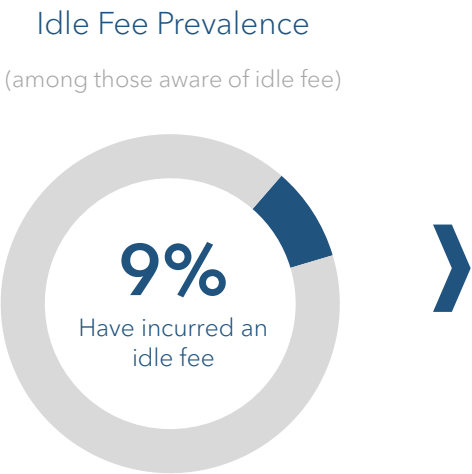
"I try to get back to my car but if I get held up somewhere I don't like the charge. I think you should have 20 to 30 minutes grace after a charge is done."



REASON FOR INCCURING IDLE FEE

One-in-ten who use BC Hydro public charges have incurred the idle fee.

The most common reason why drivers incur the idle fee is that they have an important activity to finish nearby.



Reason for Idle Fee

(among those who have incurred an idle fee)

	2024
Sample (incurred an Idle Fee)	111
Had an important activity to finish nearby	37%
Didn't know an idle fee would incur	14%
Did not receive an idle fee notification (e.g. in-app or SMS)	14%
Willing to pay amount for a longer stay	12%
Forgot about the idle fee	6%
Was late to return to the car / took time to unplug the EV (unaided)	5%
Issues with the system / charger (unaided)	5%
Lost track of time (unaided)	3%
Other	3%

Sample: Those aware of idle fee – 2024 (1,305)
Sample: Those who have incurred an idle fee – 2024 (111)
IDLE_FEE_3a. Have you incurred an idle fee?
IDLE_FEE_4. We would like to better understand how our idle fee is working. Please select which of the following is the most important reason why you incurred the fee.



SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

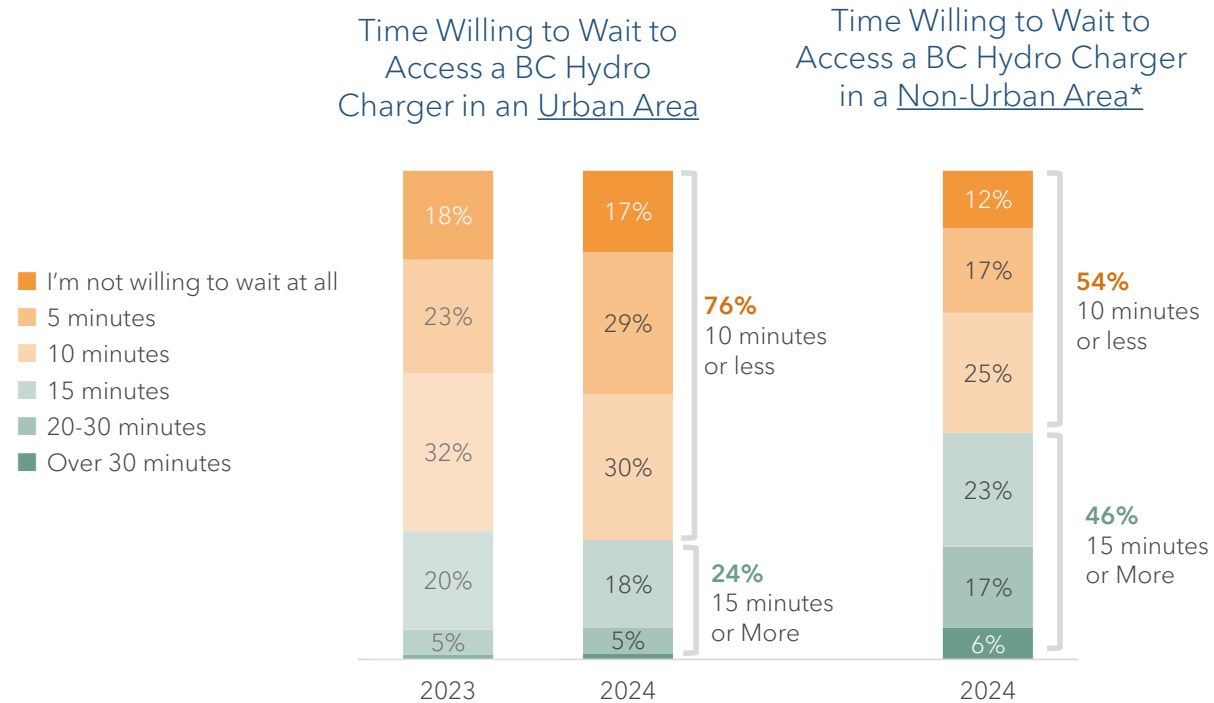
Public Charging Habits



WILLINGNESS TO WAIT TO ACCESS A BC HYDRO CHARGER

BC Hydro network members are more willing to wait longer at non-urban locations like highway charging stations, with 46% prepared to wait 15 minutes or more. In contrast, only 24% are willing to wait that long at urban chargers.

The results show that BC Hydro network members are becoming less tolerant of wait times at urban chargers. In 2023, 41% said that they were willing to wait 5 minutes or less – this increased to 46% in 2024.



Sample: Use a public charger - 2023 (1,814), 2024 (1,747)

*Q12 wording updated in 2024, so can not be trended.

Q11d. BC Hydro is looking into how many chargers a busy site should have. How long are you willing to wait to get access to an available BC Hydro charger in an urban area?

Q12. How long are you willing to wait to get access to an available BC Hydro charger in a non-urban area, such as at a highway charger during a road trip?

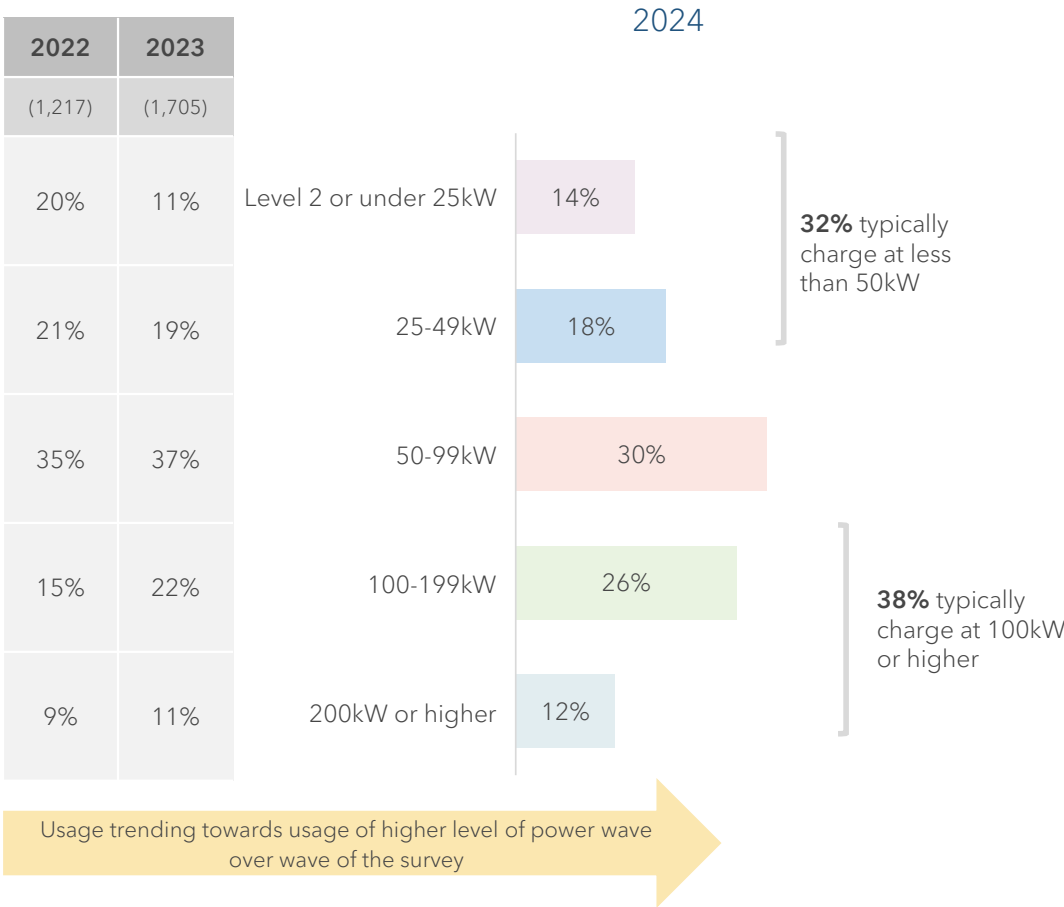


POWER LEVELS USED AT PUBLIC CHARGERS

Power Level Used Most Often at Public Chargers

Charging at 50-99 kW remains the most common choice, though it's declined from 37% in 2023 to 30% in 2024.

BC Hydro network members are increasingly charging at higher power levels. The percentage of drivers using chargers rated at 100 kW or higher has steadily grown, rising from 24% in 2022 to 33% in 2023 and reaching 38% in 2024. This is mostly driven by the increase in charging at 100-199kW which has steadily increased in use over the years.



Sample: Use BC Hydro Charging Stations - 2024 (1,646)
Q17. What charger power level do you use most often when charging your EV at public chargers



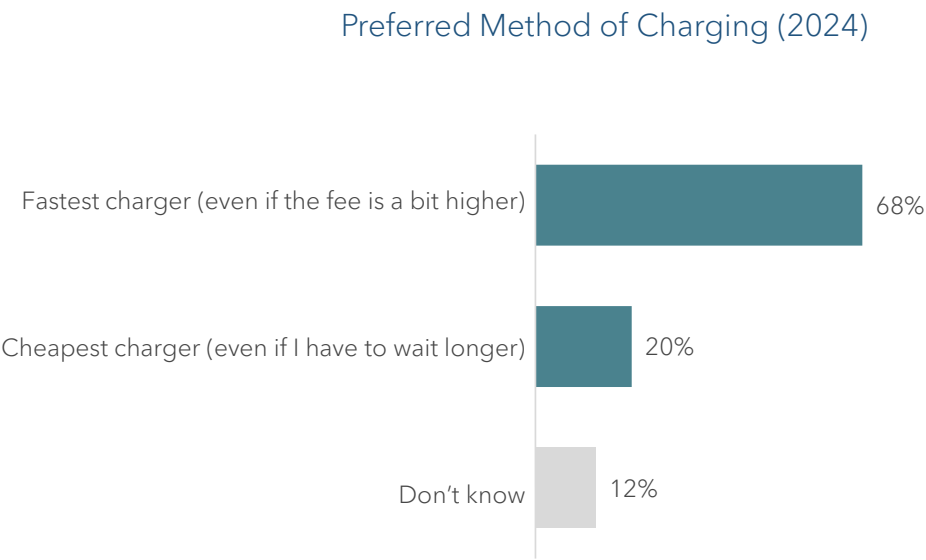
SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

Rates & Pricing



CHARGING: FASTEST VS. CHEAPEST

Fast charging remains the preferred choice, with just over two-thirds of BC Hydro network members (68%) choosing it over slower, cheaper options.



2021	2022	2023
(868)	(1,121)	(1,705)
60%	67%	67%
29%	21%	21%
12%	12%	11%

Sample: Use BC Hydro Charging Stations – 2024 (1,646)
Q19. The higher the charger power rating (e.g., 50kW, 100kW), the less time it takes to give your EV the same amount of charge. Assuming that fees at public chargers would be calculated based on charging speed and time, which of the following statements would be most applicable to you? Please select one.



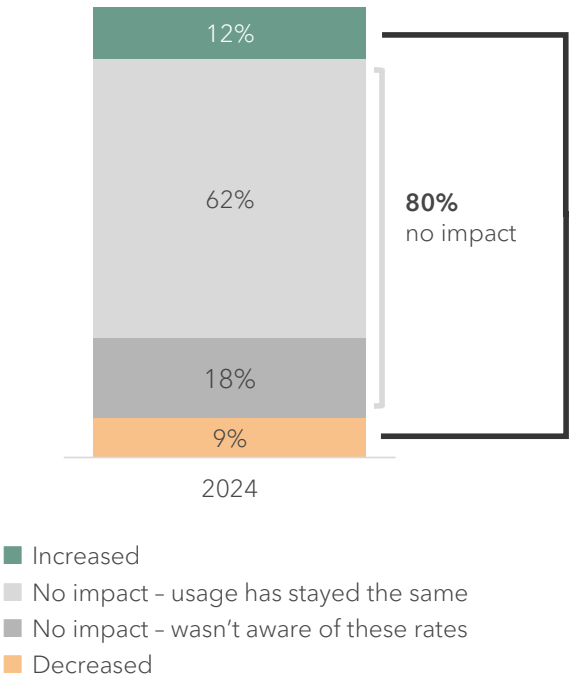
IMPACT OF CHARGING RATE CHANGE

The recent shift from time-based billing has had minimal impact, with 80% of BC Hydro network members reporting no change in their usage.

This new rate structure has had the greatest positive impact on long-distance travel, with 43% of drivers who adjusted their usage since the rate change reporting increased use of BC Hydro chargers during long-distance trips.

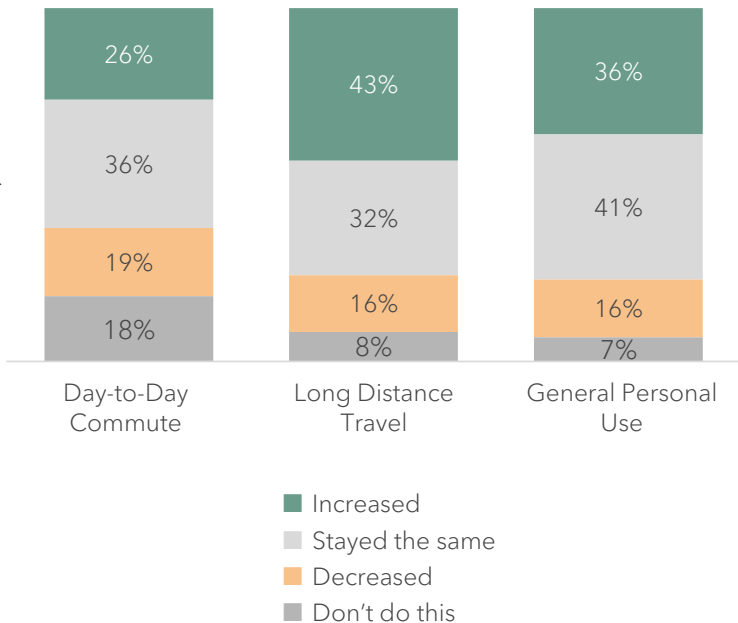
Impact of Charging Rates Implemented in May 2024*

(among those who use BC Hydro chargers)



Impact By Type of Use (2024)*

(among those who increased or decreased usage due to the rate implementations)



Sample: Use BC Hydro Charging Stations – 2024 (1,646)

Sample: Increase or decreased usage due to the rate implementation – 2024 (336)

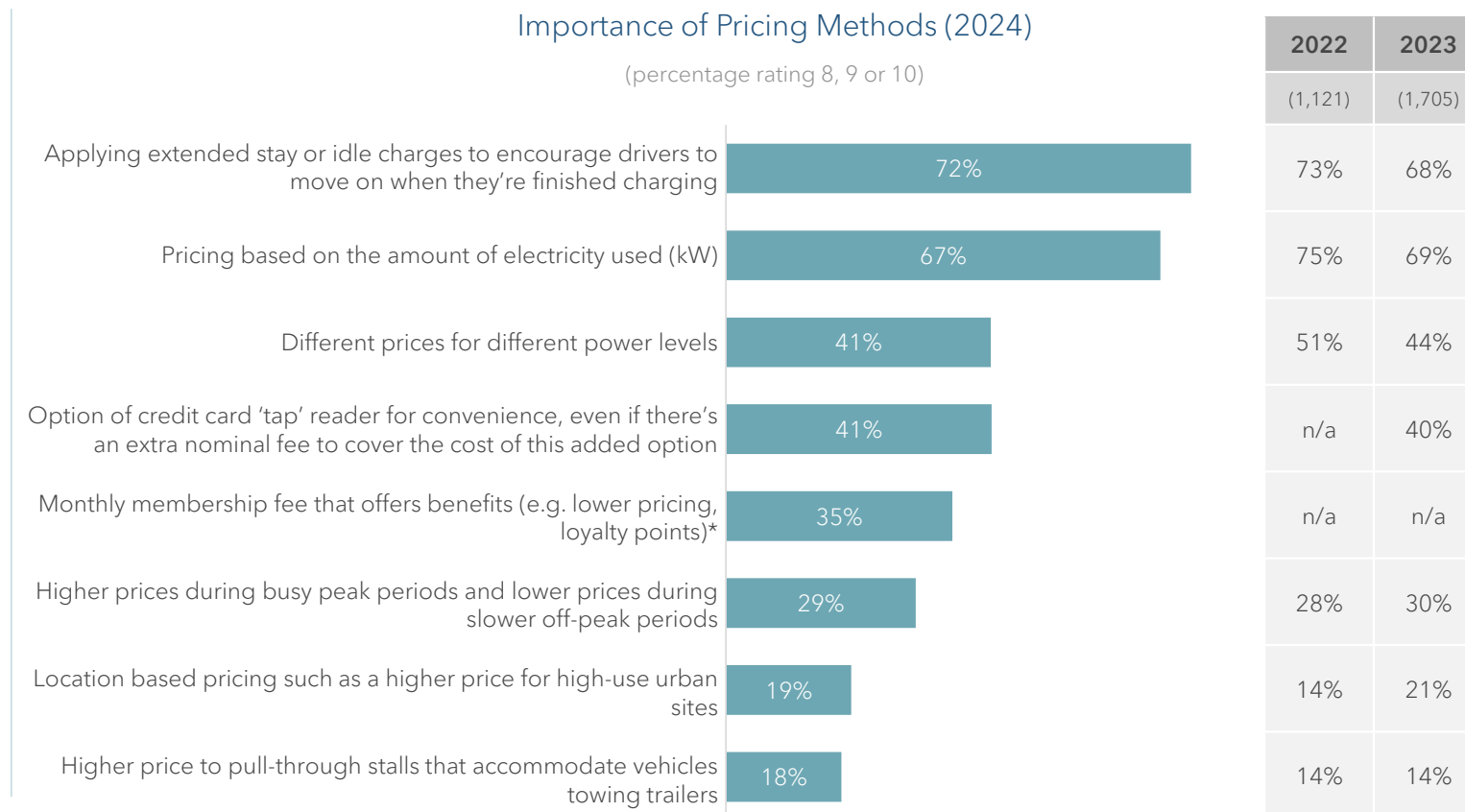
*Question updated in 2024 so trending is not available

Q14. In May 2024, BC Hydro implemented energy-based charging rates (Level 2 charging - \$0.2865 per kWh; fast charging (25kW or higher - \$0.3479/kWh) at its public chargers to replace time-based billing. How would you say this has impacted your usage of these public chargers? Please select one. Q15. How has your usage changed in the following use cases?



IMPORTANCE OF PRICING METHODS

The importance of applying an idle fee has increased by 4 points since last year, making it the most important pricing method. Pricing solely based on electricity usage also remains a top choice.



*Answer option was updated in 2024, so not possible to trend with past waves.

Sample: Use BC Hydro Chargers- 2024 (1,646)

Q16. On a scale from 1 to 10 where 1 means 'not at all important' and 10 means 'extremely important' please rate how important the following pricing methods are to you.



PERCEIVED VALUE OF BC HYDRO CHARGERS

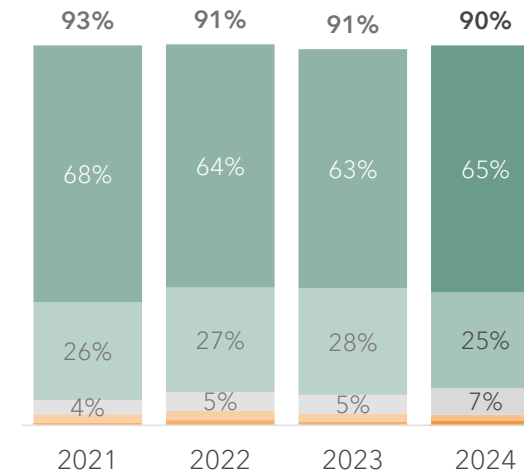
BC Hydro network members continue to see value in BC Hydro chargers, with 9 out of 10 agreeing they benefit from their availability, and two-thirds (65%) strongly agreeing.

Over three-quarters of BC Hydro network members agree that BC Hydro's charging fees are reasonable.

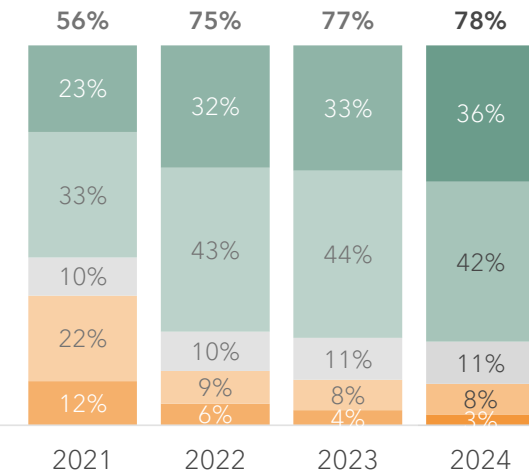
% Strongly Agree / Somewhat Agree

- Strongly Agree
- Somewhat Agree
- Neither
- Somewhat Disagree
- Strongly Disagree

EV drivers benefit from the availability of BC Hydro public chargers



BC Hydro charges reasonable fees (Level 2 charging - \$0.2865/kWh, fast charging/ 25 kW or higher - \$0.3479/kWh, and idle fee - \$0.40/minute) to charge my EV.*



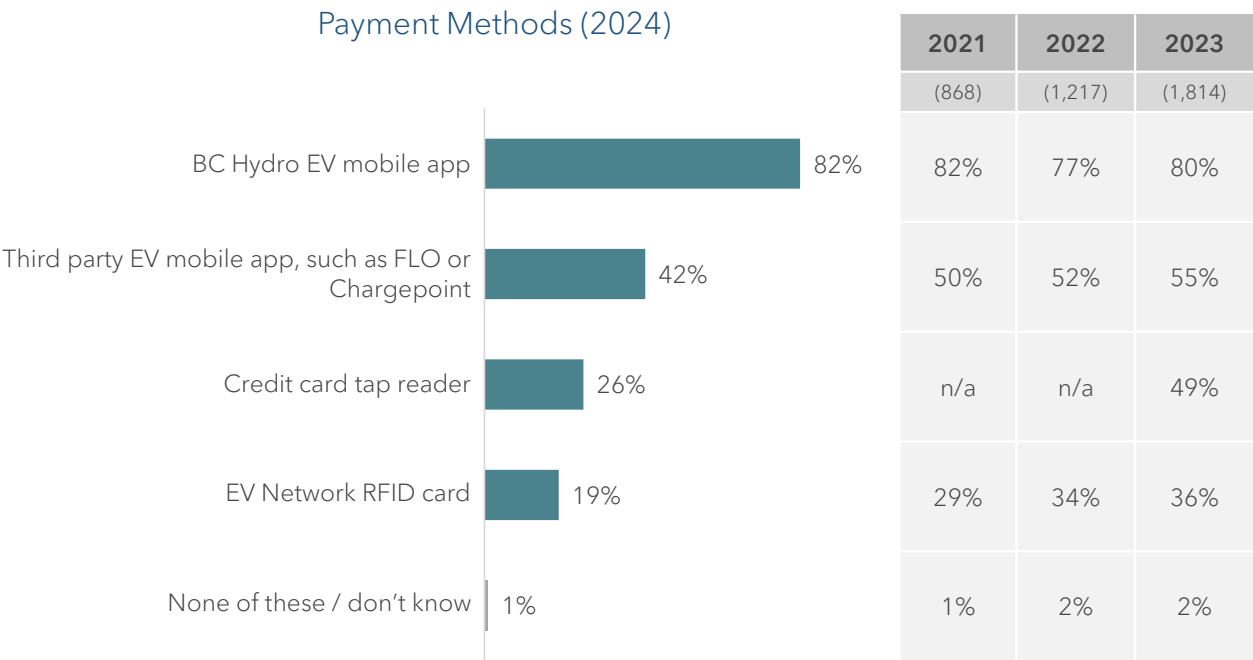
*Rates updated in 2024. 2023 and older question text: BC Hydro charges reasonable fees (for 25kW - 0.12/min, 50kW - 0.21/min and 100kW - 0.27/min) to charge my EV
Sample: Use BC Hydro Public Chargers- 2024 (1,646), 2023 (1,705), 2022 (1,121), 2021 (868)
Q20. To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statements:



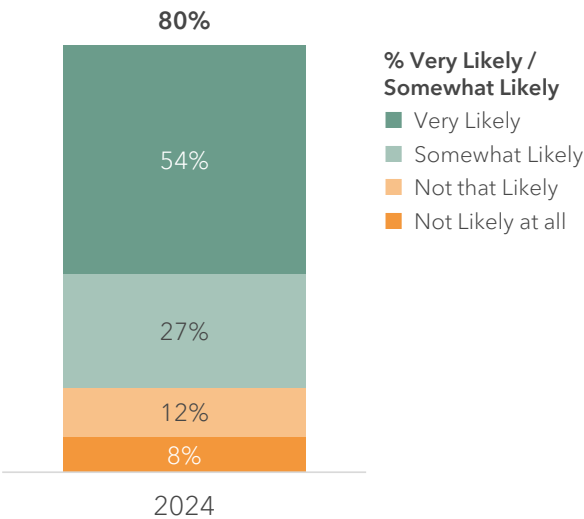
PAYMENT METHODS

The BC Hydro mobile app remains the most common payment method, unchanged from last year. While still the second most common payment method, the use of third-party EV apps has dropped significantly from 55% in 2023 to 42% in 2024. The use of Credit card tap readers and EV network/RFID cards have also dropped significantly this year.

Eight-in-ten BC Hydro network members would be likely to choose to have their public charging session costs integrated with their residential electricity bill.



Desire to integrate public charging costs with residential bill



Sample: Use a public charger – 2024 (1,747)
Q13. Which of the following methods are you most likely to use to active a charge at a public charger? Please select all that apply / Q13bill. If an option to integrate your BC Hydro public charging session costs into your BC Hydro residential electricity bill was made available to you in the future, how likely would you consider signing up?



SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

Home Charging



HOME & PUBLIC CHARGING

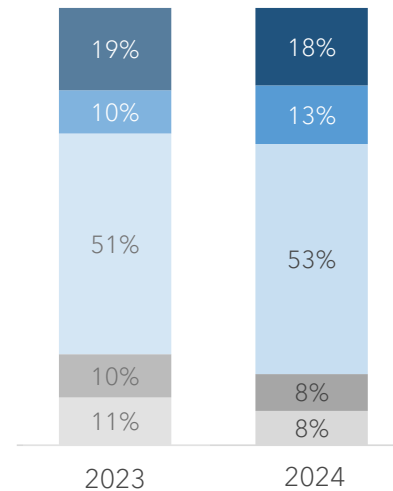
Home charging habits remain consistent with last year, with most users (53%) charging when the battery drops below a certain level.

This is also the most common practice at public chargers. However, public charging users are more likely to lack a typical charging pattern compared to home users (23% vs 8%).

Those who primarily use lower-power public chargers (Level 2 or under 25 kW) are more likely to charge whenever they have an opportunity to top up (22% vs 12%-14% at higher power levels).

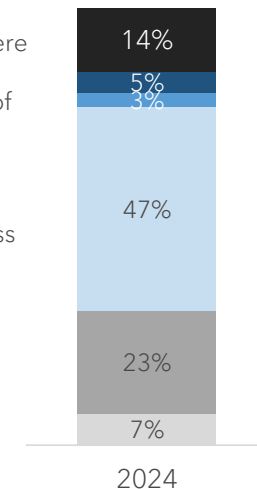
- Keep my charger plugged in regardless of state of charge
- Plug in to fully charge after every few days regardless of state of charge
- Plug in to fully charge whenever my battery drops below a certain amount
- No typical charging pattern at home
- Other

When EV Drivers Charge at Home



When EV Drivers Charge Publicly

- I charge my vehicle whenever there is an opportunity to top-up at or near my destination, regardless of state of charge.
- I charge my vehicle everyday regardless of state of charge
- I charge every few days regardless of the state of charge
- I charge whenever my battery drops below a certain amount
- No typical charging pattern at home
- Other



Sample: Charge at public chargers- 2024 (1,747)

Sample: Charge at home - 2023 (1,604), 2024 (1,438),

Q5c. Which of the following statements best describes how you typically charge your EV at home?

Q5d. Which of the following statements best describes how you typically charge at public chargers? New Question in 2024



CHARGING LEVELS AT HOME

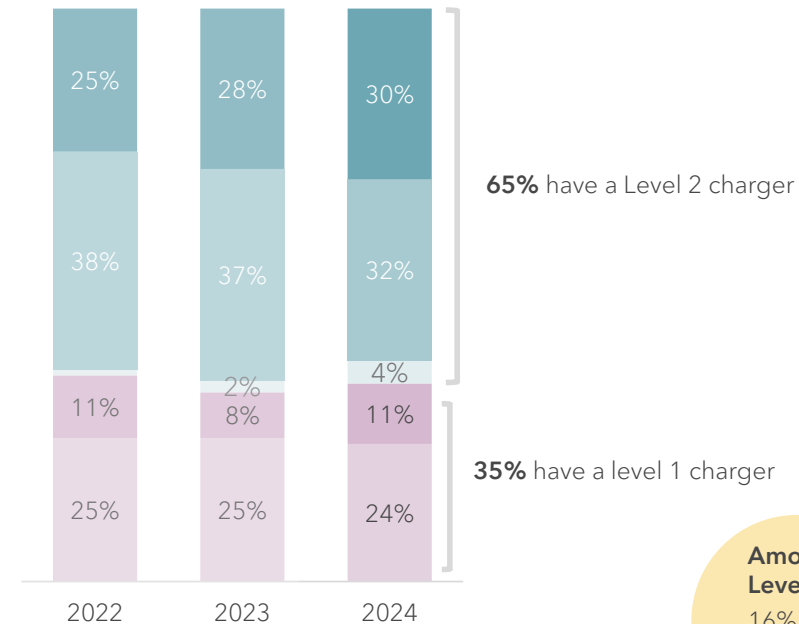
Use of Level 1 and Level 2 chargers has remained stable, with about two-thirds using a Level 2 charger and one-third using a Level 1 charger. Among those using a Level 2 charger, 46% have it connected to the internet, half do not, and the remainder are unsure.

Frequent users of BC Hydro chargers are less likely to own a Level 2 charger (58%) compared to occasional users (67%) and those who haven't used a BC Hydro charger in the past six months (72%).

Plans to upgrade to Level 2 charging remain consistent with previous years, with 70% of current Level 1 users planning to upgrade within the next six months.

Type of EV Charger at Home

- Level 2: Networked (Internet-connected)
- Level 2: Non-networked (not connected to Internet)
- Level 2: Don't know if it networked/non-networked
- Level 1: Plan to install to Level 2 within 6 months
- Level 1: No plans to install Level 2



Among those with a Level 2 Charger:
16% have Grizzl-E
14% have ChargePoint
8% have Tesla

Sample: Charge at home – 2024 (1,438), 2023 (1,604), 2022 (1,095)

Q31. What level is the EV charger you have at home? Please select one only. / Q32. Is your Level 2 charger... / Q33a. What's the make of your Level 2 charger? /

Q36. Do you plan to install a Level 2 charger in the next six months? / Q37. Do you plan to install a Level 2 charger that is...

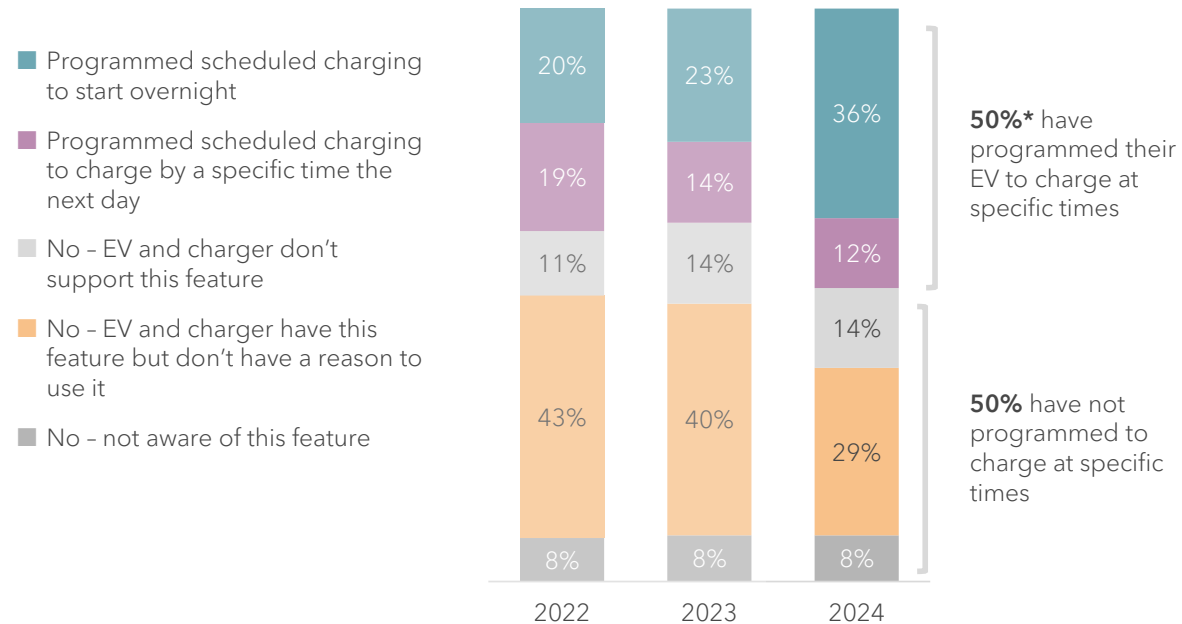


LEVEL 2 CHARGER PROGRAMING

Half (50%) of those using Level 2 chargers now program their EVs to charge at specific times, up from 38% last year. This increase is driven by more users scheduling their charging to start overnight.

The percentage of those with Level 2 chargers with cars or chargers that don't support programmed charging has remained steady. However, fewer of those with programmed scheduled charging capability choose not to use it, dropping from 40% in 2023 to 29% in 2024.

Use of Start and Stop Feature on Level 2 Charger



*Includes the 2% not listed in the chart that programmed their EV charger to start/stop using an "Other" method.

Sample: Have a Level 2 charger - 2024 (883), 2023 (1,044), 2022 (680)

Q34. Have you ever programmed your EV and EV charger to start and stop at a specific time? Please select only one. / Q35. Which of the following statements would be most applicable to you?

BC Hydro Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates

Evaluation Report for Year One

Appendix D

EV Charging Service Jurisdictional Review Conducted by EY

**Jurisdiction Scan
of Public Electric
Vehicle (EV)
Charging Rates in
British Columbia**

Prepared for BC Hydro

31 July 2025



The better the question. The better the answer.
The better the world works.



Shape the future
with confidence

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1. Executive Summary

Ernst & Young LLP (EY) was engaged by BC Hydro to conduct a jurisdictional scan of public electric vehicle (EV) charging services and rates in British Columbia (B.C.), Canada, as of July 2025.

EV charging infrastructure continues to scale rapidly with over 35,423 public ports across Canada – 7,178 of which are in B.C.¹. BC Hydro operates one of the country's largest utility-owned fast-charging networks and is expanding access in both urban and rural areas. Public charging services operate under a variety of models, including utility-owned, host-operated, and municipal-led networks. These models shape how infrastructure is funded, priced, and managed, resulting in a diverse range of user experiences and cost structures.

As there is a growing shift toward energy-based (per kWh) pricing to ensure greater fairness across different vehicle types, BC Hydro's current rate of \$0.3609/kWh for DC fast charging remains among the more affordable options in the market. In comparison, other charging operators in British Columbia typically charge between \$0.28 to \$0.90/kWh² depending on factors such as ownership structure, funding models, and operational costs. The current BC Hydro Level 2 charging rate, set at \$0.2972/kWh, supports public access to EV charging at a relatively affordable rate, aligning with broader market trends in British Columbia that typically range from \$0.15 to \$0.50/kWh. Additionally, many charging operators offer Level 2 charging at no cost, often subsidized by site hosts as a means to attract EV-driving customers. To improve charger availability, many networks including BC Hydro are also implementing idle fees and exploring alternative pricing models.

Looking ahead, developments such as ultra-fast charging, roaming interoperability, and dynamic pricing pilots point to a rapidly evolving and increasingly sophisticated charging landscape across B.C.

This report provides a brief overview of this current landscape of public EV charging services and rates, emphasizing the sector's evolving nature and providing insights that may inform future investment planning and regulatory considerations.

¹ Natural-resources.canada.ca: Electric Charging and Alternative Fuelling Stations Locator on 8 July 2025

² EY Market Study based on publicly available information

2. Introduction

2.1 Context

As EV adoption accelerates across Canada, the public charging landscape is evolving to meet rising demand while balancing cost recovery, customer experience, and grid optimization. Accordingly, utilities, municipalities, and private operators are experimenting with a range of pricing structures and business models that reflect regional policies, infrastructure costs, and customer needs.

This report was prepared by EY for BC Hydro as a high-level jurisdiction scan of public EV charging developments across B.C. It provides a brief overview, based on a sample dataset, of the current state of infrastructure deployment, operating models, and pricing structures covering both energy and time-based approaches as well as associated fee mechanisms. Comparative insights from publicly available data sources were leveraged to also provide perspectives on how comparable jurisdictions are currently pricing their charging services.

2.2 Overview

Canada's public EV charging network continues to expand rapidly, with over 33,700 public charging ports installed nationwide as of early 2025 – a 24.2% year-over-year increase. This includes more than 6,300 Direct Current Fast Chargers (DCFC) and 27,400 Level 2 (L2) chargers, supporting the country's transition to zero-emission transportation³. British Columbia remains at the forefront of EV adoption in Canada, with over 195,000 EVs on the road and 22.4% of new light-duty vehicle sales classified as zero-emission vehicles (ZEVs) in 2024⁴.

As of July 2025, there are approximately 7,178 public EV charging ports across 2,451 public charging sites in British Columbia (B.C.) of these, 5,112 ports are L2 chargers, and 2,066 ports are DC fast chargers⁵. These installations reflect a 24.6%⁶ year-over-year increase in the province's public charging infrastructure in 2024 compared to 2023, highlighting continued investment to support transportation electrification and EV adoption across both urban and rural areas. BC Hydro plays a major role in the province's charging infrastructure development, operating a substantial utility-deployed fast-charging network that is among the most extensive in Canada. BC Hydro's network includes over 600 charging ports at more than 147 locations, with plans to expand to 800+ ports by 2026⁷.

Public EV charging across Canada operates under various models, including utility-owned networks (e.g., BC Hydro, Hydro-Québec), private operators (like FLO, Tesla, ChargePoint), municipal partnerships, and retail-hosted stations. These models differ in ownership, pricing structures, and customer experience, contributing to a diverse and decentralized national charging landscape.

Key trends shaping the sector in 2025 include growth in ultra-fast charging (150-350 kW), adoption of energy-based pricing, increasing interoperability across networks, and the shift toward NACS (North American Charging Standard) connectors. Investments are also targeting underserved rural and Indigenous communities to improve equitable access⁸.

³ [Electricautonomy.ca](https://electricautonomy.ca)

⁴ [Connect.electrumcharging.com](https://connect.electrumcharging.com), Government of British Columbia's 2024 Zero-Emission Vehicle Update

⁵ Electric Charging and Alternative Fuelling Stations Locator as on 7 July 2025

⁶ Government of British Columbia's 2024 Zero-Emission Vehicle Update

⁷ BC Hydro's EV public charging progress report April 2025

⁸ Electric Autonomy Canada - 2025 Network Report

3. Approach & Methodology

This jurisdictional scan provides insights into public EV charging pricing structures and operating models across several major network operators in B.C. The scan focuses on publicly available data sources, including published network operator rates, mobile applications of private operators and third-party databases. It provides an overview, based on sample data, of pricing mechanisms (such as energy-based and time-based models), fee structures (including idle and session-based charges), and operational characteristics to reflect both current practices and emerging trends in the public EV charging sector.

The charging networks selected for the study employ a range of ownership models (e.g., utility-owned, private network, municipal), charger types (e.g., DCFC and L2), and pricing structures (e.g., energy-based, time based). Rather than evaluating individual charger in isolation, this scan provides insights into BC Hydro's rates relative to a sample set to depict relative market positioning across key pricing dimensions as of available data in July 2025.

The report includes insights on:

- Collection of posted charging rates for both DCFC and L2 chargers across selected networks in B.C.
- Alignment of all pricing comparisons to a standardized \$/kWh basis, where possible, to enable consistent perspectives across networks

3.1 Data Sources

The scan draws on various publicly available databases, including:

- Charging site-level data from platforms such as ChargeHub⁹, PlugShare¹⁰, and NRCan's Electric Charging Station Locator¹¹
- Official pricing information published on network operator websites and mobile applications which have been used to validate pricing posted on the above databases

3.2 Sampling Approach

A representative sample of public EV charging sites was compiled to support the scan of charging operators and associated rates. The dataset includes a range of charger types, network operators, and pricing models selected from B.C. To maximize accuracy and consistency, publicly available pricing data was validated against official government sources and operator mobile applications.

To ensure a representative and comprehensive analysis of public EV charging infrastructure, the sample was manually curated by selecting sites across specific criteria. Charging locations were selected based on varying ownership models (including public agencies, private enterprises, and utility-led initiatives), the scope and nature of services offered (e.g., Level 2 and DC fast charging), station power ratings, and geographic contexts such as urban, suburban, and rural environments. This targeted manual selection

⁹ ChargeHub EV Charging Station Locator

¹⁰ PlugShare EV Charging Station Locator

¹¹ NRCan's Electric Charging and Alternative Fuelling Stations Locator

enabled meaningful comparisons across different operational, technological, and locational profiles throughout B.C.

Table 1: Total sample collected for the study	
Total count of charging operators considered in scan	9
Total count of charging sites considered in scan	101

Note: Table 9 in the appendix presents a comprehensive list of the samples collected

3.3 Assumptions and Limitations

The scan reflects conditions and pricing data as of July 2025. It does not include promotional, fleet-specific, or location-dependent pricing unless explicitly published. While efforts were made to include a representative range of operators and geographies, the sample is not exhaustive and may not capture every business model currently in use. Additionally, differences in network maturity, regulatory oversight, service design, and cost recovery approaches may influence pricing in ways that are not fully comparable across jurisdictions.

This report presents data obtained from publicly available sources, including third-party databases, network operator and government websites, and regulatory filings. While reasonable efforts were made to validate and cross-reference this information - particularly through government sources and customer-facing pricing in operators' mobile applications (i.e., Apps) as of the report date. The data used in this study was collected in mid-July 2025. Given the dynamic nature of EV charging rates and related policies, some figures may vary over time or differ across sources. As such, inconsistencies may exist due to real-time fluctuations and differences in data availability.

Consequently, EY makes no representations or warranties, express or implied, regarding the accuracy, completeness, or reliability of the data and accepts no liability for any direct or indirect loss arising from its use. No proprietary or customer-specific billing data were utilized in this scan. Pricing comparisons are based on posted rates and may not account for variations due to site-level infrastructure costs, energy procurement models, or localized incentives.

Additionally, we recognize that differences in regulatory environments, network maturity, service design, and cost recovery mechanisms across jurisdictions may influence price comparability. Variations in underlying energy costs between British Columbia (B.C.) and other jurisdictions can significantly affect pricing structures. These jurisdictional differences were acknowledged but not adjusted for in this analysis, and comparisons should be interpreted considering these contextual factors.

It should also be noted that the total number of charging sites / ports reported for a given charging operator or region may vary across data sources due to differences in reporting methodology, frequency of updates, and network classification criteria. As a result, station counts referenced in this scan may not align precisely with every publicly available dataset.

4. Pricing and Fee Structures

Public EV charging in B.C. also employs multiple pricing methodologies, including energy- and time-based rates, idle and roaming fees, subscription plans, and dynamic pricing. These structures reflect varying operational needs, regulatory frameworks, and user preferences across networks.

Across jurisdictions, public charging services may be billed on either an energy-based (per kWh) or time-based (per minute) model. Time-based billing remains in use where Measurement Canada dispensation for energy metering has not yet been granted or implemented¹². As a result, charging operators vary in pricing methodologies, which can again complicate comparisons across network types and business models. For instance, time-based pricing may result in cost disparities between vehicles with different onboard charging capabilities.

Charging Operators like Tesla¹³ and Electrify Canada, and other large networks have now started to transition to energy-based pricing as regulatory clarity and metering standards improve. Conversely, some operators such as Petro-Canada¹⁴ continue to use time-based billing, which may penalize drivers with lower onboard charging capacities¹⁵.

4.1 Price Setting Operating Model Classification

Depending on which party sets the charging rates at a site, price setting can be grouped into the following two categories:

1. Centralized Pricing

A single organization determines the rate structure and typically applies it uniformly across its entire network of chargers. This approach simplifies the customer experience by offering consistent pricing at every station*. **Examples:** Tesla, BC Hydro, Suncor

2. Decentralized Pricing

Individual site owners or operators set their own rates, resulting in often significant variations in charging costs from one location to another. This model allows for market-driven flexibility but can introduce complexity for drivers comparing prices. **Examples:** FLO, ChargePoint

***Note:** While some networks are centrally governed and pricing is primarily set by the owner-operator (e.g., Parkland's On the Run), rates may still vary regionally due to local market conditions or operational models (e.g., franchise involvement). These cases may be considered "semi-centralized" – consistent in governance, but with some localized pricing flexibility (similar to certain FLO implementations).

¹² <https://ised-isde.canada.ca/>

¹³ <https://driveteslacanada.ca/news/tesla-adjusts-supercharger-pricing-in-canada-more-off-peak-rates-new-brunswick-reverts-to-per-minute-billing/>

¹⁴ <https://www.petro-canada.ca/en/personal/fuel/canadas-electric-highway>

¹⁵ EY Market Study based on publicly available information

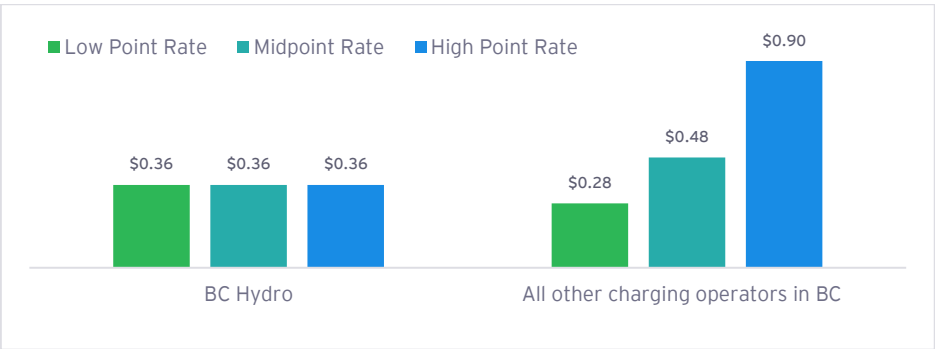
4.2 EV Charging Rates

Public EV charging rates in B.C. vary widely depending on the charging operator, charger type, and ownership / operating model. This section presents a comparison of current pricing across major networks operating in the province, covering both DC fast charging and L2 charging.

Charging operator's pricing is compared below using three reference points: the 'Low Point Rate' (the lowest rate offered by the operator), the 'High Point Rate' (the highest rate), and the 'Midpoint Rate' for a balanced comparison. The midpoint is calculated using the median method rather than a simple average to better reflect typical pricing and reduce the influence of outliers. The overall lowest and highest rates across all operators are also highlighted to show the full range of pricing in the market.

The figures below offer a snapshot of rate structures to help illustrate the range of costs faced by EV drivers and the positioning of different operators within the B.C. EV charging landscape. Supporting data tables for figures are included in the Appendix. All figures are represented as Canadian Dollars (CAD) per kWh and rounded to the nearest two decimal cents.

Figure 1: DC Fast Charging Pricing rates: BC Hydro vs. All Other Charging Operators in British Columbia (\$/kWh)



Note: Figure 1 compares BC Hydro against all other charging operators across different operating models.

Figure 2: DC Fast Charging rates Comparison: BC Hydro vs. All Other Charging Operators in British Columbia (Detailed) (\$/kWh)



Figure 3: Level 2 Charging rates Comparison: BC Hydro vs. All Other Charging Operators in British Columbia (\$/kWh)

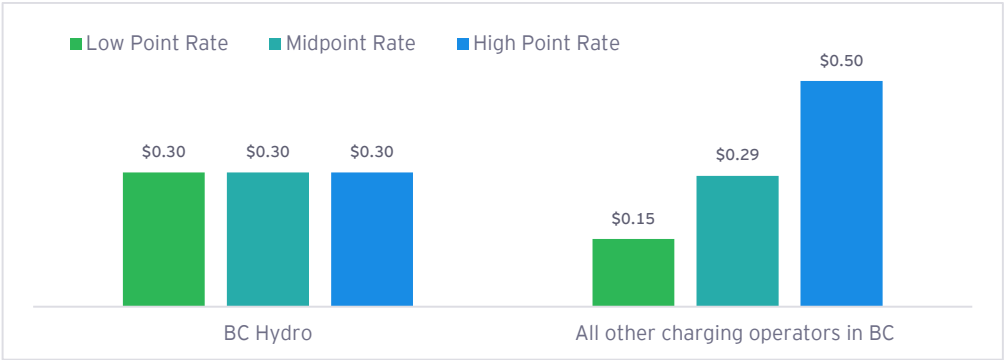


Figure 4: Level 2 Charging rates Comparison: BC Hydro vs. All Other Charging Operators in British Columbia (Detailed) (\$/kWh)

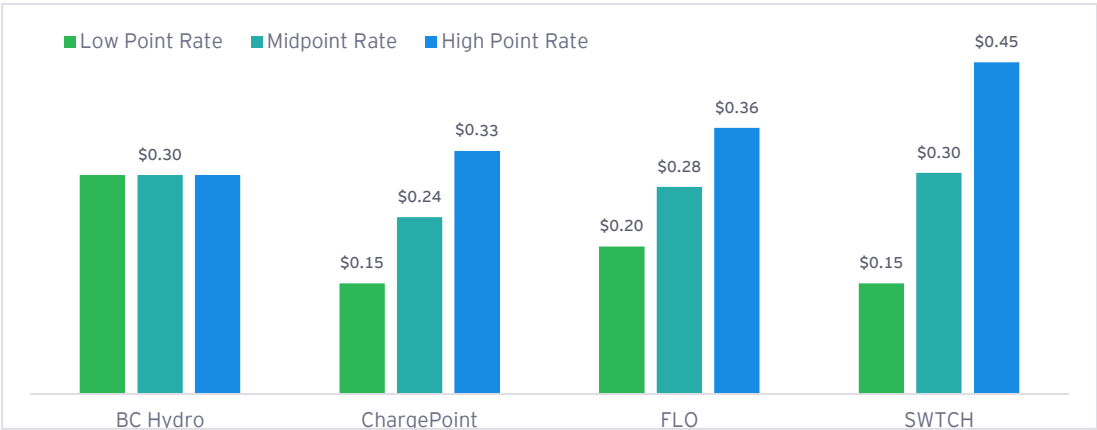


Figure 5: DC Fast Charging Rates Comparison: BC Hydro vs. Other Jurisdictions in Canada (\$/kWh)

Note: The figures below provide an overview of pricing structures across various jurisdictions in Canada in comparison to BC Hydro rates.

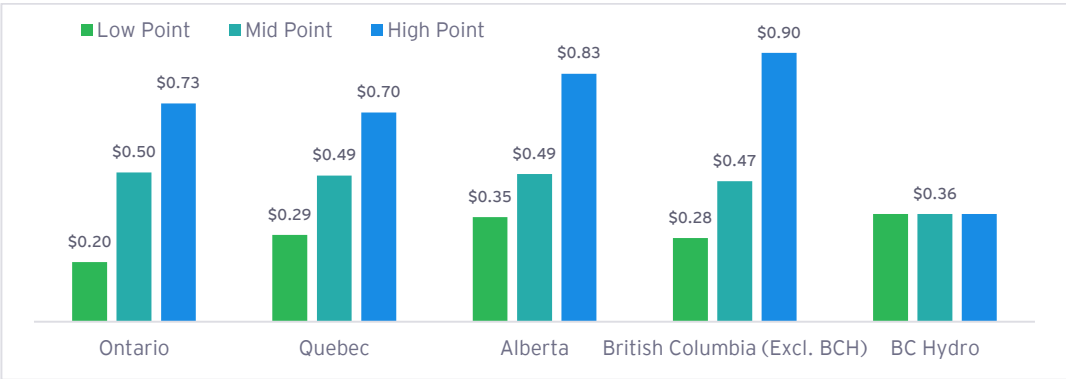
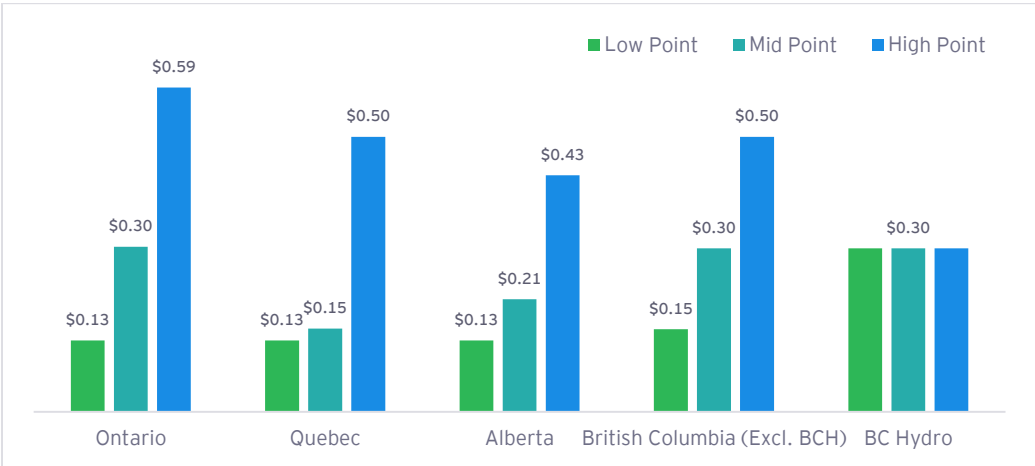


Figure 6: Level 2 Charging Rates Comparison: BC Hydro vs. Other Jurisdictions in Canada



Note: The figures below provide DCFC pricing comparison of Centralized vs Decentralized models.

Figure 7: DC Fast Charging rates in Canada by Operating Model (\$/kWh)

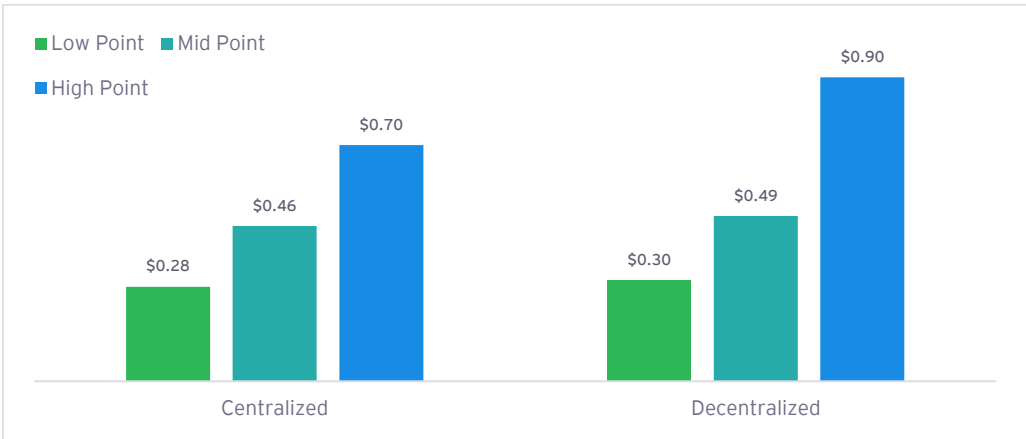


Figure 8: Level 2 Fast Charging rates in Canada by Operating Model (\$/kWh)

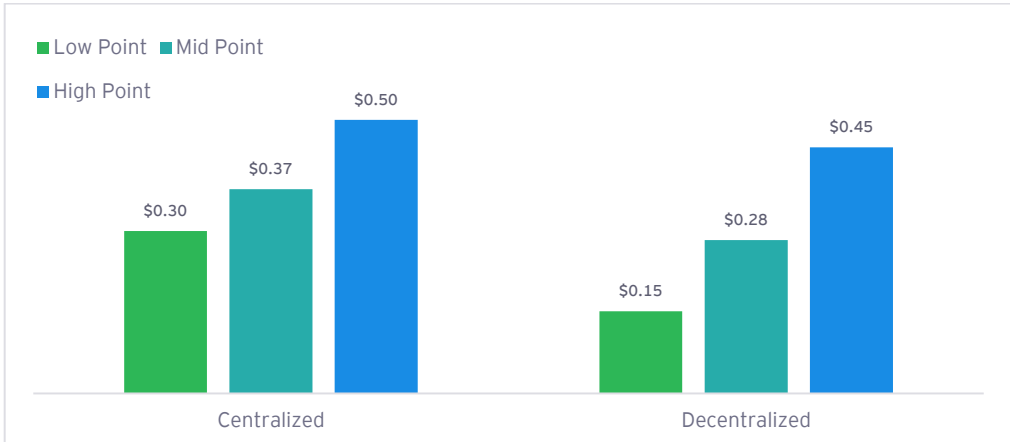
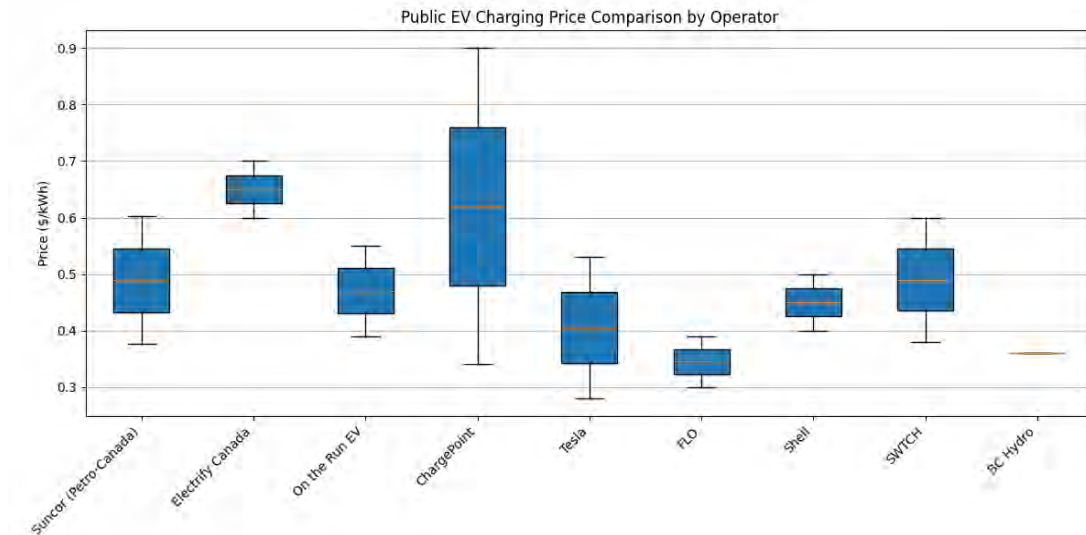


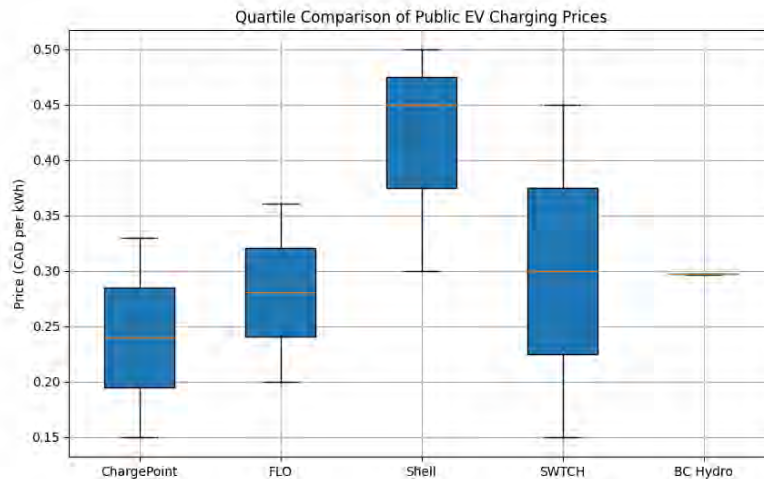
Figure 9: Quartile Comparison of Public EV DC Fast Charging rates in British Columbia



Interpretation:

- BC Hydro has a fixed rate of \$0.361/kWh, shown as a flat line (no variation).
- ChargePoint shows the widest price range, indicating high variability.
- Electrify Canada and Suncor are on the higher end of the price spectrum.

Figure 10: Quartile Comparison of Public EV Level 2 Charging rates in British Columbia



Interpretation:

- ChargePoint and SWITCH offer the lowest entry-level prices, starting at \$0.15/kWh.
- Shell has the highest upper-end price in this group.
- FLO and SWITCH show moderate variability, while ChargePoint has a narrower range.

Based on the pricing data sample shown above, BC Hydro's current public fast charging rates fall at the lower end of the pricing spectrum across peer networks in B.C. and across comparable jurisdictions in Canada. However, the diversity in pricing approaches observed in this scan reflects differences in infrastructure costs, ownership models, customer usage patterns, and regulatory context. Notably,

time-based pricing remains prevalent where energy-based billing is constrained by Measurement Canada certification requirements, complicating direct comparisons across networks.

Notes:

1. Some public charging networks in B.C., including Tesla, B.C. Ministry of Transportation and Suncor (Petro Canada), offer charging at select sites free of charge. For instance, Tesla's offer free charging at many places like EXchange Hotel in Vancouver and Kumsheen Raft Adventures in Lytton. These chargers are often sponsored by the site owners, to attract EV-driving customers. Additionally, certain sites operated by SWTCH, ChargePoint, and Shell may also provide complimentary charging, typically in partnership with retail or municipal hosts. Availability varies by location and is often subject to change or time limits.
2. Estimated rates represent the low point, midpoint and high point of published pricing ranges for each operator, where applicable. Hourly rates were converted to approximate per kilowatt-hour (kWh) values based on a standard L2 charging rate of 7.2 kW per hour, assuming average charger output and typical user consumption. These values are indicative and may vary depending on equipment specifications, site conditions, and user charging behavior.

Time-based rates were converted to power-based rates using the formula below:

Some EV Charging operators use time-based pricing, which needed to be converted to energy-based (per kWh) rates for a more accurate comparison. For example, Petro-Canada charges CAD 0.50 per minute for DC fast charging. To standardize these rates, charging speed assumptions were applied based on regression models developed by power levels, using real-world charging session data provided by BC Hydro.

Table 3: Rate of Actual Power Dispensed by Charger Power Based on BC Hydro Charging Session Data										
Charger Power in kW	7	25	50	75	90	100	175	180	200	350
Actual power dispensed kWh/Min	0.08	0.29	0.6	0.82	0.87	0.83	1.1	1.33	1.33	1.35

The following formula was used for the conversion:

Conversion of rate from \$/min to \$/kWh = Rate per minute / Dispensed kWh per minute
--

4.3 Idle Fees

An idle fee is a charge applied when an EV remains plugged into a charger after charging is complete. This structure is commonly used at public EV charging sites, especially for DC fast chargers, where high demand and limited availability make station turnover essential. Idle fees encourage prompt vehicle removal to free up the charger for others and reduce site congestion.

Table 4 below shows a comparison of idle fees charged by BC Hydro and other major private EV charging networks in B.C., based on the most recently available data:

Table 4: Sample Idle Fees Charges by BC Hydro and Operators Across B.C.			
Charging Network	Idle Fee	Grace Period	Notes

BC Hydro	\$0.40 per minute ¹⁶	5 minutes after charging ends	Applies only to DC fast chargers; no idle fee for L2 chargers
Shell	\$0.15/min	After 5 mins grace period	Usually varies by site
Electrify Canada	\$0.40 per minute ¹⁷	10 minutes after charging ends	Applies after a 10-minute grace period for DC fast chargers; shown in app before session starts
ChargePoint	\$3.00 to \$10.00/hr	15 mins	Idle fees are optional and vary widely
Tesla Supercharger	\$0.50/min and \$1.00/min if station is 100% occupied ¹⁸	5 mins	Applies only to DC fast chargers
Petro Canada	No idle fee ¹⁹	Not applicable	

Fee structures, grace periods, and enforcement mechanisms vary by operator. While some apply fees immediately upon charging completion, others allow users a short window to vacate the charger before fees are incurred.

4.4 Other common and trending fee structures

- **Roaming surcharges:** Users accessing a third-party charging network (e.g., using BC Hydro card on SWTCH network) may incur an additional per-session fee (typically \$0.75-\$1.25)²⁰.
- **Pre-authorized payment holds:** Many operators place temporary holds of \$20-\$50 on credit cards or apps before a session begins²¹.
- **Dynamic pricing:** Some of the charging operators are piloting variable rates based on time-of-day or site congestion levels²². **Example:** Tesla charging site at Richmond (BC-Steveston Highway) follows a dynamic pricing model varying the rates based on peak and off-peak hours:

Table 5: Dynamic pricing example: Tesla Supercharger, Richmond		
Time Period	Tesla vehicle (\$/kWh)	Non-Tesla Vehicle (\$/kWh)
12:00 AM - 4:00 AM	\$0.20/kWh	\$0.29/kWh
4:00 AM - 8:00 AM	\$0.20/kWh	\$0.29/kWh
8:00 AM - 10:00 PM	\$0.35/kWh	\$0.49/kWh
10:00 PM - 12 AM	\$0.20/kWh	\$0.29/kWh

¹⁶ <https://www.bchydro.com/powersmart/electric-vehicles/public-charging/charging-rates-roaming.html>

¹⁷ <https://www.electrify-canada.ca/pricing/>

¹⁸ <https://www.tesla.com/support/charging/supercharger/fees>

¹⁹ <https://www.petro-canada.ca/en/personal/fuel/canadas-electric-highway>

²⁰ <https://www.bcit.ca/files/appliedresearch/pdf/bcit-evid-project-public-report-roaming-guidelines-for-ev-charging-final.pdf>

²¹ <https://www.ampeco.com/guides/payment-terminals-practical-guide/>

²² <https://natural-resources.canada.ca/funding-partnerships/charging-infrastructure-dynamic-distributed-price-signal-load-shaping>

5. Conclusion

This jurisdictional scan provides insights into some of the diverse strategies adopted for public EV charging in B.C., spanning pricing models, ownership structures, and service delivery approaches.

Based on the observed public charging data within this report, several trends are emerging:

- **Energy-based pricing is now common across major networks** as regulatory frameworks evolve to support direct billing by kWh. However, time-based pricing remains in use – particularly for L2 stations and in jurisdictions where metering approvals are still pending.
- **Idle fees and session management policies are increasingly adopted** and serve as important tools for improving charger availability and utilization, especially at high-demand DCFC sites.
- **Public charging rates vary widely** depending on the operator type, cost recovery model, and service level. In some cases, private-owned stations set higher prices, while utility-owned and publicly funded networks generally remain at the lower end of the pricing spectrum.
- **Business models are diverse**, ranging from vertically integrated private operators to public-private partnerships and host-owned network service platforms. These models influence not only pricing, but also customer experience, network reliability, and long-term scalability.

Based on the data considered within the scope of this report, BC Hydro's public charging rates are reasonably consistent with market practices. The differences in pricing can be attributed to variations in network ownership, capital recovery models, and billing mechanisms, which influence user pricing based on governance and infrastructure investment strategies. The BC Hydro L2 charging rate, set at \$0.2972/kWh, is aligned with broader market trends. BC Hydro's current rate of \$0.3609/kWh for DC fast charging remains among the more affordable options in the market. In comparison, private networks typically charge between \$0.28 and \$0.90/kWh²³ depending on factors such as ownership structure, funding models, and operational costs. Additionally, many charging operators offer Level 2 charging at no cost, often subsidized by site hosts as a means to attract EV-driving customers. To improve charger availability, many networks including BC Hydro are also implementing idle fees and exploring alternative pricing models. Looking ahead, developments such as ultra-fast charging, roaming interoperability, and dynamic pricing pilots point to a rapidly evolving and increasingly sophisticated charging landscape.

While structural differences across networks do affect pricing, EY's 2024 Mobility Consumer Index research finds that EV users continue to prioritize cost, charger availability, vehicle range and charging time²⁴. As public charging infrastructure grows, maintaining price transparency, consistent performance, and broad geographic coverage will be essential to support ongoing EV adoption in B.C.

²³ EY Market Study based on publicly available information

²⁴ https://www.ey.com/en_gl/newsroom/2024/09/global-demand-for-evs-slows-as-consumer-concerns-remain-high-over-lack-of-charging-infrastructure-ey-global-mobility-consumer-index

6. Terminology, Definitions, Acronyms

Term	Meaning
Charging Site	Referring to the physical location where the chargers are situated.
Charger	The EV charging supply hardware that can include one or more ports and connectors.
Charger Port	The power outlet included in the charger that provides electricity to the vehicle. One charger can have one or more ports.
Connectors	The hardware equipment (which includes the cable, socket, handle and plug) that is plugged into the vehicle to charge it. Different types of connectors include CCS (Combined Charging System), Tesla NACS (North American Charging Standard), J1772 and CHAdeMO.
Plug	The metal component of an EV connector that is inserted into the charging socket of an EV.
Socket	The metal component on a vehicle that you plug the connector into to begin charging.
Charger Cable	The heavy-duty black insulated electrical cable / cord attached to a public EV charger that delivers power from the charger to the vehicle. The cable connects the charger to the vehicle through the connector (plug and handle).
Faster Charging	Refers to Direct Current (DC) EV charging operating at 480+ V, delivering 25+ kW of power.
Level 2 Charging	Refers to Alternating Current (AC) EV charging operating at 208 V or 240 V, delivering approximately 3 to 19 kW of power.
Idle Fee	A fee charged for remaining connected to a charging port after charging has ended.
EV Charging Site	Used in a general sense when talking about all our EV charging sites (hub and non-hub sites).
Acronym	Meaning
B.C.	British Columbia
BCH	BC Hydro
DCFC	Direct Current Fast Charging
EV	Electric Vehicle
NACS	North American Charging System
ZEV	Zero-Emission Vehicle

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Evaluation Report for Year One – May 2024 to April 2025

Appendix D

Jurisdiction Scan of Public Electric Vehicle (EV) Charging Rates in British Columbia
31 July 2025

8. Appendix

Pricing Comparison: BC Hydro vs. All Other Charging Operators in British Columbia

Tables 1-4 below offer a snapshot of rate structures to help illustrate the range of costs faced by EV drivers and the positioning of different operators within the B.C. EV charging landscape.

Table 1: DC Fast Charging rates in British Columbia: BC Hydro vs. All Other Charging Operators-Summarized (\$/kWh)					
Charging Operator	Charging Power	Low Point Rate	Midpoint Rate	High Point Rate ↓	Comments
BC Hydro	25kW, 50kW, 100kW, 120kW, 180kW, 200kW, 350kW	\$0.361	\$0.361	\$0.361	Flat rate
All other Charging operators in BC	40 - 350kW	\$0.280	\$0.480	\$0.900	Flat rate, Dynamic / variable pricing*
*Varies by like location, time of day, energy demand, and membership status.					

Table 2: DC Fast Charging rates in British Columbia: BC Hydro vs. All Other Charging Operators-Detailed (\$/kWh)					
Charging Operator	Charging Power	Low Point Rate	Midpoint Rate	High Point Rate* ↓	Comments
BC Hydro	25-350kW	\$0.361	\$0.361	\$0.361	Flat rate
FLO	50-100kW	\$0.300	\$0.345	\$0.390	Variable pricing
Shell	40-180kW	\$0.400	\$0.450	\$0.500	Variable pricing
Tesla	72-325kW	\$0.280	\$0.405	\$0.530	Variable pricing
On the Run EV	100-200kW	\$0.390	\$0.470	\$0.550	Variable pricing
SWTCH	75.2-150kW	\$0.380	\$0.490	\$0.600	Variable pricing
Suncor (Petro-Canada)	100-350kW	\$0.376	\$0.489	\$0.602	Flat rate (converted per minute)
Electrify Canada	50-350kW	\$0.600	\$0.650	\$0.700	Variable pricing
ChargePoint	62.5-200kW	\$0.340	\$0.620	\$0.900	Rate varies by site. ChargePoint's Site at Prince George Ford, Central St charges \$0.9/kWh
*Arranged from lowest to highest using High Point Rate					

Table 3: L2 Charging rates in British Columbia: BC Hydro vs. All Other Charging Operators-Summarized (\$/kWh)					
Charging Operator	Charging Power	Low Point Rate	Midpoint Rate	High Point Rate	Comments
BC Hydro	7.2kW - 19.2kW	\$0.297	\$0.297	\$0.297	Fixed / flat rate
All other Charging operators in BC	5kW - 19.2kW	\$0.150	\$0.290	\$0.500	Dynamic / variable pricing

Table 4: L2 Charging rates in British Columbia: BC Hydro vs. All Other Charging Operators-Detailed (\$/kWh)					
Charging Operator	Charging Power	Low Point Rate	Midpoint Rate	High Point Rate* ↓	Comments

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BC Hydro	7.2kW - 19.2kW	\$0.297	\$0.297	\$0.297	Fixed / flat rate
ChargePoint	5kW - 6.6kW	\$0.150	\$0.240	\$0.330	Variable pricing
FLO	6.2kW - 16.6kW	\$0.200	\$0.281	\$0.361	Variable pricing
SWTCH	6.656kW - 9.984kW	\$0.150	\$0.300	\$0.450	Variable pricing
*Arranged from lowest to highest using High Point Rate					

Pricing Comparison: BC Hydro vs. Other Jurisdictions in Canada

Tables 5 - 6 below provide an overview of pricing structures across various jurisdictions in Canada in comparison to BC Hydro rates.

Table 5: DC Fast Charging rates in Canada: BC Hydro vs. Other Jurisdictions (\$/kWh)				
Charging Operator / Jurisdiction**	Low Point Rate	Midpoint Rate	High Point Rate* ↓	Comments
BC Hydro	\$0.36	\$0.36	\$0.36	Fixed / flat rate
Quebec	\$0.29	\$0.49	\$0.70	Variable pricing
Ontario	\$0.20	\$0.50	\$0.73	Variable pricing
Alberta	\$0.35	\$0.50	\$0.83	Variable pricing
British Columbia	\$0.28	\$0.48	\$0.90	(Excl. BC Hydro)
*Arranged from lowest to highest using High Point Rate				
**Charging operators considered: ChargePoint, FLO, Petro-Canada, Electrify Canada, Tesla, Shell Recharge				

Table 6: L2 Charging rates in Canada: BC Hydro vs. Other Jurisdictions (\$/kWh)				
Charging Operator/Jurisdiction**	Low Point Rate	Midpoint Rate	High Point Rate* ↓	Comments
BC Hydro	\$0.297	\$0.297	\$0.297	Fixed / flat rate
Alberta	\$0.13	\$0.20	\$0.43	Variable pricing
Quebec	\$0.13	\$0.151	\$0.5	Variable pricing
British Columbia (Excl. BCH)	\$0.15	\$0.297	\$0.5	Variable pricing
Ontario	\$0.13	\$0.3	\$0.59	Variable pricing
*Arranged from lowest to highest using High Point Rate				
**Charging operators considered: ChargePoint, FLO, Petro-Canada, Electrify Canada, Shell Recharge				

Pricing Comparison: Operating Models

Tables 7 - 8 below provide an overview of pricing structures across various operating models in B.C.

Table 7: DC Fast Charging rates in Canada by Operating Model (\$/kWh)				
Operating Model	Low Point Rate	Midpoint Rate	High Point Rate* ↓	Comments
Centralized	\$0.280	\$0.460	\$0.700	Suncor, Tesla, BC Hydro, Electrify Canada, On the Run EV
Decentralized	\$0.300	\$0.490	\$0.900	ChargePoint, FLO, SWTCH

Jurisdiction Scan of Public Electric Vehicle (EV) Charging Rates in British Columbia
31 July 2025

*Arranged from lowest to highest using High Point Rate

Table 8: L2 Charging rates in Canada by Operating Model (\$/kWh)				
Operating Model	Low Point Rate	Midpoint Rate	High Point Rate* ↓	Comments
Decentralized	\$0.150	\$0.281	\$0.450	ChargePoint, FLO, SWTCH
Centralized	\$0.297	\$0.374	\$0.500	BC Hydro, Shell
*Arranged from lowest to highest using High Point Rate				

Charging Operators - Selected Sample

Table 9 below provides an overview of the sample selected for the analysis.

Charging Operators	Total Charging Sites ²⁵	Total Sample selected
ChargePoint	997	11
Electrify Canada	11	11
FLO	685	10
Shell Recharge	27	10
SWTCH	114	11
On the Run EV	52	15
Petro Canada	12	9
Tesla	218	11
BC Hydro	143	13
Grand Total	2,259	101

²⁵ NRCan's Electric Charging and Alternative Fuelling Stations Locator

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BC Hydro Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates

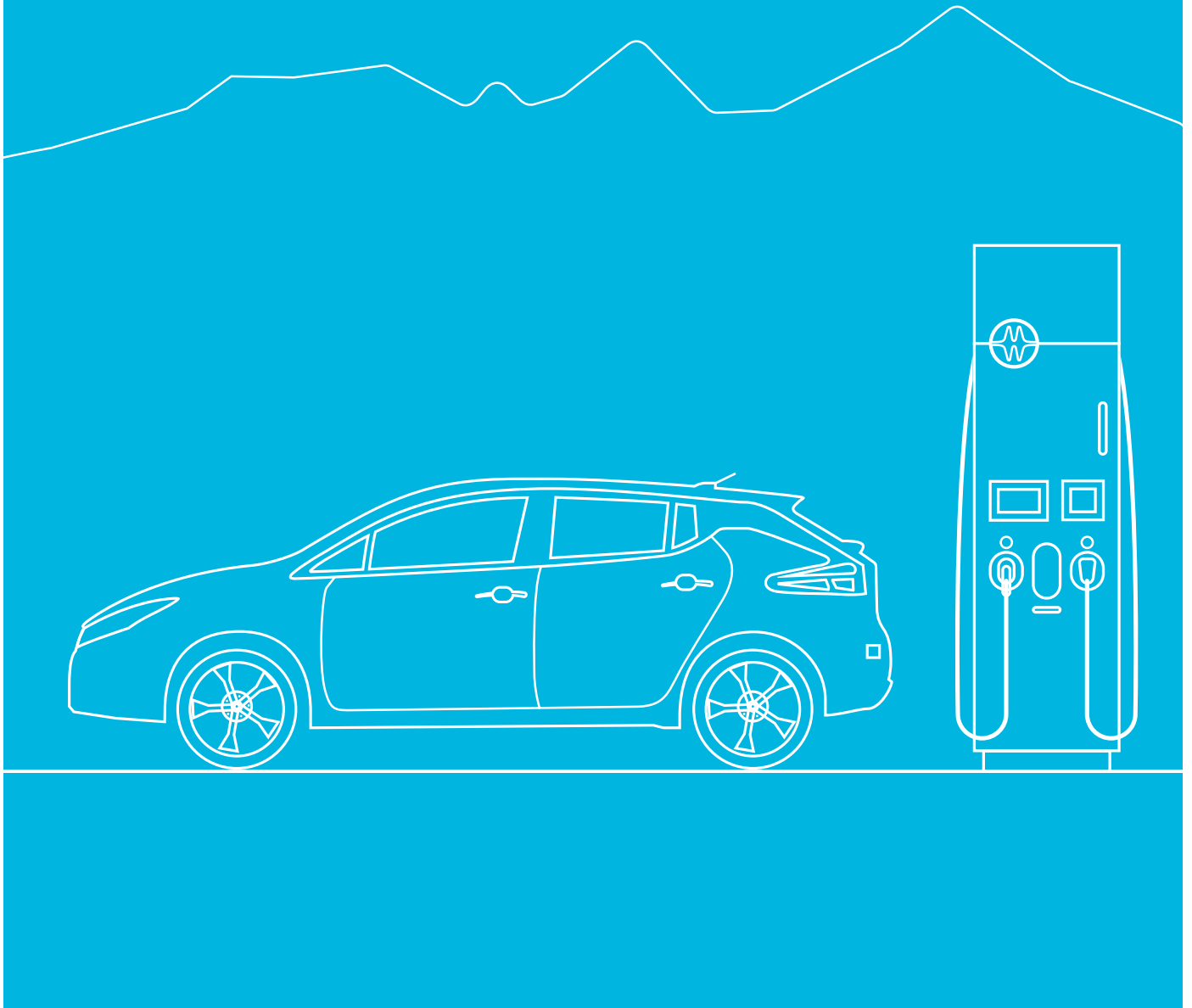
Evaluation Report for Year One

Appendix E

BC Hydro Public EV Charging Progress Report - April 2025

Driving forward:

BC Hydro's EV public charging progress report



Report
April 2025

 **BC Hydro**
Power smart

BC Hydro Public Electric Vehicle Charging Service Rates

Driving the EV revolution: BC Hydro an EV leader

Since the 2000s, when the first electric vehicles hit B.C.'s roads, BC Hydro has been at the forefront of driving EV adoption. Today, there are over 195,000 EVs on B.C. roads, and within the next decade, this number is projected to soar to 700,000 to 900,000. This report dives into how BC Hydro is powering the transition to EVs by making EV charging more accessible, convenient, and inclusive for all British Columbians.

From pioneers to game-changers



In 2013, we installed our first DC fast charger – the first in B.C. Now, with more than 591 charging ports at over 144 locations, we're transforming the EV charging experience across the province.



In just one year, our public charging network tripled in size. On average, we have installed more than one charging port a day for a total of 418 over the past year.



We debuted 350-kilowatt chargers that provide 100 kilometres of charging in just 5 minutes.



In the past year, we've launched 22 state-of-the-art charging hubs, each equipped with 8 to 22 charging ports, cutting wait times for drivers.



85% of our chargers are fast chargers and we support all charger connector types (CCS, NACS and CHAdeMO). BC Hydro was recently named one of the best-rated EV charging networks in North America of 2024 by ChargeHub.



In partnership with government, we completed the Electric Highway in September – strategically positioning fast chargers every 150 kilometres along major roadways across B.C. Of the 155 locations, BC Hydro built and operates 111 of the sites or just over 70% of the electric highway network.



EV drivers charging at home in B.C. save about 80% on fuel costs. A trip from Vancouver to Kelowna costs about \$10 in charging versus \$60 in gas. Over a decade, including purchase, fuel, and maintenance, a typical EV can save drivers about \$30,000 – or \$3,000 per year.



With over 98% renewable energy in our grid, EV drivers in B.C. are reducing greenhouse gas emissions while steering us toward a sustainable tomorrow. EV driver in B.C. can reduce their GHG emissions by 70% using BC Hydro's clean electricity, compared to fossil-fuel powered vehicles.



B.C. is one of the fastest-growing EV hubs in North America, and we have the highest EV adoption rate in Canada.

Electrifying the future



By Spring 2026, we'll grow our charging ports to over 800.



This year, we are introducing 400-kilowatt fast chargers, which can deliver 100 kilometres of range in just 3 minutes.

To continue supporting EV adoption, BC Hydro is:

- Making charging more convenient by allowing customers to activate and pay for their EV charging with a simple tap from credit or RFID cards.
- Expanding sites for medium-duty vehicles with tailored solutions, as well as EV charging sites equipped to support the heavy-duty vehicle market.
- Helping apartments prepare for the EV boom with our EV Ready Program.

British Columbia is a leader in EV adoption

British Columbia is blazing a trail in Canada with its rapid adoption of light-duty electric vehicles (EVs). In 2024, zero emissions vehicles (ZEVs) made up a remarkable 22.8% of all new light vehicles in the province. Today, over 195,000 electric vehicles are cruising B.C.'s roads, and BC Hydro projects this number will grow to between 700,000 and 900,000 within the next decade.

BC Hydro is facilitating the transition to electric vehicles by making EV charging accessible and easy for all British Columbians. This includes expanding public charging infrastructure, ensuring grid readiness for home, depot, workplace, and public charging, enhancing home and depot charging options, and leading the EV charging market through ongoing research.

This report highlights the progress BC Hydro has made in expanding its public charging infrastructure and outlines the steps it will continue to take to ensure that all drivers in B.C. have access to reliable, convenient, and affordable charging.

The rise of electric vehicles in B.C.

The demand for EVs in B.C. has been steadily climbing, driven by a mix of eco- and cost-conscious customers. With 98% of the province's energy coming from renewable sources and some of the lowest energy rates in North America, B.C. is perfectly positioned to embrace the EV transition. Plus, thanks to major leaps in battery technology over the past decade, most new EVs can now zip along for 400 to 500 kilometers on a single charge, with some models even hitting the 700-kilometre mark.

The EV wave is gaining momentum, and it's not just because they're cool, eco-friendly and have lower life-cycle costs. The expansion of charging infrastructure means you can power up your ride almost anywhere, making range anxiety a thing of the past. Add to that the increasing oil and gas prices, and it's fueling people to switch gears. Plus, with an increasing array of EV options now available, from sleek SUVs to rugged pickup trucks, there are more electric vehicles available to suit different tastes and lifestyles. With more EV models expected to hit the market in the coming years, prices are set to become competitive with traditional internal combustion engine vehicles. This means more affordable EV options for everyone, making the switch to electric even more enticing.

The Zero-Emission Vehicle Act targets 90% light-duty ZEV sales by 2030, one of the most ambitious in North America. In the race to EV adoption, British Columbia is outpacing most other jurisdictions in North America.

EV drivers in B.C. charging at home save about

80% on fuel costs

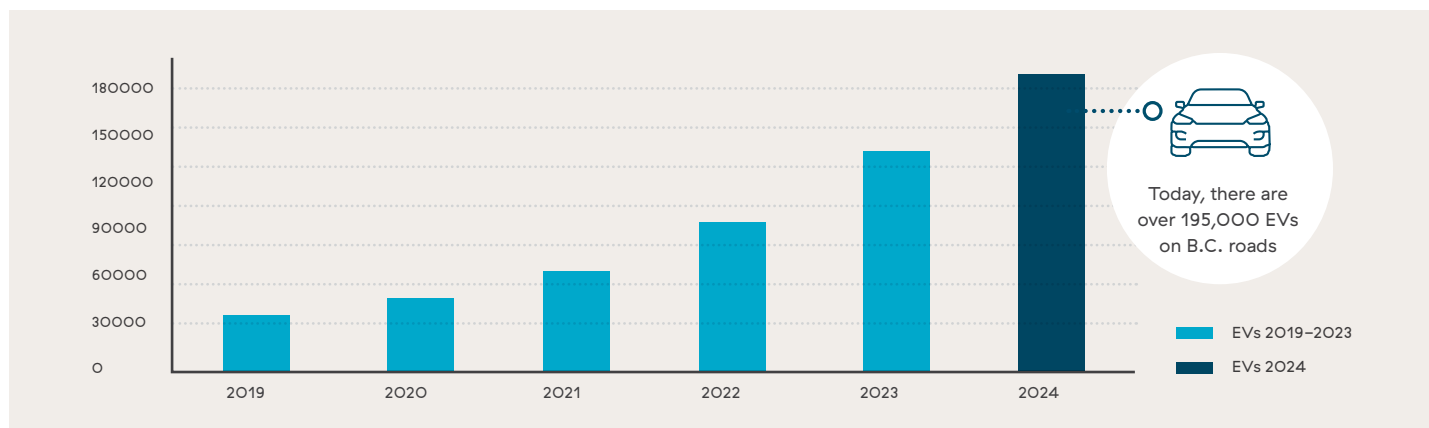
A trip from Vancouver to Kelowna costs

\$10 in charging **vs. \$60** in gas

Over a decade, including purchase, fuel, and maintenance, a typical EV can save drivers about

\$30,000—or \$3,000 per year.

NUMBER OF EV'S ON BRITISH COLUMBIA ROADS



Supplying clean electricity for EV growth

With over 98% of BC Hydro's electricity coming from clean energy, EV drivers in BC are significantly reducing their contribution to greenhouse gas emissions. Studies have shown that up to 70% of emissions can be reduced by EVs powered by renewable hydroelectricity, compared to conventional fossil fuel vehicles.

At BC Hydro, we often get asked about our strategy to power the rising tide of electric vehicles. It's essential to understand that this surge in EVs will be a gradual wave, not a sudden flood. Our current infrastructure is well-equipped to handle this growth, and we're making smart investments to ensure we can meet future demands.

Most EV charging happens overnight at home, when residential power usage for activities like cooking, heating, and lighting is at its lowest. BC Hydro offers an optional residential time-of-day rate that encourages overnight use of electricity to reduce the peak system demand in the late afternoon and early evening. By 2030, the estimated demand for electricity from EVs is 1,300 gigawatt hours—just 2 percent of the total energy demand. BC Hydro has been including EVs in its load forecasts since 2011 and has carefully planned for the anticipated increase in EVs on B.C. roads.

Through our Integrated Resource Plan, we have mapped out various load scenarios and identified the resources needed to meet this demand. We regularly monitor the health of local distribution systems and upgrade them as needed to meet new neighborhood demands as part of our standard operations.

Power wherever you go: Our public EV charging network in B.C.

Lack of charging infrastructure is often seen as a roadblock to electric vehicle adoption. While most British Columbians charge their EVs at home, at depots, or at their workplaces for daily travel, we know that not everyone will have access to these options right away. Plus, EV drivers still have the need to charge while traveling long distances or when they need a quick top-up after a lot of driving. That's why having a reliable and trusted public charging network across the province is crucial, both now and in the future, to ensure EV drivers can charge their vehicles wherever they go. This network will help build confidence for British Columbians to embrace EVs. And guess what? BC Hydro has been working towards this goal since 2009.

Early days



Back in 2009, BC Hydro didn't have any public chargers because there were no EVs on the roads in British Columbia. But that year, BC Hydro and the City of Vancouver made a splash by announcing the arrival of North America's first production-ready, highway-capable electric cars – three Mitsubishi iMiEVs. Two of these trailblazing cars joined BC Hydro's fleet, marking the dawn of the EV era in British Columbia. Fast forward to 2013, and Nanaimo proudly became home to the province's first public fast charger for electric vehicles. This game-changing charger could power up a vehicle in 90 minutes.

First decade of public charging

In the first decade, BC Hydro made steady progress with public charging as the EV transition was just getting started. From 2013 to 2023, we added around 170 fast chargers to our network at 86 sites. Each site had about two to four ports, mostly along highways in places like Kamloops, Nanaimo, Duncan, Squamish, and Merritt. Our goal during this time was to create a network that allowed EV drivers to travel seamlessly across the province.

Exponential growth in the last year

Over the past year, BC Hydro has supercharged its public EV charging network to support the government's CleanBC Roadmap to 2030 goal of completing the Electric Highway by the summer of 2024. BC Hydro now has the largest geographical footprint of any charging provider in the province and played a pivotal role in completing the Electric Highway. Most of BC Hydro's Electric

POWERING THE ELECTRIC HIGHWAY

In September, the Province reached a significant milestone with the completion of B.C.'s "Electric Highway," a comprehensive network of public EV fast charging sites strategically positioned along all highways and major roadways approximately 150 kilometers apart. This extensive network spans the entire province, enabling seamless EV travel from Vancouver to the Yukon border and from Vancouver Island to Alberta.

The Electric Highway network comprises 155 charging sites and over 310 fast chargers, with additional Level 2 chargers available at some locations. BC Hydro owns and operates 70% of these sites, reinforcing our commitment to supporting the growth of electric vehicle infrastructure in British Columbia.



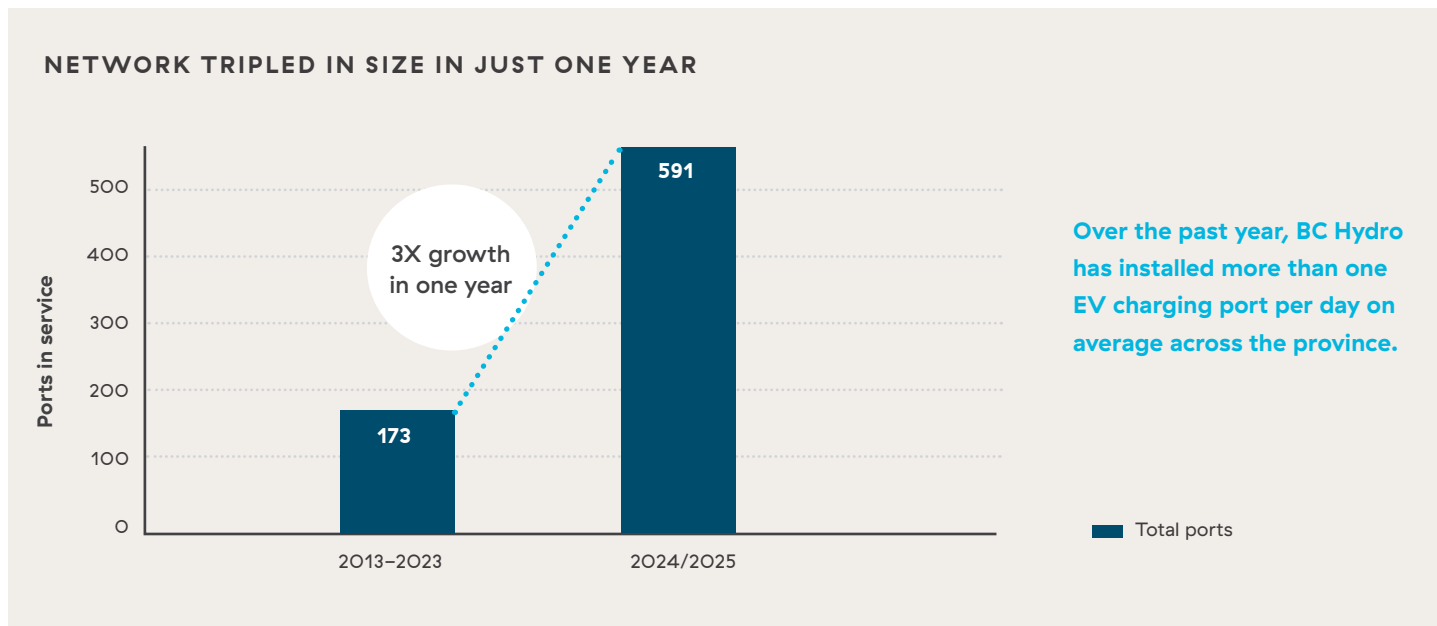
Highway sites feature two to four fast-chargers and include innovative solutions such as nine battery-supported charging sites and five off-grid charging sites for areas where the grid is constrained or unavailable.

To cut down on waiting times at charging sites, we rolled out charging hub sites in 2024, each boasting 8 to 22 charging ports. The first hub site was at the Surrey Arts Center, hosted by the City of Surrey. As of March 2025, BC Hydro has a total of 22 hub-sites, including Surrey (7), Delta (2), Maple Ridge (1), Port Moody (1), Port Coquitlam (1), Colwood (2), Prince George (1), Chilliwack (1), Courtney (1), Sidney (1), Abbotsford (1), Gibsons (1), Vancouver (1) and Lake Country (1).



Lake Country charging hub: One of the largest in BC Hydro's network—provides space for up to 22 EVs to charge at the same time and debuted its first 350-kilowatt charger in B.C.

Today, BC Hydro boasts 591 charging ports in its network, with 85% being fast-chargers, spread across 144 locations throughout the province. The maximum output of our charging network has more than quadrupled, meaning we can power more vehicles and faster.



Boosting today's charging experience

BC Hydro isn't just about the number of sites and EV chargers; we're all about enhancing the charging experience for our customers.

FAST HIGH POWER CHARGERS

We tailor our charging power levels to match dwell-times. For example, grocery store chargers allow for 30 to 40 minutes of shopping, while highway chargers are designed for quick stops. In 2024, we primarily installed 180-kilowatt fast chargers, which can add 180 kilometers of range in approximately 10 minutes and have power sharing that allows two vehicles to charge up to 90 kW each at the same time. Recently, we introduced 350-kilowatt chargers in Lake Country and Prince George, capable of providing a 100 kilometres of range in just 5 minutes.

INCLUSIVE FOR ALL

BC Hydro is all about making EV charging sites accessible for everyone, including individuals with disabilities. The vast majority of our sites include accessibility features like a curbless design, cable management systems, and lower screen displays on the new chargers for improved accessibility.

We've always offered EV charging for vehicles using the Combined Charging System (CCS) or CHAdeMO. But with many North American vehicle manufacturers now committing to the North American Charge Standard (NACS), we've started introducing chargers with NACS connectors at our hub-sites. This makes us the first public charging provider in B.C. to offer all connector types in our network.

BC Hydro offers both pull-in and pull-through charging sites. The pull-through sites are particularly convenient for EVs with trailers or medium-duty EVs.



Currently, 25 of our charging sites are designed to accommodate medium-duty EVs, serving the business community.

We've also got our own mobile application that our more than 100,000 EV members can use to activate and pay at our public chargers. Plus, we're a member of ChargeHub, which means other EV charging providers that are members of ChargeHub (like SWTCH Energy, Shell Recharge, HyperCharge, FLO) can have their EV community use our charging sites seamlessly through their mobile application and visa versa, you can use your BC Hydro mobile application to activate and pay at their charging sites.

BOOST CONFIDENCE THROUGH HIGH RELIABILITY

EV drivers expect chargers to be operational, and a non-functioning charger can really shake their confidence—not just at the site they are charging, but in the entire public charging network. BC Hydro tackles this head-on by providing robust maintenance and service support, ensuring a consistent experience across the network with 24/7 assistance for drivers. These efforts contribute to BC Hydro's exceptional reliability, with our fast-charging network boasting an industry-leading charger uptime rate of 99%. This is even more impressive considering the high usage of our chargers, peaking at 56,000 charging sessions on average each month.



BC Hydro's fast-charging network was recently recognized by ChargeHub as one of the best-rated charging networks of 2024. Read the article here: [Top Rated Charge Point Operators in North America: 2024 Edition](#)



EV charging port weather canopies at Bell 2 Lodge in Northern B.C.

CONVENIENT AND SAFE LOCATIONS

Safety for drivers is paramount, whether they are stepping out to charge or waiting in their vehicles. That's why we, along with our partners, ensure that EV charging sites are designed with adequate lighting, security measures, and open sightlines.

When deciding where to build new charging sites or expand existing ones, we consider key factors like priority areas from the Government of B.C.'s EV network plan, proximity to other chargers and core travel corridors, nearby amenities and available parking space.

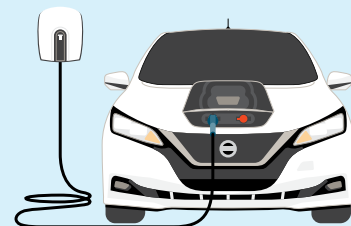
Weather canopies are also part of BC Hydro's strategy to make EV charging as seamless as possible. These canopies, located in areas that experience the most inclement weather (Good Hope Lake, Bell 2, Powder King and Britton Creek) help EV drivers brave the elements, and ensure the chargers are protected from snow, ice and rain.

FAIR AND AFFORDABLE RATES:

BC Hydro recovers its public charging program costs through the EV Public Charging Service Rate set by the BC Utilities Commission. This means EV drivers using BC Hydro public chargers are paying for the program costs. In 2024, BC Hydro switched from time-based rates to energy-based rates to bill customers for energy used, which is generally perceived as fairer.

EV CHARGING RATES

The BC Utilities Commission (BCUC) is responsible for setting EV charging rates, and the cost is recovered by public charging users, not ratepayers. In 2024, the BCUC approved new energy-based rates for EV charging which are 36.09 cents per kilowatt hour for all fast-charging power levels and 29.72 cents per kilowatt hour for Level 2 charging. BC Hydro believes energy-based rates are fairer and are easier for customers to understand. These charges are in line with other public charging services in B.C.



Locally owned and powering economic growth together

BC Hydro's charging network is a British Columbia asset for the benefit of British Columbians and those who visit our beautiful province. Over the last year, BC Hydro invested over \$48 million in expanding the BC Hydro EV charging network and plans to invest more than \$360 million in further expansions over the next 10 years. These investments not only enable the transition to EVs, it also results in stimulating local economic growth through partnering with host providers, funding partners, tech experts, and design/construction experts.

We partner with a diverse group of public, private, and First Nations partners to host our EV charging sites. We have over 58 city, district and village partners hosting our chargers at recreation centers, parks, information centers, and along highways. We are collaborating with organizations like ICBC to host at their Claim Centres and Translink to host at their Park & Ride lots. We've also teamed up with private organizations to provide EV charging at multiple locations, often at shopping centers for the convenience of EV drivers.



BC Hydro partnered with TransLink to host L2 and fast chargers at their Park & Ride locations. L2 chargers allows EV drivers to charge their EV while taking transit and return to a fully charged EV, while the fast chargers allow EV drivers to top up their EV quickly, for example while waiting to pick up a transit user. Currently, there are two TransLink locations providing EV charging, South Surrey with 20 ports and Port Coquitlam with 18 ports, with more locations coming in the near future.



Artwork by Breanna Charleyboy from the Ulkatcho First Nations community at Ulkatcho (Anahim Lake) EV charging site.

BC Hydro is also thankful for partnerships with nine First Nations Communities to host and maintain the EV charging sites on their lands including at Seabird Island Band in Agassiz, McLeod Lake Indian Band in McLeod Lake, Ulkatcho First Nation in Anahim Lake, Nisga'a Nation in Gitlaxt'aamiks and Laxgalts'ap, Dease River First Nation in Good Hope Lake, Skidegate First Nations in Skidegate, Fort Nelson First Nation in Liard Hot Springs Lodge, Daylu Dena Council and Liard First Nation in Lower Post, and Chehalis Indian Band in Agassiz.

BC Hydro's charging network is partially funded through contributions from the Province of B.C. and Natural Resources Canada. For charging sites built in F25, the provincial and federal government contributed over \$21 million to fund the build costs. This support is crucial not only for expanding the network but also to keep rates affordable.

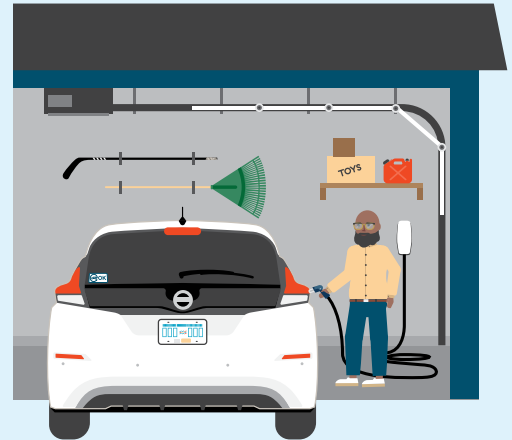
Through partnerships, we are supporting building an eco-system of EV charging, not only our own charging network. We work closely with other EV charging providers to interconnect to our grid and provide customers with renewable energy to charge vehicles.

Partnerships are vital to our continued success towards a greener and prosperous tomorrow for B.C. We look forward to collaborating with more partners on the unique solutions that will power our shared future.

CONVENIENT HOME CHARGING

BC Hydro supports home charging with incentives like optional time-of-day pricing for electricity, with a discount of 5 cents per kilowatt-hour (kWh) for electricity used between 11 p.m. and 7 a.m., and a 5-cent surcharge per kWh for usage from 4 p.m. to 9 p.m. This is a great option for EV drivers who can charge their vehicles overnight.

Additionally, BC Hydro's EV Ready Program helps condos prepare for EV adoption, which is where we are seeing significant growth. The program supports apartment, condo, and townhome complexes in becoming EV Ready, ensuring they can accommodate high levels of future EV charging. This involves providing a parking space with electrical wiring installation for an EV charger.



BC Hydro will debut its new 400 kilowatt chargers this year, delivering 100 kilometres of range in just three minutes.

What's next

By Spring 2026, BC Hydro is set to grow its charging ports to over 800. We will continue to support the Province's goal to achieve 10,000 chargers by 2030, by leading charger deployment and working with other parties will ensure reliable EV charging for residents across B.C., along travel corridors, and provide additional support in bustling urban areas. In 2025, we expect to install our first 400-kilowatt fast-charger, marking a significant milestone.

To make EV charging even more convenient, we are enabling customers to activate and pay for their EV charging with a simple tap from credit and/or RFID cards. We are also exploring options to integrate EV public charging bills into residential bills and developing tailored charging solutions for fleet customers.

From a rate perspective BC Hydro will be piloting various rate alternatives to increase charger utilization. Providing incentives may encourage some customers to shift the time of day they charge their vehicles to charge at off peak times where overall system load and charging utilization is lower, and/or to charge at sites that are less heavily used.

Venturing into new market segments beyond light-duty vehicles, BC Hydro will continue expanding its network for medium-duty EVs and begin constructing its first heavy-duty EV charging site to support the trucking market.

By using the BC Hydro charging network, you are energizing the Canadian economy. Together, we are driving towards a more sustainable and prosperous future, one charge at a time.

